

# IMPACT ASSESSMENT OF TECHNICAL AND VOCATIONAL EDUCATION AND TRAINING (TVET) PROJECT



**Submitted To:**  
**BOSCO INTEGRATED DEVELOPMENT  
SOCIETY**



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## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) project, implemented by the Bosco Integrated Development Society (BIDS) across six centres in Northeast India, focused on empowering disadvantaged rural youth by enhancing their employability, self-reliance, and income through quality vocational skill training. The project successfully reached 8,180 youth—close to its target of 10,000—with a strong emphasis on women, who comprised over 60% of participants, and youth aged 18 to 25.

Key achievements of the intervention include 1,520 job placements and 1,645 self-employment outcomes, surpassing original targets, especially in fostering women-led enterprises. The development of 38 NSQF-aligned courses across diverse trades contributed to the standardization and national recognition of vocational offerings. Beneficiary feedback reflected high satisfaction, with average scores exceeding 4.2 for training quality, content, and trainer effectiveness.

The project also supported the establishment of 195 micro-enterprises through its Entrepreneurship Hub, focusing on sectors such as tailoring, baking, mobile repairing, and beauty and wellness. These accomplishments collectively demonstrate the project's success in laying a solid foundation for vocational education and entrepreneurship in the region.

However, the project faced notable challenges, including limited job placement linkages, restricted access to finance for self-employment, insufficient market connectivity, and inadequate post-training follow-up. Only 24 trainees accessed government schemes, highlighting gaps in financial and institutional support. Sustainability prospects varied among centres, with the Shillong centre notably achieving coverage of 50% of its operating costs, indicating a trajectory toward self-sufficiency.

Despite these constraints, the TVET project had a transformative impact on beneficiaries' confidence, skillsets, income, and social standing. Over 90% of trainees reported increased respect within their families and communities and expressed a strong willingness to sustain their livelihoods and recommend the training to others.

For ensuring long-term success and scalability, it is imperative to strengthen financial linkages, enhance post-training support mechanisms, and deepen institutional partnerships. Addressing these areas will be critical to maximizing the project's lasting impact and replicability across similar disadvantaged contexts.

**CHAPTER 1**  
***INTRODUCTION***

## 1.1 Overview of the project

The northeastern region of India is characterized by a significant population of disadvantaged rural youth who face challenges related to unemployment and limited economic opportunities. Addressing these challenges needs focused and targeted interventions to upskill youth, promote entrepreneurship, and ultimately improve their socio-economic status. The **Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET)** project is designed to improve the future prospects of disadvantaged rural youth in the northeastern Indian states of Meghalaya, Assam, and Tripura, through access to quality vocational training and support for business start-up, leading to successful employment, entrepreneurship, and improved income.

The project is implemented by **Bosco Integrated Development Society** in multiple locations across Northeast India, including Shillong (Meghalaya), Silchar (Assam), Agartala (Tripura), Nongstoin (Meghalaya), Jowai (Meghalaya), and Bishramganj (Tripura).

### PROJECT OBJECTIVES

Train 10000 disadvantaged youths

6000 youth gain formal employment

1000 youth become self-employed

500 youth start a small business

### KEY COMPONENTS

#### Modernisation of 6 DBVT Centres

Alignment with NSQF  
58+ modular courses developed  
Technical upgrades

#### Skill Training Delivery

Successful training of 10000 youth

#### Entrepreneurship and Self-Employment Support

Financial and institutional support for trained youth

#### Sustainability and Integration

Enable centres to register with government bodies  
Continuous support for training and rural entrepreneurship

By providing access to quality vocational training and comprehensive support for business start-ups, the project endeavours to empower young individuals with the skills and resources necessary for successful employment and entrepreneurship. Such initiatives are critical in promoting sustainable economic growth and socio-economic development within the region.

## 1.2 Scope of the Study

The scope of this study encompasses a comprehensive evaluation of the TVET project, with a focus on assessing its overall impact through the following key dimensions:

- **Relevance-** To what extent did the project address the needs and priorities of disadvantaged rural youth in the target states? Were the vocational training courses aligned with current labour market demands and local employment opportunities, ensuring meaningful skill development?
- **Effectiveness-** To what extent have the planned objectives (e.g., training of 10,000 youth, development of 58 NSQF-aligned courses) been achieved? How effectively did the centers deliver quality vocational training? Were the trainees able to secure employment or start enterprises post-training?
- **Efficiency-** Were resources (financial, human, and infrastructural) used optimally to achieve the intended project outputs and outcomes? Was the project implemented in a timely manner and within the allocated budget?
- **Impact-** What are the measurable social, economic, and environmental outcomes resulting from the project interventions? How has the project contributed to improved livelihoods, community development, and increased environmental awareness among the beneficiaries?
- **Sustainability-** Are the vocational training centers equipped (institutionally and financially) to continue functioning beyond the project's completion? Have effective linkages been established with government schemes, financial institutions, and the private sector?

Additionally, the study will also document best practices, identified from field experiences, to reinforce the project's impact on a broader scale and provide recommendations for its feasibility and the long-term sustainability of community-driven activities.

## 1.3 About the Study

The final evaluation of the project aims to provide a comprehensive assessment of the initiative's overall performance, focusing on key dimensions such as relevance, effectiveness, efficiency, social, economic, and environmental impact, as well as long-term sustainability. Specifically, the evaluation will determine the extent to which the project has addressed the needs of disadvantaged rural youth through vocational training, how effectively the set objectives have been achieved, and whether the resources were utilized optimally to deliver intended outcomes.

It will also examine the tangible and intangible impacts of the project, socially (e.g., empowerment, inclusion, community development), economically (e.g., income generation, employment opportunities, entrepreneurship), and environmentally (e.g., sustainable practices promoted through training). Sustainability will be assessed in terms of the ongoing capacity of the vocational training centers to operate independently, maintain quality standards, and continue supporting youth post-project. The findings from this final evaluation will serve as critical input for future programme planning and scaling. Moreover, the evaluation will play a vital role in ensuring transparency and accountability to key stakeholders, including Childaid Network and BMZ, by demonstrating the value, outcomes, and lessons learned from the project implementation.

## 1.4. Objective of the Study

The impact assessment of the TVET project aims to comprehensively evaluate the project's achievements, relevance, success, quality, effectiveness, challenges encountered, and future recommendations. The key objectives of the assessment are as follows:

### 1. Assess Project Achievement

Examine the extent to which the project has met its intended goals and delivered the expected outcomes across its various components.

### 2. Identify Key Impacts

Evaluate the changes brought about by the project at multiple levels, including:

- **Centre Level:** Improvements in infrastructure, accreditation status, and the overall quality of vocational training provided.
- **Participating Youth:** Enhancement in skills, employment rates, entrepreneurial activities, and income growth for both male and female beneficiaries.
- **Indirect Benefits:** Job creation and income generation along associated local value chains.

### 3. Review TVET Quality and Partnerships

Assess the relevance, quality, and effectiveness of the vocational training programs and evaluate the strength and effectiveness of collaborations with key stakeholders.

### 4. Analyse Project Relevance

Determine the degree to which the project activities and courses were aligned with local socio-economic needs and current labour market demands to ensure meaningful and sustainable outcomes.

### 5. Identify Successes and Challenges

Highlight key achievements, identify the challenges encountered during project implementation, and document valuable lessons learned throughout implementation.

### 6. Recommend Future Actions

Provide actionable recommendations to enhance the design, implementation, and sustainability of future TVET initiatives, ensuring continued impact and scalability.



***CHAPTER 2***  
**AREA AND CONTEXT**

## 2.1. Area Profile and Socio-Economic Context

Bosco Integrated Development Society (BIDS) has implemented the Technical Vocational and Educational Training (TVET) project across six centres in North East India: Shillong, Silchar, Agartala, Nongstoin, Pnar, and Bishramganj. Each centre plays a vital role in delivering skill development and vocational education to local youth and marginalized communities. The following sections provide a detailed discussion of the area and context for each centre.

### 2.1.1. Silchar

In Silchar and in the broader Cachar district, the literacy rate stands at approximately 80%, compared to Assam's overall 72%. In this context, simply possessing a degree is no longer a guarantee of stable employment. The 2023-24 Assam Economic Survey reveals that nearly 10 lakh educated youths registered as job seekers in 2022, from just 1.38 lakh in 2021, an increase of seven-fold over one year. Meanwhile, unemployment among those aged 15 and above stood at 1.7% in Assam versus the national rate of 3.2%. Despite existing infrastructure like Assam University, NIT Silchar, and polytechnic institutes, there remains a significant gap between formal education and industry needs. Vocational programs under the Industrial Training Institute (ITI), Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY), Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana (DDU-GKY), and agri-based Skill Training of Rural Youth (STRY) help to bridge this divide, offering skill training in carpentry, tailoring, electrical work, and agriculture. Furthermore, local NGOs like Don Bosco and Seva Kendra Silchar have established initiatives and trained hundreds in trades, such as electrical, carpentry, tailoring, and livestock, securing jobs or enabling self-employment. Thus, strengthening vocational training can directly address the steep rise in educated but unemployed youth and better align Silchar's skilled workforce with evolving economic opportunities.

**Table 2.1: Socio-economic indicators and need for skill training in Silchar**

| Indicator                                       | Value                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Literacy Rate (Cachar District)                 | 79.34%                                                                                                 |
| Literacy Rate (Assam)                           | 72.19%                                                                                                 |
| Educated Job Seekers Registered in Assam (2021) | 1.38 lakh                                                                                              |
| Educated Job Seekers Registered in Assam (2022) | 10 lakh                                                                                                |
| Unemployment Rate (Age 15+ in Assam)            | 1.7% overall (urban: 6.1%)                                                                             |
| Unemployment Rate (India)                       | 3.2% overall (urban: 5.4%)                                                                             |
| Key Local Institutions                          | Assam University, NIT Silchar, ITI Silchar                                                             |
| NGO Interventions                               | Vocational training in tailoring, electrical, carpentry, and livestock by Seva Kendra, Don Bosco, etc. |
| Relevant Government Schemes                     | PMKVY, DDU-GKY, STRY                                                                                   |

Source: District Census Handbook, Cachar; <https://assam.gov.in>

### 2.1.2. Meghalaya

Meghalaya's population aged 15 years and above stands at 21.99 lakh, of which 12.48 lakh, 57%, form part of the labour force, those who are either working or actively seeking work. However, the unemployment rate remains high at 7.6%, with significant gender disparity in labour force participation: 76% for males compared to only 39% for females. Nearly 80% of the state's labour force lives in rural areas, and 81% of employed persons work in rural regions, with 77% engaged in non-agricultural occupations. Despite a high proportion of non-agricultural employment, income levels remain modest: 32% earn ₹20,000 or less per month, and 52% earn between ₹20,001–₹50,000.<sup>1</sup>

Formal vocational training remains extremely limited in the state; only 0.1845 lakh persons or 1% have received or are undergoing such training, and just 0.09 lakh are youth aged 15–30. Encouragingly, 66.18% of formally trained individuals are women, showing that structured programs can draw significant female participation. Among the formally trained individuals, 100% are employed, with 88% working in non-agricultural sectors, but income distribution remains similar to the general workforce, with 39.47% earning ₹20,000 or less and 51.05% earning ₹20,001–₹50,000.

In contrast, 11.4 lakh people in Meghalaya have informally acquired skills, mostly through on-the-job learning 74% self-learning 22%, or hereditary means 4%. Yet, only 0.12 lakh of them are aware of formal skill development programs. Still, 1.15 lakh of them express willingness to enroll in formal programs, 99% of them if the training is free or sponsored. Among the state's adult population, a significant 46.93% (10.32 lakh) are unskilled and unemployed or not in the labour force. Alarming, 72.87% of this segment are women, and 73% reside in rural areas. Within this group, even a small exposure to skilling initiatives shows promise: 0.084 lakh are aware of formal training programs, and 99% of them are willing to enroll if the programs are free, with 90% preferring short-term courses.

These figures point to a pressing need to expand accessible, affordable, and job-linked vocational training across Meghalaya. The demand is evident, particularly among youth and women, and the economic payoff, greater employability, reduced dependency on limited government jobs, and enhanced rural entrepreneurship, is significant. A strategic focus on free or subsidised short-term training, especially in non-agricultural sectors, could bridge Meghalaya's skill gap and transform its workforce from informally experienced to formally equipped.

**Nongstoin**, the district headquarters of West Khasi Hills in Meghalaya, has a population of around **28,742**, with a district literacy rate of **87.93%**, reflecting a large pool of educated youth. However, formal education alone has not translated into stable job opportunities. Structural unemployment is high, with only a small proportion of youth being absorbed into the formal sector. While Nongstoin does have a Government ITI and a few vocational centres like the CIDC Centre and Don Bosco Technical School, the scale of training remains insufficient. Encouragingly, projects like the one by Grassroot Shillong and Don Bosco, which trained 30 youth in carpentry with 100% placement or upskilling, demonstrate the transformative potential of vocational education. The demand for trades such as motor mechanics, welding, tailoring, and computer literacy far exceeds available infrastructure. To reduce youth unemployment and the pressure on government job markets, Nongstoin needs expanded, high-quality vocational training that is closely aligned with both local needs and emerging industries.

**Jowai**, in the West Jaintia Hills district, has a predominantly tribal population and a workforce that relies heavily on agriculture, handloom, and informal trade. Youth in the region face

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<sup>1</sup> National Skill Development Corporation. (2020). *Estimating The Skill Stock In Meghalaya- Leveraging A Household Survey Conducted By The Centre For Monitoring Indian Economy To Understand The Supply Of Skills In Meghalaya*.

significant barriers to formal employment due to limited access to skill-based education and industry linkage. As per the PLFS 2022-23 based on the usual status (adjusted) approach, the overall unemployment rate in Meghalaya was 6% compared to the all India average of 3.2%. Youth unemployment (15-29 years) was 18% for Meghalaya compared to 10% for all India. In such a context, vocational training in Jowai can serve as a powerful tool for equipping youth with practical skills in trades like carpentry, tailoring, eco-tourism services, food processing, and digital literacy. This not only enhances employability but also supports local industries and entrepreneurship. Scaling up vocational infrastructure in Jowai is essential to reduce migration, promote self-employment, and ensure inclusive development.

**Shillong**, the capital city of Meghalaya and its largest urban centre, serves as a hub for education and administration, attracting thousands of youth each year. Despite this, the city faces rising urban unemployment and underemployment, particularly among graduates with limited practical or job-oriented skills. The city's growing sectors-hospitality, tourism, IT services, construction, and creative arts require skill sets that are often not addressed by conventional education. Moreover, urban migration from nearby districts increases the burden on Shillong's job market. By strengthening vocational training tailored to urban employment opportunities, such as retail, hospitality management, graphic design, plumbing, electrical work, and digital marketing, Shillong can better equip its youth for sustainable livelihoods while reducing dependency on limited white-collar jobs.

### 2.1.3. Tripura

Tripura, with a population of approximately 42 lakh (2023-24 estimates), faces persistent challenges in employment due to its largely agrarian economy and limited industrial base. Over 73% of its population lives in rural areas, and 31.8% belong to Scheduled Tribes. The state's youth unemployment rate stands at a concerning 18.6% (PLFS 2022–23), significantly higher than the national average of 12.4%. Vocational training is essential in Tripura to address the mismatch between education and employability, particularly for tribal and rural youth who lack access to mainstream job markets. Equipping them with market-relevant skills in trades such as bamboo crafts, agriculture, hospitality, and IT can promote local employment, reduce distress migration, and improve income levels. Strengthening vocational training will also support Tripura's alignment with national skill development goals and boost economic opportunities in sectors like eco-tourism, green energy, and digital services.

**Table 2.2: Unemployment Statistics for Tripura**

| Indicator                                 | Rural (%) | Urban (%) | Total (%) |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR)    | 57.2      | 46.3      | 54.8      |
| Worker Population Ratio (WPR)             | 53.3      | 41.1      | 50.6      |
| Unemployment Rate (UR)                    | 6.9       | 11.3      | –         |
| Youth Unemployment Rate (15–29 years)     | –         | –         | 18.6      |
| Scheduled Tribe Population (Census 2011)  | –         | –         | 31.8      |
| Rural Population Proportion (Census 2011) | –         | –         | 73+       |

*Source: PLFS data for 2022–23 and 2023–24*

***CHAPTER 3***  
**RESEARCH METHODOLOGY**

The assessment employed a mixed-methods approach, integrating both qualitative and quantitative techniques to provide a comprehensive and in-depth analysis of the impact of the TVET project implemented by BOSCO Integrated Development Society across six locations in the Northeast region (NER). This approach enabled the evaluation of both project performance metrics and descriptive targets. The assessment framework is divided into two distinct components: Secondary Assessment, which involved the analysis of existing data and documentation, and Primary Assessment, which entailed field-level data collection and direct engagement with stakeholders.

### 3.1. Secondary Assessment

A secondary analysis of all the key project reports was carried out to understand the context of the disadvantaged youths in the project areas. The analysis is aimed to understand the gaps and challenges faced by the youths and how they got enrolled in the skill enhancement course provided under the project TVET. An analysis of the enrollment record/MIS data and enrolment process is expected from the project reports, along with the projected deliverables through each course.

### 3.2. Primary Assessment

A primary assessment was conducted, first to triangulate the findings of the secondary assessment like – number of enrolled candidates received employments, started micro enterprises or received financial assistance for startups including observation of the infrastructure development and second, to conduct a primary assessment of all the actors in the project. The methods of primary assessment were:

**Key Informant Interviews (KIIs):** With project stakeholders such as center heads, trainers, government representatives, and financial partners.

**Focus Group Discussions (FGDs):** With beneficiaries (trained youth), families, and community leaders.

**Surveys:** Structured questionnaires targeting a representative sample of trained youth to measure employment, income changes, and satisfaction.

**Site Visits & Observations:** Direct assessments of infrastructure, training sessions, and equipment usage.

**Case Studies:** In-depth stories illustrating transformative outcomes and entrepreneurial journeys.

### 3.3. Stakeholders

The following are the major stakeholders identified and interviewed.

- Project beneficiaries (youths)
- Government Departments
- Institutions
- Trainers
- Employers
- BOSCO Integrated Development Society

### 3.4. Data Collection

The study relied on structured quantitative and qualitative methods, including focus group discussions with participants and staff.

- **Survey Tool:** A structured questionnaire was designed. The study used a technology-based software **Kobo Toolbox** to collect, analyze, and manage data for surveys, monitoring, evaluation, and research.
- **Data Processing:** Responses were collected digitally and analyzed using SPSS for robust statistical analysis.

#### 3.4.1. Quantitative Data Collection

The quantitative survey has assessed the following indicators:

- To what extent were the project objectives and results achieved?
- How effective were the training methodologies and curriculum?
- How efficient was the use of resources in the training?
- What changes (intended or unintended) have occurred among beneficiaries (short-term/long-term)?
- What is the potential for sustainability and scalability?
  - In terms of vocational training centers
  - In terms of beneficiaries of the project
  - In terms of Bosco Integrated Development Society (BIDS) and Bosco Entrepreneurship Hub (E-Hub)
- Did the project address the actual labour market needs?
- Did the project address the actual needs of the target groups?
- How effectively is BIDS collaborating with key stakeholders such as government institutions and private sector partners to achieve its objectives?
- What mechanisms or roles are in place to ensure effective coordination between BIDS and the six individual Don Bosco vocational centers, vis-à-vis their respective functions and responsibilities?

These quantitative indicators helped in assessing the effectiveness and impact of the project interventions in a measurable way.

#### 3.4.2. Qualitative Data Collection

To gain contextual insights, the study includes:

- **Key Informant Interviews (KIIs):** Conducted with Beneficiaries (youths), Institution Heads, Trainers, Employers, BOSCO project team to understand the relevance of the courses, challenges, changes required.
- **Focus Group Discussions (FGDs):** Organized with the youths who are currently undergoing training in the centres, to explore their experiences in classrooms, trainings, teaching learning methods, evaluation processes and to understand their aspirations and whether their need is met or not, including the results they are receiving after the trainings.

These **qualitative insights** provide a deeper understanding of beneficiaries' experiences, challenges, and perceptions, complementing the quantitative data for a comprehensive project evaluation.

### 3.4.3. Data Collection Tools

Major tools of data collection are:

- Observation sheets
- Telephonic interview

Primary respondents (beneficiaries of the project) were interviewed via phone. A structured questionnaire was used to interview the beneficiaries through the phone, targeting a representative sample of trained youth to measure employment, income changes, and satisfaction.

This approach has been identified as the most suitable given the respondents' diverse geographic distribution, which may limit their physical proximity to TVET centers and make in-person engagement challenging.

To facilitate effective data collection and analysis, clearly defined roles and responsibilities have been outlined as follows:

**Table 3.1: Roles of Responsibilities of Data Collection**

| Roles and Responsibilities |                                                    |                                                                |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| SI. No                     | SDS                                                | BOSCO                                                          |
| 1                          | Desk Review                                        | Providing all necessary reports, records (including financial) |
| 2                          | Preparation of survey design (questionnaires etc.) | Feedback on questionnaires                                     |
| 3                          | Conducting Interviews                              | Providing Contacts of Key Informants                           |
| 4                          | Conducting FGDs                                    | Arranging location and participants                            |

### 3.5. Sampling

The samples are classified into two groups: project beneficiaries (youth participants) and other stakeholders within the same operational universe. The youths for interviews were selected by a simple random sampling method, ensuring that every individual had an equal probability of inclusion in the study. Given the project's implementation across six different locations, the target population was further divided into six clusters corresponding to these geographical sites. Within each cluster, the simple random sampling method was applied consistently to achieve representative samples from each location.

The sample size was calculated by using the standard sample size formula, considering the desired confidence level (95%) and margin of error (5%). This calculation ensured that the number of surveyed individuals was statistically sufficient to produce valid and generalizable findings of the study.



**Sample size formula (for finite population):**

$$n = \frac{N \cdot Z^2 \cdot p(1 - p)}{(e^2 \cdot (N - 1)) + (Z^2 \cdot p(1 - p))}$$

Where:

- $n$  = required sample size
- $N$  = population size (10,530 trained youth)
- $Z$  = Z-score (1.96 for 95% confidence)
- $p$  = estimated proportion of success (usually 0.5 for maximum variability)
- $e$  = margin of error (commonly 0.05 or 5%)

(with 95% confidence and 5% margin of error):

$$n = \frac{10530 \cdot (1.96)^2 \cdot 0.5(1 - 0.5)}{(0.05^2 \cdot (10530 - 1)) + ((1.96)^2 \cdot 0.5(1 - 0.5))} \approx 372$$

Based on the sample size calculation, the minimum recommended sample for the youth beneficiaries was determined to be between 370 and 400 individuals. Accordingly, a total of 400 youth participants were selected from the 8,180 beneficiaries trained under the BOSCO Integrated Development Society (BIDS) project. This sample comprises a representative mix of trained youth, self-employed youth, and those who have secured employment, ensuring a comprehensive evaluation of the project's impact across diverse outcome categories.

**Table 3.2: Sample Size Distribution by Centre**

| Centre       | Trained Youth | Suggested Sample Size (95% CL, ±5% Error) |
|--------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Shillong     | 2,610         | ~92                                       |
| Silchar      | 3,150         | ~111                                      |
| Agartala     | 1,215         | ~43                                       |
| Nongstoin    | 1,845         | ~65                                       |
| Bosco Pnar   | 1,260         | ~45                                       |
| Bishramganj  | 450           | ~16                                       |
| <b>Total</b> | <b>10,530</b> | <b>~372</b>                               |

**Table 3.3: Scaled Sample Allocation (Total Number of Sample ≈ 400)**

| Centre       | Trained Youth | % of Total Youth | Scaled Sample (≈400 Total) |
|--------------|---------------|------------------|----------------------------|
| Shillong     | 2,610         | 24.79%           | ~99                        |
| Silchar      | 3,150         | 29.91%           | ~120                       |
| Agartala     | 1,215         | 11.54%           | ~46                        |
| Nongstoin    | 1,845         | 17.52%           | ~70                        |
| Bosco Pnar   | 1,260         | 11.96%           | ~47                        |
| Bishramganj  | 450           | 4.27%            | ~18                        |
| <b>Total</b> | <b>10,530</b> | <b>100%</b>      | <b>400</b>                 |

**Table 3.4: Key Informant Interviews**

| Key Informant Interviews      |                                                   |                                                   |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Key Informants                | No. of Informants per Institute                   | Number of Informants across project locations (6) |
| Head of Institutions          | 1                                                 | 6                                                 |
| Trainers                      | 2                                                 | 12                                                |
| BOSCO officials/Staff members | -                                                 | 2                                                 |
| Employers                     | (Employment carried out centrally by BIDS office) | Total 3                                           |

**Table 3.5: Focus Group Discussions**

| Focus Group Discussion       |                             |                                             |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Respondent Group             | Number of FGD per Institute | Number of FGDs across project locations (6) |
| Youths who received training | 1                           | 6                                           |



### 3.6. Expected Indicators

**Table 3.6: Expected Indicators**

| Indicators                                                                             | Measurement Approach                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10,000 young people improve income and future opportunities through quality education  | Number of trained youths; employment/self-employment/business startup rate; income tracking |
| 6,000 young people find employment                                                     | Post-training placement records; employer verification                                      |
| 1,000 young people work independently                                                  | Self-employment documentation; case studies; follow-up surveys                              |
| 500 young people start a small business                                                | Business registration documents; entrepreneurship support records                           |
| 20–25% of trained youth find employment                                                | Baseline and endline employment surveys; training centre records                            |
| At least 6,000 youth (60% incl. 30% women) in long-term employment or higher positions | Placement tracking; gender-disaggregated data from centers                                  |
| 1,000 youth supported into self-employment (50% women)                                 | Project support documentation; follow-up surveys                                            |
| 500 youth supported in micro-enterprise setup                                          | Entrepreneurship Hub records; enterprise registration; success tracking                     |
| 6 modern, sustainable and state-accredited VET centers                                 | Infrastructure audits; accreditation certificates; equipment inventories                    |
| 18 modular curricula aligned to NSQF                                                   | Curricula documentation; alignment reviews with NSQF standards                              |
| 75% employment rate after training                                                     | Post-training employment surveys; third-party verification                                  |
| Centers cover 50% of running costs                                                     | Financial audits; income/expenditure statements                                             |
| 3 production centers cover an additional 30%                                           | Business performance reports from production units                                          |
| 10,000 youth trained (3,000/year post-project)                                         | Enrolment and completion records                                                            |
| 3,060 youth trained annually in certificate courses                                    | Training attendance records                                                                 |
| 1,836 placed annually (60% placement)                                                  | Placement logs; alumni feedback                                                             |
| 600 trained annually in postgraduate certificate courses                               | Enrollment in advanced programs; training records                                           |
| 360 employed from postgraduate training (60%)                                          | Employment verification                                                                     |
| 120 graduates/year in high-calibre jobs                                                | Employer reports; income records ( $\geq$ €180/month)                                       |
| Average income of employed graduates: €96–€180                                         | Income survey; employment contracts                                                         |
| Tracking of all employed graduates for 1 year                                          | Database tracking; phone follow-ups or field visits                                         |

|                                                             |                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Entrepreneurship Hub advises 1,500 youth                    | Attendance logs; training records; feedback reports |
| 200 trained youth receive project loan                      | Loan disbursement records                           |
| 50 trained entrepreneurs receive bank loan                  | Bank confirmation documents                         |
| 1,000 youth receive support for tools/equipment             | Project procurement and distribution logs           |
| 60% success rate in self-employment                         | Follow-up assessment; income verification           |
| Target income for self-employed: €72–€96/month              | Income records; client interviews                   |
| 500 youth supported to start micro-enterprises              | Business initiation tracking; mentoring logs        |
| 1,500 youth guided to govt. entrepreneurship schemes        | Counselling records; application logs               |
| 40% receive state support                                   | Scheme enrolment confirmation from govt. bodies     |
| Shillong and Silchar centers accredited under NQAF          | Accreditation certificates                          |
| 4 centers accredited under NQAF Level 1                     | Same as above                                       |
| Shillong registered under PMKVY                             | Registration confirmation from PMKVY portal         |
| 6 centers registered under State Skill Development Missions | Registration certificates; funding access reports   |

### 3.7. Key Deliverables & Work Plan

**Table 3.7: Work Plan**

| Phase   | Particulars                                                                        | W- 1 | W- 2 | W- 3 | W- 4 |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|------|------|------|
| Phase-1 | Desk Review                                                                        |      |      |      |      |
|         | Inception Report                                                                   |      |      |      |      |
| Phase-2 | Sharing of survey tools for Feedback                                               |      |      |      |      |
|         | Pilot survey                                                                       |      |      |      |      |
|         | Finalisation of survey tools and uploading the survey tools in the online software |      |      |      |      |
|         | Data Collection                                                                    |      |      |      |      |
| Phase-3 | Data Editing                                                                       |      |      |      |      |
|         | Data Analysis                                                                      |      |      |      |      |
| Phase-4 | Report writing                                                                     |      |      |      |      |
|         | Submission of draft report                                                         |      |      |      |      |
|         | Working on feedback                                                                |      |      |      |      |
|         | Submission of End-Term evaluation report                                           |      |      |      |      |

***CHAPTER 4***  
**FINDINGS: BENEFICIARIES OF  
THE BOSCO TVET PROJECT**

## 4.1. Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong

As outlined in the research methodology, a total of 99 beneficiaries from the Shillong Centre, who had successfully completed their training under the BMZ BOSCO TVET project, were interviewed as part of this study. The objective of this engagement was to evaluate the post-training outcomes, including employment status, livelihood activities, and the overall effectiveness of the vocational training in enhancing employability and supporting sustainable income generation. The subsequent analysis presents the key findings based on the data collected from these respondents.

### 4.1.1. Basic Beneficiary Details

The majority of interviewed beneficiaries are young, with 64% aged between 18–25 years, and predominantly female, also at 64%, indicating a youthful and women-centric participation. This youthful and women-centric participation is particularly evident in vocational categories such as Beauty Therapist, Baking Technician, Hand Embroidery, and Sewing Machine Operator, where female representation is especially strong. In terms of educational attainment, 33% of beneficiaries have completed at least secondary education, while a substantial 57% have achieved higher secondary education or graduation, indicating that the group is relatively well-educated. This combination of youthfulness, female predominance, and educational background indicates the potential for these beneficiaries to effectively leverage the vocational training for improved employment and entrepreneurship outcomes.

**Table 4.1: Basic Beneficiary Details**

| Indicators                | % of beneficiaries |
|---------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Age (years)</b>        |                    |
| 18-25                     | 64%                |
| 26-35                     | 32%                |
| 36+                       | 4%                 |
| <b>Level of education</b> |                    |
| Primary                   | 10%                |
| Secondary                 | 33%                |
| Higher secondary          | 40%                |
| Graduate                  | 17%                |
| <b>Sex</b>                |                    |
| Female                    | 64%                |
| Male                      | 36%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)



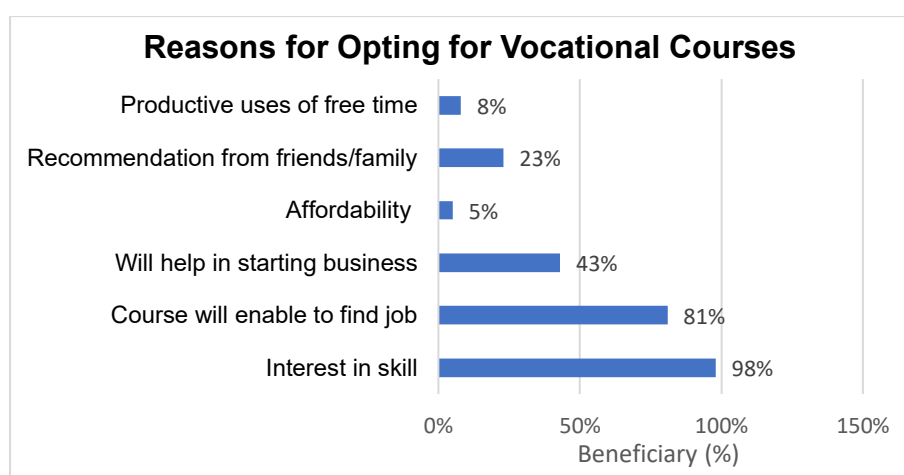
**Table 4.2: Profile of Vocational Courses opted by Beneficiaries**

| Course/Trade                                | % of beneficiaries |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Beauty Therapist                            | 8%                 |
| Baking Technician                           | 10%                |
| Craft Baker                                 | 9%                 |
| Hand Embroidery                             | 14%                |
| Sewing Machine Operator                     | 12%                |
| Street Food Vendor                          | 12%                |
| Plumber General                             | 7%                 |
| Four Wheeler Service Technician             | 5%                 |
| Solar Lighting Assembler                    | 8%                 |
| Bridal, Fashion and Portfolio Makeup Artist | 5%                 |
| Electrician Domestic Solutions              | 2%                 |
| Fashion Designer                            | 2%                 |
| Automotive Body Painting Technician         | 2%                 |
| Hair Stylist                                | 2%                 |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

#### 4.1.2. Project Awareness and Training Feedback

Of the interviewed beneficiaries, **98%** reported learning about the project and its various technical and vocational training courses through **word-of-mouth**, primarily from acquaintances and friends. The remaining 2% reported that they got to know about it through Don Bosco Teachers and the newspaper. This highlights the critical role of personal networks and community-based communication in reaching disadvantaged rural youth within the project's target areas.

**Figure 4.1: Reasons for Choosing Vocational Courses**

Source: Primary data (2025)

The primary data from beneficiaries of the Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong, reveals that **personal interest in the vocational skill** was the most significant factor influencing course selection. This was followed closely by the belief that completing the course would **enhance job prospects and support business start-ups**, reflecting a strong



motivation among youth towards achieving economic self-reliance through vocational training. Recommendations from friends or family and the productive use of free time played a lesser role, while affordability was the least influential factor in course selection. This indicates that passion and perceived employability were the main drivers behind course choices.

The data also clearly demonstrates strong alignment of the vocational training programs with both the personal aspirations of the beneficiaries and the labour market requirements in the region. Around 94% of beneficiaries felt that the training matched their personal interests and career goals, which highlights the program's effectiveness in engaging youth in skills they are motivated to develop. Additionally, the majority of the respondents (about 98%) confirmed that the training was relevant to current labour market demands, indicating that the courses offered are well designed to equip participants with employable and entrepreneurial skills that meet regional economic needs.

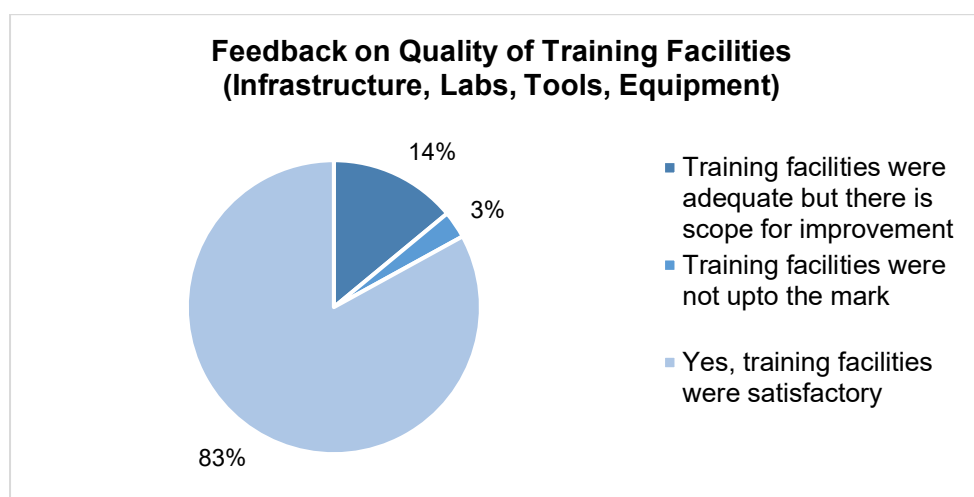
**Table 4.3: Rating of Training Aspects by Beneficiaries**

| Training aspects                         | Average rating |
|------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Content and clarity of training material | 4.5            |
| Duration of training                     | 4.5            |
| Methodology used during training         | 4.6            |
| Effectiveness of trainer                 | 4.5            |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

Beneficiaries were also asked to rate various aspects of the training on a scale of 0 to 5, with 5 being the highest. The average ratings reflect high levels of satisfaction across all parameters. The methodology used during training received the highest average rating of 4.6, indicating that the teaching approach was particularly effective and well-received. Content and clarity of training material, duration of training, and effectiveness of the trainer all received an equally strong average rating of 4.5, suggesting that the training was comprehensive, well-structured, and delivered competently. A respondent who had enrolled in the Beauty Therapist course shared her experience: *"The trainers are very friendly, knowledgeable, kind, supportive, and make the classes interactive. The trainers not only teach us, but they also give us the space to show our creativity. They also encourage us to take up different kinds of training. Next month, I'll be going for on-the-job training in Chennai."*

**Figure 4.2: Feedback on Training**



Source: Primary data (2025)



The feedback on training quality facilities, including infrastructure, labs, tools, and equipment, was largely positive, with 83% of beneficiaries reporting that the facilities were satisfactory. While 14% felt the facilities were adequate but could be improved, only a small fraction of 3% found them not up to the mark. This indicates a generally strong training environment with minor areas that could benefit from further enhancement.

Furthermore, a small percentage of beneficiaries reported challenges during the training, with 5% indicating issues with training methods, 4% citing concerns regarding trainer efficiency, and 3% expressing concerns about curriculum relevance. These relatively low figures suggest that the overall quality of the training was high, reflecting well on the effectiveness of the facilities, trainers, and course content. The positive reception highlights the project's success in delivering vocational education that meets the expectations and needs of the participants.

#### 4.1.3. Post-Training Outcomes

The employment outcome of the beneficiaries indicates that a combined 53% of beneficiaries are either **employed (27%)** or **self-employed (26%)**. This demonstrates that over half of the surveyed participants were able to leverage their training to enter the workforce or start their own businesses. This outcome aligns well with the project's goal of promoting both employment and entrepreneurship among disadvantaged youth. However, around **46% of the surveyed beneficiaries were unemployed**, indicating a gap in either job placement support, labour market absorption capacity, or alignment between training and available opportunities.

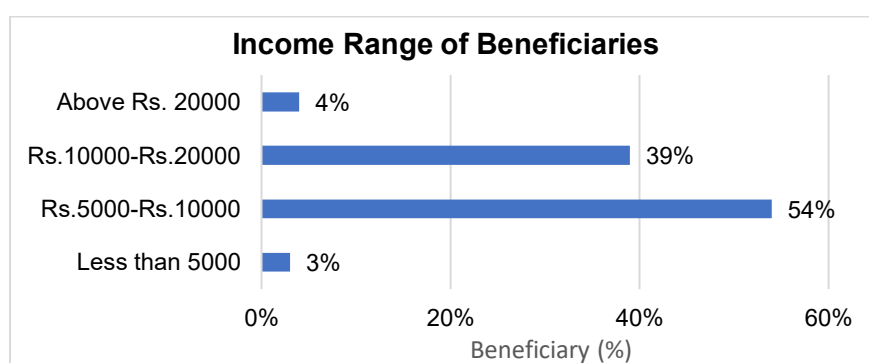
**Table 4.4: Employment Profile of Beneficiaries**

| Employment Status | % of beneficiaries |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| Employed          | 27%                |
| Self-employed     | 26%                |
| Unemployed        | 46%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

Furthermore, a **significant 91% of the employed and self-employed beneficiaries reported that the training directly helped them secure employment or start their own business**, highlighting the strong practical impact and relevance of the vocational courses. Only 7% stated that the training did not assist them in this regard, while 2% felt it was only somewhat helpful. These findings suggest that the training programs were largely successful in enhancing livelihood opportunities for participants.

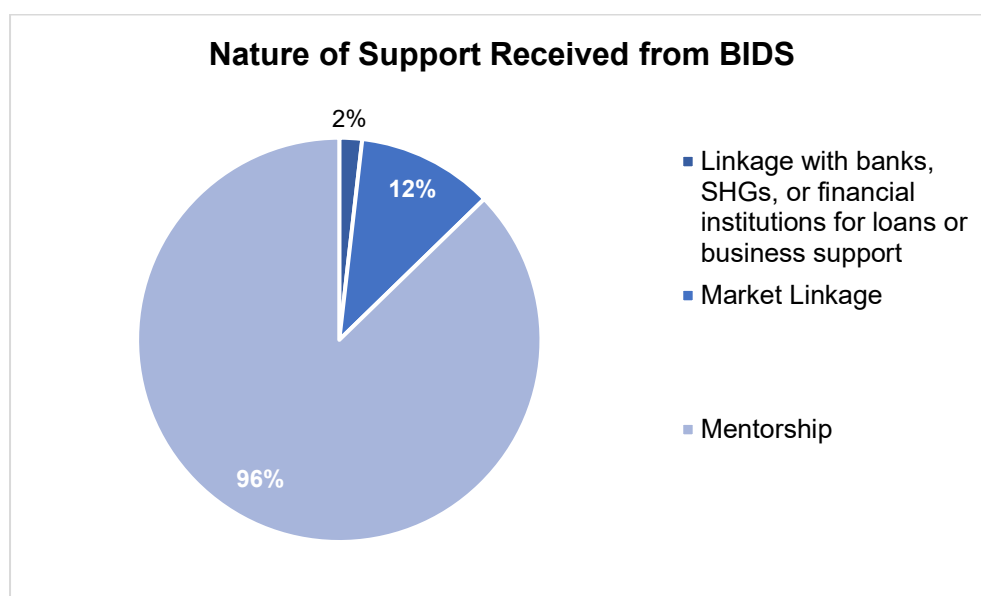
**Figure 4.3: Income Range of Beneficiaries**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

The income distribution of employed beneficiaries reveals that a majority, 54%, earn between ₹5,000 and ₹10,000 per month, indicating that most are at the lower end of the earning spectrum. A significant portion, 39%, earn between ₹10,000 and ₹20,000, suggesting better income outcomes for a considerable number of participants. Only 4% reported earnings above ₹20,000, reflecting limited high-income generation through the program. Meanwhile, just 3% earn less than ₹5,000, showing that very few are in extremely low-income brackets. Overall, while the program has enabled income generation for most beneficiaries, the majority remain in modest earning categories. This can also be attributed to the fact that most beneficiaries have only recently joined employment and are likely starting with entry-level wages. As they gain experience and stability in their jobs or businesses, their income levels may be expected to improve over time.

**Figure 4.4: Nature of Support from BIDS**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

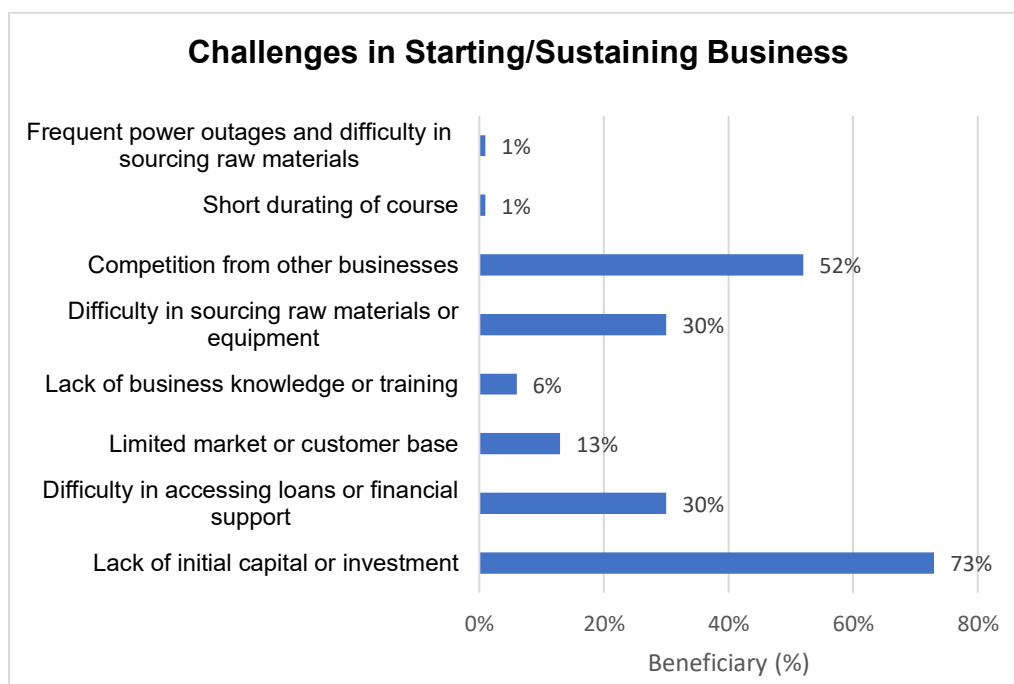
The nature of support received from BOSCO BIDS highlights a strong emphasis on mentorship, with 96% of beneficiaries reporting access to continuous guidance and support. As one trainer at the centre shared, *“Students, especially those enrolled in the beauty and wellness courses, are first groomed and taught basic soft skills-how to sit, stand, speak, and carry themselves, as these are fundamental in this industry and extremely important.”* This reflects the project’s focus on holistic development, going beyond technical training to include personal presentation and communication skills essential for professional success.

However, only 12% received market linkage support, and a mere 2% were connected to banks, SHGs, or financial institutions for loans or business support. This indicates that while the program excelled in providing non-financial, knowledge-based support, it lacked adequate mechanisms for providing access to financial resources and market opportunities.

Furthermore, **the majority of the surveyed beneficiaries (>90%) reported not receiving any financial assistance**, such as grants or loans, for their business as part of the BIDS project. This indicates a gap in post-training support, particularly in enabling self-employment through financial backing.

According to centre records, out of a total of 3,811 youths trained at this specific location, only 64 beneficiaries (approximately 1.7%) secured monetary support to launch their businesses under the Project Entrepreneurship Hub, a dedicated component of the TVET initiative aimed at promoting entrepreneurship.

**Figure 4.5: Challenges in Starting/Sustaining Business**



The primary challenge faced by beneficiaries in starting or sustaining a business was the lack of initial capital or investment, reported by 73% of respondents. This was followed by intense competition from other businesses, highlighting the need for better market strategies and differentiation. Furthermore, 30% of beneficiaries struggled with accessing loans or financial support, and an equal percentage faced difficulties in sourcing raw materials or equipment, both of which point to systemic barriers in operationalising business plans. Only a small fraction cited lack of business knowledge or short training duration as issues, suggesting that the training was largely effective, but external factors like financial access and market conditions remained as barriers.



According to the primary data, around 19% of respondents mentioned receiving job placement follow-up, indicating that the centre is making efforts to track the current employment status of both placed and unplaced trainees. This kind of follow-up is important as it helps assess the long-term effectiveness of the training. It also allows the centres to identify any challenges trainees may be facing at work and provide support when necessary. This can lead to timely guidance, necessary improvements, and better job retention and satisfaction. As one respondent noted when asked about their employment status, *“Yes, I did get a job through the BIDS placement process, but I came back home after 3 months.”* Such instances of beneficiaries leaving their jobs, especially when placed outside the Northeast region, were fairly common. Regular post-training follow-up can help identify underlying issues and explore possible solutions to improve employment outcomes.

Furthermore, field visits were reported by a very small fraction, likely under 2%, pointing to a lack of on-ground engagement or monitoring support. Around 2–3% stated that no follow-up was taken at all. While mentoring seems to be a core component of post-training support, the limited focus on job placement and field engagement sheds light on an area for improvement in post-training outcomes.

#### 4.1.4. Aspirations and Sustainability

Primary data indicates a strong sense of aspiration and positive impact among the beneficiaries following their participation in the vocational course. A significant majority, 98%, reported improvements in their skills and confidence, while 100% acknowledged enhanced respect and social standing within their families and communities, thus highlighting the social value attached to skill development and employment. Furthermore, 99% of respondents expressed willingness to recommend the training to others, indicating high levels of satisfaction and belief in its utility. Furthermore, 97% showed interest in learning new skills through similar vocational courses in the future, indicating that there exists a continued aspiration for self-improvement and upward mobility. These findings suggest that the training has not only equipped beneficiaries with practical skills but has been successful in facilitating their personal growth, social recognition, and a mindset of ambition.

**Table 4.5: Aspirations of Beneficiaries**

| Indicators                                                                                  | % of beneficiaries |    |       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----|-------|
|                                                                                             | Yes                | No |       |
| Improvements in skills and confidence                                                       | 98%                | 2% |       |
| Enhanced respect or social standing in the community/family post-training/ post-employment? | Yes                | No |       |
|                                                                                             | 100%               | -  |       |
| Will the beneficiary recommend the training to others in the community                      | Yes                | No |       |
|                                                                                             | 99%                | 1% |       |
| Aspiration to learn new skills in the future through similar vocational courses             | Yes                | No | Maybe |
|                                                                                             | 97%                | 1% | 2%    |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 4.6: Impact of Training on Beneficiaries**

| Impact of the training on the lives of the beneficiaries                            | % of beneficiaries |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| I have started earning an income                                                    | 55%                |
| I feel more confident and socially respected                                        | 96%                |
| I am contributing financially to my family                                          | 47%                |
| I have started or joined an environment-friendly initiative as a part of green jobs | 3%                 |
| I have not experienced any noticeable change                                        | 1%                 |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The impact of the training on the lives of beneficiaries has been largely positive, with 55% of the surveyed beneficiaries reporting that they have started earning an income and 96% stating that they feel more confident and socially respected. These outcomes indicate that the training has significantly contributed to both economic empowerment and personal growth. Nearly half of the respondents, 47%, mentioned that they are now contributing financially to their families, reflecting a shift towards an increase in household-level economic participation. However, participation in environment-friendly or green job initiatives remains low, at just 3%, suggesting an area for future strengthening. Only 1% reported no noticeable change, shedding light on the overall effectiveness of the training in improving livelihoods and boosting self-esteem among beneficiaries.

The data indicates a promising outlook on the sustainability of both the beneficiaries' livelihoods and the functioning of the training centre. A significant **92%** of the employed and self-employed respondents expressed confidence in **sustaining their job or business in the long term**. This reflects not only the relevance and applicability of the skills acquired during training but also the beneficiaries' growing self-reliance and belief in their ability to maintain their enterprises independently.

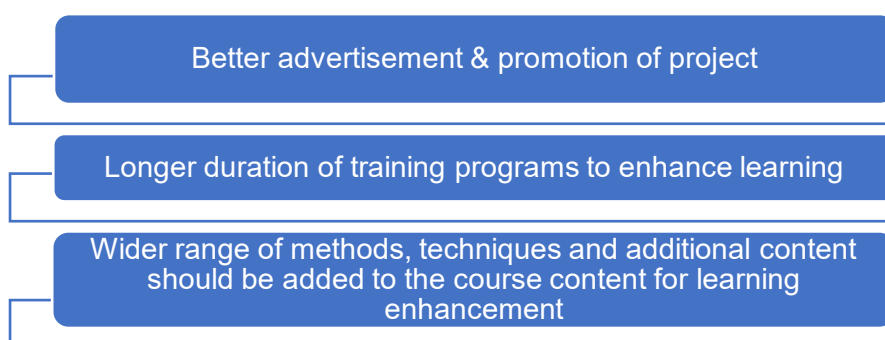
In addition, the majority of respondents (>90%) believe that **the training centres have the capacity to continue** offering vocational training to youth even after the project ends. This suggests a strong institutional foundation, adequate infrastructure, and adequately trained staff, which together contribute to the sustainability of the centres beyond project support. The data highlights that both the individual beneficiaries and the training institutions are positioned for sustained impact in the future.

#### 4.1.5. Recommendations

The surveyed beneficiaries have put forward several recommendations aimed at enhancing the effectiveness and reach of future prospects of the project. Such key suggestions include:

- **Improved Project Promotion:** Expanding awareness campaigns to better promote the project, thereby reaching a larger number of eligible beneficiaries and increasing participation rates.
- **Extended Course Duration:** Lengthening the duration of vocational training courses to allow more comprehensive skill development and deeper mastery of the trades.
- **Enhanced Training Methods:** Upgrading the training approaches and techniques employed to create more engaging, effective, and learner-centered educational experiences, which would improve knowledge retention and practical competence.

Incorporating these recommendations can significantly contribute to improved beneficiary outcomes and greater overall impact of the Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) initiative.



## 4.2. Don Bosco Tech, Pnar, Jowai

### 4.2.1. Basic Beneficiary Details

The majority of interviewed beneficiaries, around 98%, fall between the ages of 18 to 35, indicating strong youth participation in the centre. Most have completed at least secondary education, with 49% having studied up to higher secondary level and 13% being graduates. The data also reflects a highly women-centric reach, with 83% of the beneficiaries being female, suggesting that the training has been particularly successful in engaging young and educated women.

**Table 4.7: Basic Beneficiary Details**

| Indicators                | % of beneficiaries |
|---------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Age</b>                |                    |
| 18-25                     | 55%                |
| 26-35                     | 43%                |
| 36+                       | 2%                 |
| <b>Level of education</b> |                    |
| Primary                   | 4%                 |
| Secondary                 | 30%                |
| Higher secondary          | 49%                |
| Graduate                  | 13%                |
| Postgraduate              | 4%                 |
| <b>Sex</b>                |                    |
| Female                    | 83%                |
| Male                      | 17%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 4.8: Profile of Vocational Courses opted by Beneficiaries**

| Course/Trade                       | % of beneficiaries |
|------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Account Executive                  | 11%                |
| Assistant Beauty therapist         | 47%                |
| Associate Desktop Publishing (DTP) | 13%                |
| Domestic Data Entry Operator       | 23%                |
| Four Wheeler Service Technician    | 6%                 |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The data shows that the majority of interviewed beneficiaries, 47% had opted for the course of Assistant Beauty Therapist, indicating a strong preference for the beauty and wellness sector. This is followed by 23% trained as Domestic Data Entry Operators and 13% in Desktop Publishing, both reflecting interest in computer-based roles. Other trades like Account Executive (11%), Four Wheeler Service Technician (6%) had lower participation amongst the respondents.

### 4.2.1. Project Awareness and Training Feedback

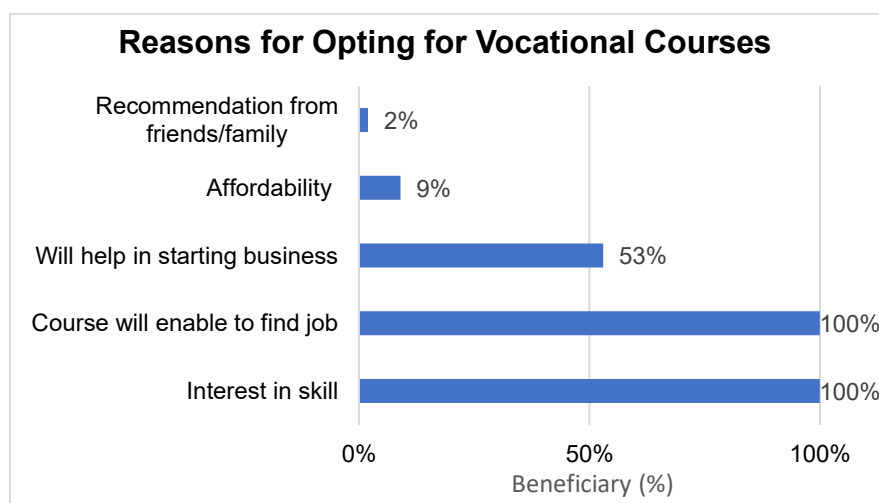
According to primary data, all respondents reported that they came to know about the project through friends, family, or acquaintances, indicating that information about the training was primarily spread **through word of mouth**.

While word-of-mouth is an effective way to spread awareness about the project, its reach and sustainability are limited, as it depends heavily on personal networks. **To ensure wider and more consistent outreach, the training centres should consider adopting more structured outreach strategies, such as community meetings, local advertisements,**



**social media, and collaboration with local institutions or self-help groups.** This would help in reaching a more diverse group of potential beneficiaries and improve the visibility and long-term impact of the project.

**Figure 4.7: Reasons for Opting for Vocational Courses.**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

Primary data indicates that the two most significant factors that drove the respondents to opt for these particular courses were a genuine interest in the skill and the belief that the course would help them secure employment, both cited by nearly all respondents. This indicates that most participants were driven by personal motivation and a strong desire for career advancement. Furthermore, more than half of the beneficiaries opted for the course with the aim of starting their own business, reflecting entrepreneurial aspirations. In comparison, only a small percentage selected the course based on affordability or recommendations from friends or family, suggesting that internal goals and perceived career benefits played a larger role in their decision-making process than external influences.

**The data also reflects the high relevance of the training provided, both in terms of individual aspirations and regional labour market demands.** All respondents 100% stated that the training was aligned with their personal interests and career goals, indicating that the courses offered were well-suited to the needs and motivations of the beneficiaries. This strong alignment is likely to result in higher engagement, better learning outcomes as well as improved chances of sustained employment. 98% of respondents felt that the training matched the current labour market demands in the region, suggesting that the programme was well-informed by local economic conditions and job opportunities. These findings indicate that the training was both meaningful to the individuals and designed to meet regional employment needs.

**Table 4.9: Rating of Training Aspects by Beneficiaries**

| Rating given to training aspects         | Average rating |
|------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Content and clarity of training material | 4.3            |
| Duration of training                     | 4.4            |
| Methodology used during training         | 4.4            |
| Effectiveness of trainer                 | 4.3            |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The average ratings given to various aspects of the training indicate a high level of satisfaction among the beneficiaries. Both the duration of the training and the methodology used received the highest average rating of 4.4, suggesting that participants found the

structure and delivery of the course to be effective and engaging. The content and clarity of the training material, as well as the effectiveness of the trainer, were also rated positively at 4.3, reflecting overall confidence and satisfaction in the quality of instruction and materials provided. These consistently high ratings suggest that the training programme was well-designed and delivered in a way that met the learners' expectations.

The feedback on training quality and facilities reflects a highly positive response from the beneficiaries, **with 96% stating that the facilities were satisfactory**. This indicates that the infrastructure, labs, tools, and equipment provided were largely adequate to support effective learning for the beneficiaries. **Only 4% felt that while the facilities were adequate, there was room for improvement**, and none reported the facilities as being unsatisfactory. This suggests that the centre maintained a good standard in terms of learning resources. No specific challenges were reported by beneficiaries regarding training.

#### 4.2.2. Post-Training Outcomes

The employment profile of the beneficiaries indicates that 34% are employed, 9% are self-employed, while a majority of 57% remain unemployed. Although over one-third of the beneficiaries have secured formal employment, the relatively low rate of self-employment suggests limited entrepreneurial activity post-training. The high unemployment rate highlights ongoing challenges in translating vocational training into immediate economic opportunities.

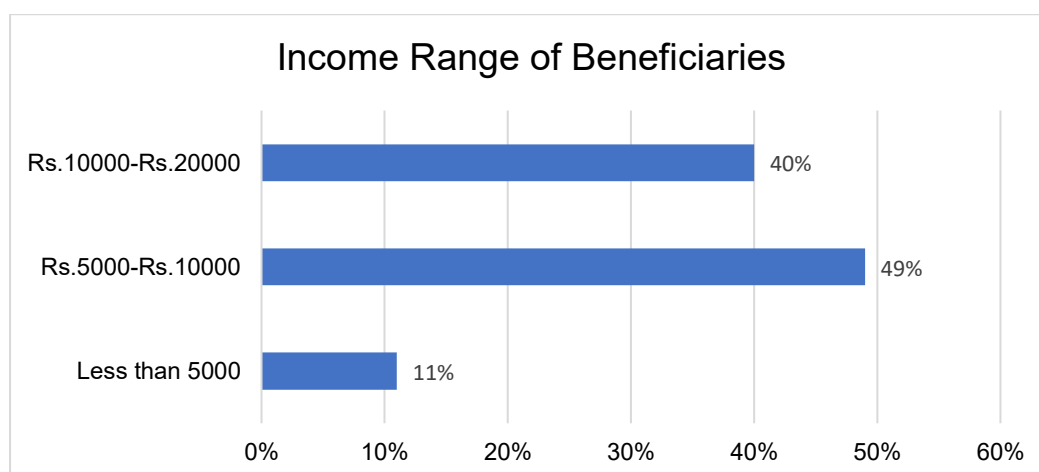
**Table 4.10: Employment Profile**

| Employment Profile | % of beneficiaries |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| Employed           | 34%                |
| Self-employed      | 9%                 |
| Unemployed         | 57%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

Furthermore, **96% of the employed and self-employed respondents stated that the training helped them in getting a job or starting a business**, indicating that the training was highly effective in enhancing employability and entrepreneurial readiness, regardless of formal placement support. **This suggests that the skill development and confidence gained through the training played a crucial role in enabling livelihood opportunities**, even for those who were not directly placed through the programme.

**Figure 4.8: Income Range of Beneficiaries**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

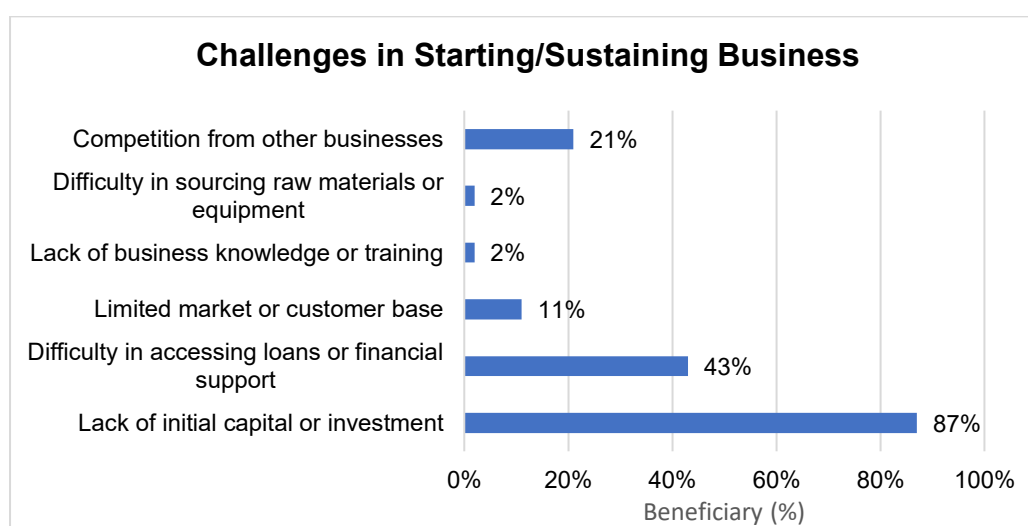


The primary data shows that **49% earn between Rs. 5,000–10,000**, followed by **40% earning Rs. 10,000–20,000**, indicating modest livelihoods. **11% earn less than Rs. 5,000**, highlighting a vulnerable section that may be in need of financial support.

Furthermore, the support provided to trainees under the BOSCO BIDS project was primarily focused on mentorship, with **94% of beneficiaries reporting having received guidance and handholding** as part of the training. However, other forms of support such as **market linkage and linkage with financial institutions or SHGs for business or loan support were limited**, indicating a gap in facilitating concrete business development or entrepreneurship opportunities.

Furthermore, out of the interviewed beneficiaries of this centre, none had received any financial assistance in the form of a grant/loan for their business as part of the project. The centre's data also reveals a significant gap in post-training financial support for beneficiaries. Out of a total of 1,209 trainees, only 5 individuals have received monetary assistance to support their entrepreneurial or business ventures.

**Figure 4.9: Challenges in Starting/Sustaining Business**



*Source: Primary data (2025)*

The most significant challenge, according to the primary data, reported by **87%** of respondents, is the **lack of initial capital or investment**, indicating that financial constraints are a primary barrier to business initiation and sustainability. This is followed by **difficulty in accessing loans or financial support (reported by 43% of the respondents)**, further emphasizing the role of financial exclusion. Notably, it has been reported in the previous sections that none of the interviewed beneficiaries had received any financial assistance in the form of a grant/loan for their business as a part of the project.

On the other hand, around 21% of respondents report competition from other businesses, and 11% report limited market or customer base, pointing to external market pressures. Very few respondents reported difficulty in sourcing raw materials or equipment or a lack of business knowledge or training, suggesting that infrastructure and skill gaps are not seen as major issues compared to financial and market-related challenges.

According to field data, only 28% experienced job placement follow-up, indicating a gap in employment linkage efforts. Furthermore, 72% mentioned no follow-up was taken at all.

### 4.2.3. Aspirations and Sustainability

**Table 4.11: Aspirations of Beneficiaries**

| Indicators                                                                                  | % of beneficiaries |    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----|
|                                                                                             | Yes                | No |
| Improvements in skills and confidence                                                       | 96%                | 4% |
| Enhanced respect or social standing in the community/family post-training/ post-employment? | 100%               | -  |
| Will the beneficiary recommend the training to others in the community                      | 100%               | -  |
| Aspiration to learn new skills in the future through similar vocational courses             | 100%               | -  |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The primary data presents a highly positive perception of the training program among beneficiaries. A significant **96%** reported improvements in **skills and confidence**, indicating the training effectively enhanced their capabilities. All beneficiaries expressed a willingness to **recommend the training** to others, reflecting high satisfaction. Similarly, all respondents showed an **aspiration to learn new skills** through similar vocational courses in the future. These indicators demonstrate the training's strong success in fostering empowerment, social recognition, and continued learning.

**Table 4.12: Impact of Training on Beneficiaries**

| Impact of the training on the lives of the beneficiaries                            | % of beneficiaries |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| I have started earning an income                                                    | 43%                |
| I feel more confident and socially respected                                        | 94%                |
| I am contributing financially to my family                                          | 40%                |
| I have started or joined an environment-friendly initiative as a part of green jobs | -                  |
| I have not experienced any noticeable change                                        | -                  |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

Around 43% of the surveyed beneficiaries of the centre have started earning an income, reflecting direct economic benefits from the training, while 40% contribute financially to their families, demonstrating enhanced household well-being. Overall, these outcomes highlight the training's effectiveness in enabling both social and economic advancement among beneficiaries.

The data reflects strong indicators of both project and beneficiary-level sustainability. All the employed and self-employed beneficiaries expressed confidence in sustaining their jobs or businesses in the long term, suggesting that the training has equipped them with not only the technical skills but also the confidence and resources required for self-reliance. Furthermore, the majority of the respondents (>90%) believe that the training centre has the capacity to continue supporting and training youth even after the project formally concludes. Thus, the project has created reduced dependency on external support and has enabled a self-sustaining ecosystem for future youth skill development and entrepreneurship.

### 4.3. St.Xavier's Vocational Training Center, Bishramganj

#### 4.3.1. Basic Beneficiary Details

The demographic profile of the beneficiaries reveals a predominantly young and female participant base, with 50% aged between 18–25 years and 78% being women. In terms of education, the majority have completed at least secondary education, with 33% being graduates and another 28% having studied up to the higher secondary level.

**Table 4.13: Basic Beneficiary Details**

| Indicators                | % of beneficiaries |
|---------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Age</b>                |                    |
| 18-25                     | 50%                |
| 26-35                     | 39%                |
| 36+                       | 11%                |
| <b>Level of education</b> |                    |
| Primary                   | 6%                 |
| Secondary                 | 33%                |
| Higher secondary          | 28%                |
| Graduate                  | 33%                |
| <b>Sex</b>                |                    |
| Female                    | 78%                |
| Male                      | 22%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 4.14: Profile of Vocational Courses opted by Beneficiaries**

| Course/Trade                       | % of beneficiaries |
|------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Sewing Machine Operator            | 67%                |
| Commercial Vehicle Driver Level -4 | 22%                |
| Four Wheeler Service Technician    | 11%                |

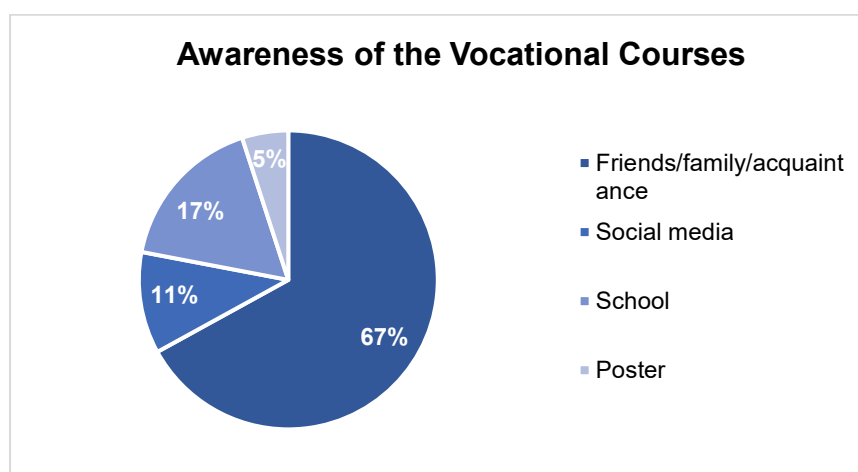
Source: Primary Data (2025)

The most popular course among the interviewed beneficiaries was Sewing Machine Operator (67%), followed by Commercial Vehicle Driver (Level -4), comprising 22% of the beneficiaries, and 11% opting for the Four Wheeler Service Technician Course.

#### 4.3.2. Project Awareness and Training Feedback

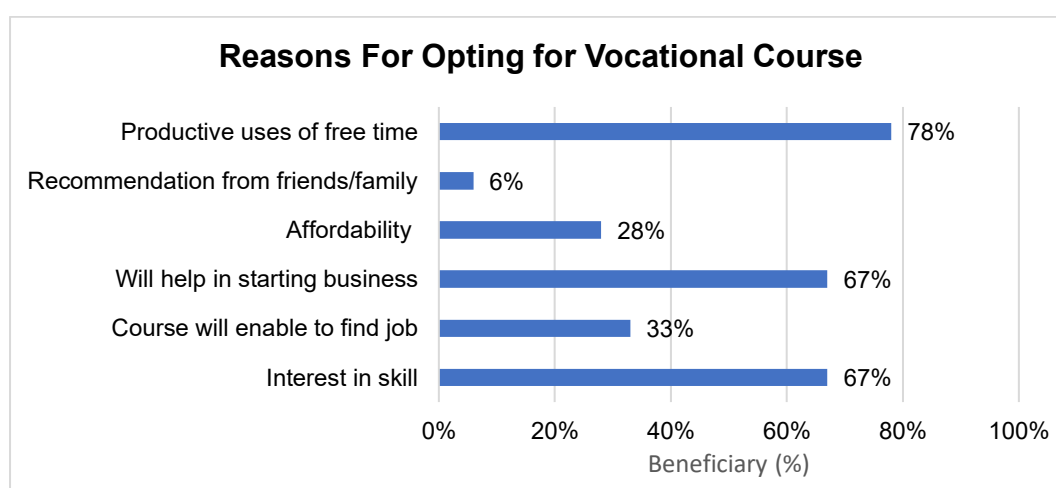
The data shows that informal social networks played the most significant role in spreading awareness about the project, with 67% of beneficiaries learning about it through friends, family, or acquaintances. This highlights the power of word-of-mouth communication in community-based outreach. Formal channels such as schools contributed to awareness for 17% of respondents, while digital outreach through social media accounted for only 11%, and posters had minimal reach at 5%. These findings suggest that future awareness strategies could focus on improving the effectiveness of digital and visual media to reach a broader and more diverse audience.

**Figure 4.10: Awareness of Vocational Courses**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Figure 4.11: Reasons for Opting for a Vocational Course**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

The data indicates that the primary motivation for enrolling in the vocational course was to make productive use of free time, cited by 78% of respondents. Equally strong drivers were the desire to start a business and interest in the skill itself, each mentioned by 67% of participants, highlighting a strong entrepreneurial and intrinsic learning orientation among the beneficiaries. About 33% chose the course for better job prospects, and 28% were influenced by its affordability. Interestingly, only 6% were motivated by recommendations from friends or family, suggesting that the decision to join was largely self-driven and based on personal goals rather than external persuasion.

Primary data suggests that the training program demonstrates strong relevance both to individual aspirations and regional economic needs. **95% of beneficiaries reported that the training aligned well with their personal interests and career goals**, indicating high levels of satisfaction and motivation. **72% affirmed that the training corresponded with local labour market demands**, while 30% felt it was only somewhat aligned.

**Table 4.15: Rating of Training Aspects by Beneficiaries**

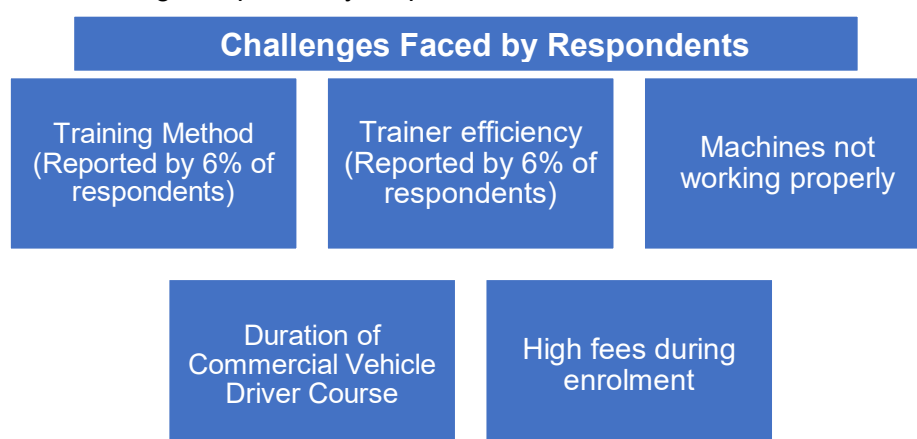
| Rating given to training aspects         | Average rating |
|------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Content and clarity of training material | 4.4            |
| Duration of training                     | 4.5            |
| Methodology used during training         | 4.7            |
| Effectiveness of trainer                 | 4.8            |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The overall feedback on the training aspects indicates a high level of participant satisfaction. The effectiveness of the trainer received the highest average rating of 4.8, suggesting that the trainer was highly effective in engaging participants and delivering the content clearly. The methodology used during the training also received a strong rating of 4.7, reflecting that participants appreciated the interactive and practical approach adopted during the sessions. The duration of the training and the clarity of the training material also received high ratings of 4.5 and 4.4, respectively, indicating that the course was well-structured and effectively delivered.

Furthermore, 89% of respondents reported that they found the training facilities (infrastructure, lab, tools, equipment) satisfactory, 11% reported that the facilities were satisfactory, but there was scope for improvement.

Some of the challenges reported by respondents have been listed below.



#### 4.3.3. Post-Training Outcomes

The employment status data of Bishramganj Centre shows that 6% of the surveyed beneficiaries are employed, while a larger proportion, 44%, are self-employed, and 50% remain unemployed. The relatively low formal employment rate suggests limited absorption into traditional job markets. However, the high rate of self-employment indicates a significant entrepreneurial inclination among the beneficiaries, reflecting their ability to leverage acquired skills to generate income independently. Still, with half of the beneficiaries unemployed, challenges persist in fully translating training into sustainable economic opportunities.

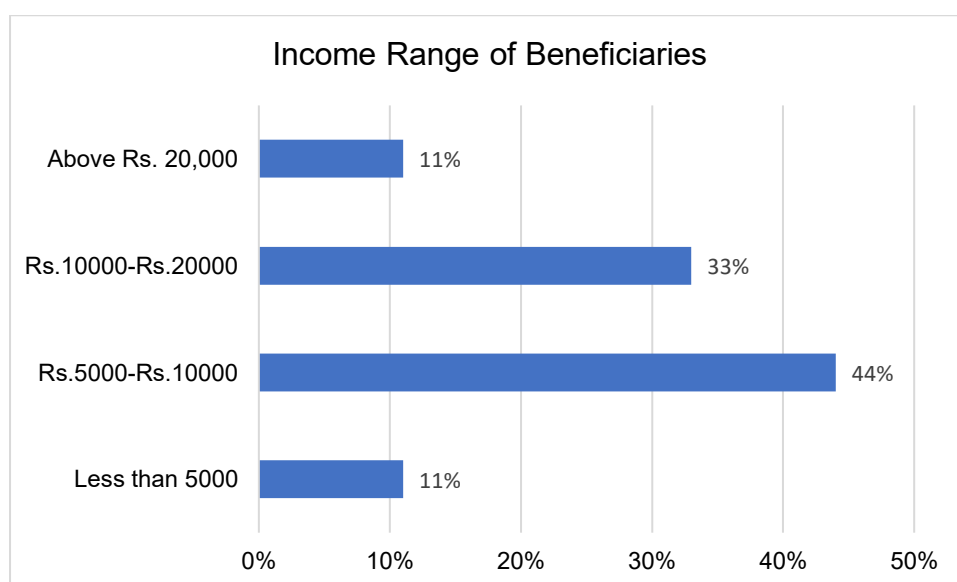
**Table 4.16: Employment Status of Respondents**

| Employment Status | Percentage |
|-------------------|------------|
| Employed          | 6%         |
| Self-employed     | 44%        |
| Unemployed        | 50%        |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

When asked whether the **training helped them secure their current job or start a business, 44% of the respondents agreed that it did help them, and 17%** reported that they were unsure. Furthermore, only 6% of the surveyed beneficiaries reported having received financial assistance (grant/loan) for their business as a part of the BIDS project. This indicates a critical gap in the program's support structure, as **94% of interviewed beneficiaries lacked access to essential financial assistance** needed to start or sustain their businesses.

This data reflects a mixed perception of the training's effectiveness in enabling employment or entrepreneurship. While nearly half of the beneficiaries acknowledged that the training was directly helpful, a significant 39% felt it had no impact, suggesting limitations in the practical relevance or application of the skills learned.

**Figure 4.12: Income Range of Beneficiaries**

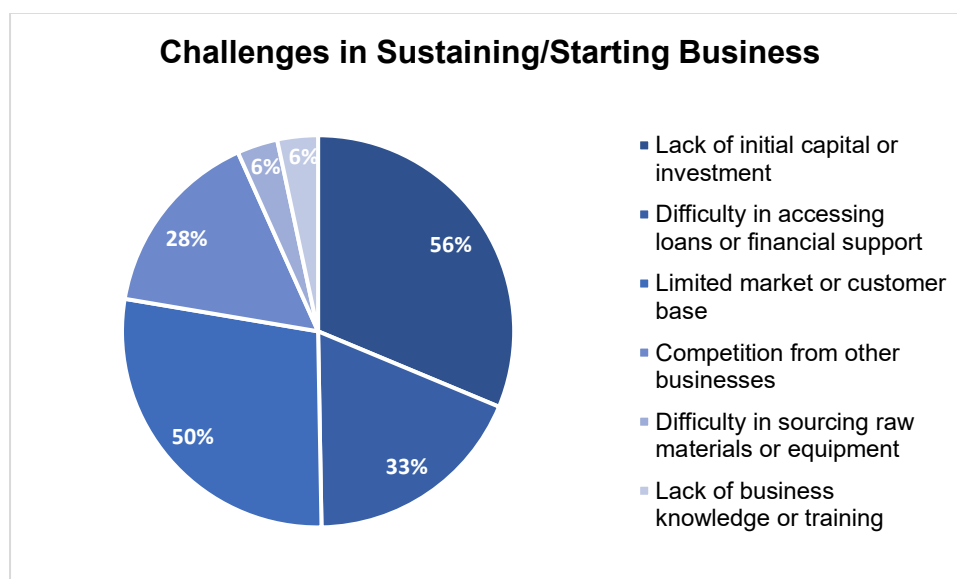
Source: Primary Data (2025)

The income distribution of the surveyed beneficiaries reveals that a majority, 56%, earn less than Rs. 5,000 per month, indicating low-income levels and limited financial stability despite having undergone training. Only 17% fall within the Rs. 5,000 – Rs. 10,000 range, and a smaller segment, 11%, earn Rs. 10,000 – Rs. 20,000, suggesting that relatively few beneficiaries have been able to secure moderate to stable earnings.

In terms of challenges, the primary data reveals that **lack of initial capital or investment (56%)** is the most common challenge faced by the surveyed beneficiaries in starting or sustaining their businesses, highlighting a critical need for financial support at the early stages. This is compounded by **difficulty in accessing loans or financial services**, reported by **33%**, indicating systemic barriers to credit. Around **50%** of the surveyed beneficiaries cited a **limited market or customer base**, pointing to poor market connectivity and inadequate demand generation. Furthermore, competition from other businesses also emerged as a notable challenge, along with difficulty in sourcing raw materials or equipment.

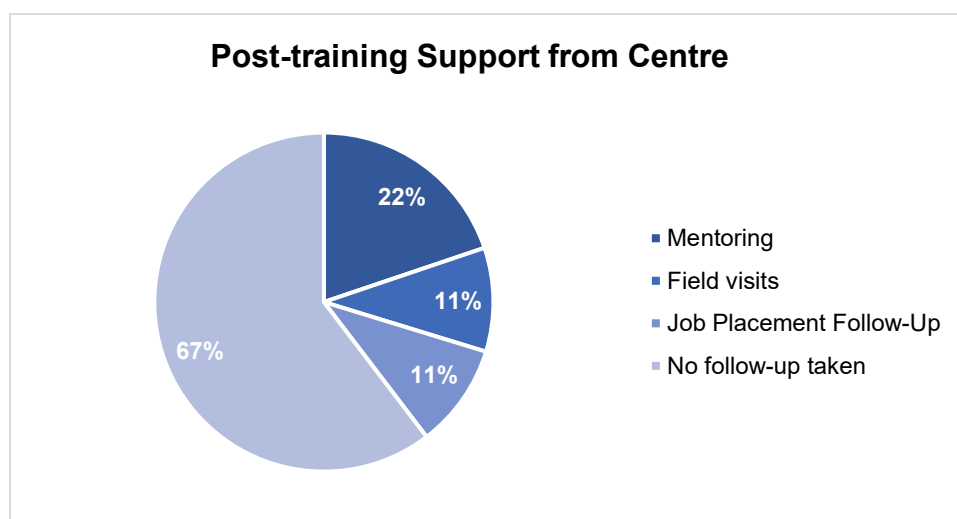
and a lack of business knowledge or training, shedding light on the gaps existing in operational support and entrepreneurship education.

**Figure 4.13: Challenges in Sustaining/Starting Business**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Figure 4.14: Post-Training Support from Centre**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

Primary data also reveals that **67%** of respondents reported that **no follow-up support** was provided after the training, indicating a serious shortfall in the program's continuity and support mechanisms. Only **22%** received **mentoring**, while **11%** each benefited from **field visits** and **job placement follow-up**. These low levels of structured support suggest that most beneficiaries were left to navigate employment or entrepreneurship challenges on their own after the training ended.

#### 4.3.4. Aspirations and Sustainability

The data highlights a fairly positive impact of the training program on beneficiaries. **94%** reported improvements in skills and confidence, while the remaining **6%** experienced partial improvement, indicating that nearly all participants gained something valuable from the training. In terms of social impact, **88%** felt an enhanced sense of respect or social



**standing** within their family or community post-training. **100% of respondents said they would recommend the training to others**, showcasing strong overall satisfaction and **83% expressed a clear aspiration to learn new skills through similar vocational courses**, with **17% being open to the idea**, suggesting a strong foundation for continued learning.

**Table 4.17: Aspirations of Beneficiaries**

| Indicators                                                                                  | % of beneficiaries |          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------|
|                                                                                             | Yes                | Somewhat |
| Improvements in skills and confidence                                                       | 94%                | 6%       |
| Enhanced respect or social standing in the community/family post-training/ post-employment? | 88%                | 12%      |
| Will the beneficiary recommend the training to others in the community                      | 100%               | -        |
| Aspiration to learn new skills in the future through similar vocational courses             | 83%                | 17%      |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

According to primary data, **half of the respondents reported having started earning an income**, indicating that the training effectively enabled income generation for the majority. Moreover, **72% of the employed and self-employed respondents are now contributing financially to their families**, showing that the program has had a tangible impact on household-level economic stability. However, **6% mentioned no noticeable change**, and another **6% engaged in green jobs or environment-friendly initiatives**, suggesting that while the overall impact is strong, a small segment either did not benefit significantly or chose alternative pathways.

**Table 4.18: Impact of Training on Respondents**

| Impact of the training on the lives of the beneficiaries                            | % of beneficiaries |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| I have started earning an income                                                    | 50%                |
| I feel more confident and socially respected                                        | 89%                |
| I am contributing financially to my family                                          | 50%                |
| I have not experienced any noticeable change                                        | 6%                 |
| I have started or joined an environment-friendly initiative as a part of green jobs | -                  |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

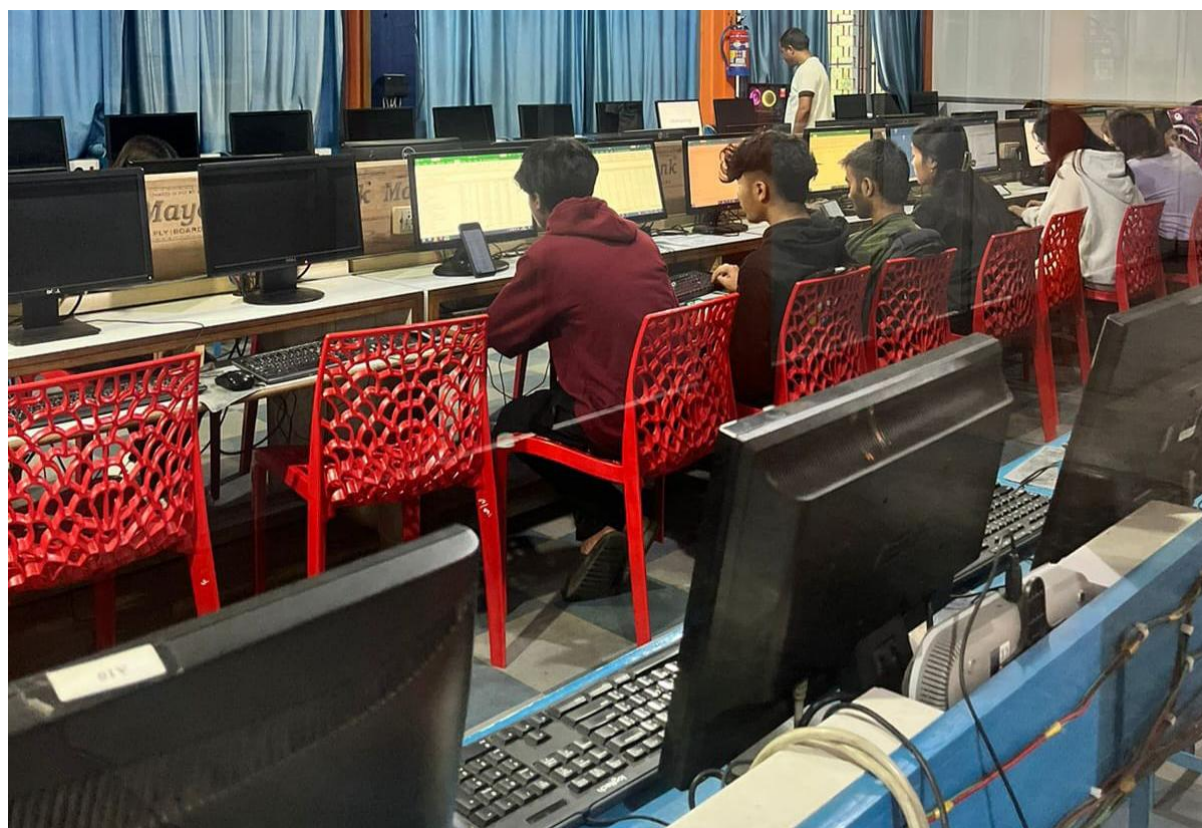
The data reflects a strong perception of sustainability from both the beneficiaries and the institutional side. A significant **78% of the employed and self-employed respondents expressed confidence** in their ability to sustain their **job or business in the long term**, indicating that the training not only equipped them with relevant skills but also fostered a sense of self-reliance and preparedness. Furthermore, **89% believe the training centre has the capacity** to continue providing skill development opportunities beyond the project period, suggesting faith in the centre's infrastructure, trainers, and operational capability. Together, these responses indicate that the program has made meaningful progress toward sustainable outcomes.

#### 4.3.5. Recommendations

The surveyed respondents of the Bishramganj centre have put forward the following recommendations.

**Table 4.19: Recommendations**

| Category                       | Recommendations by Respondents                                                          |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Placement Support</b>       | Improve the placement drive to ensure better job opportunities for trainees.            |
| <b>Training Infrastructure</b> | Provide more machines and improve training infrastructure (e.g., fan and ventilation).  |
| <b>Financial Support</b>       | Offer financial support during the training period to reduce the burden on trainees.    |
|                                | Provide financial assistance after training to help set up or sustain small businesses. |
| <b>Curriculum Enhancement</b>  | Include male clothing patterns in tailoring courses, not just female patterns.          |
| <b>Practical Learning</b>      | Make training more hands-on and practical.                                              |
| <b>Affordability</b>           | Reduce the fee structure to make the training more accessible.                          |



## 4.4. Don Bosco Peace Centre, Agartala

### 4.4.1. Basic Beneficiary Details

The data reveals that a significant majority of the beneficiaries fall within the 18–25 age group, indicating a predominantly young participant base, while only 7% are between 26–35 years and 21% are aged above 36. In terms of education, more than half have completed higher secondary education, followed by 26% with secondary education and 19% who are graduates. There are no beneficiaries with only primary education, suggesting a relatively educated group. The gender distribution is heavily skewed, with females making up 86% of the total beneficiaries, reflecting either a female-focused intervention or higher female participation in the initiative. Overall, the data points to a youthful, educated, and predominantly female demographic.

**Table 4.20: Basic Beneficiary Details**

| Indicators                | % of beneficiaries |
|---------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Age (years)</b>        |                    |
| 18-25                     | 72%                |
| 26-35                     | 7%                 |
| 36+                       | 21%                |
| <b>Level of education</b> |                    |
| Primary                   | 0%                 |
| Secondary                 | 26%                |
| Higher secondary          | 55%                |
| Graduate                  | 19%                |
| <b>Sex</b>                |                    |
| Female                    | 86%                |
| Male                      | 14%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 4.21: Profile of Vocational Courses opted by Beneficiaries**

| Course/trade                 | % of beneficiaries |
|------------------------------|--------------------|
| Domestic Data Entry Operator | 79%                |
| Craft baker                  | 12%                |
| Baking technician            | 9%                 |

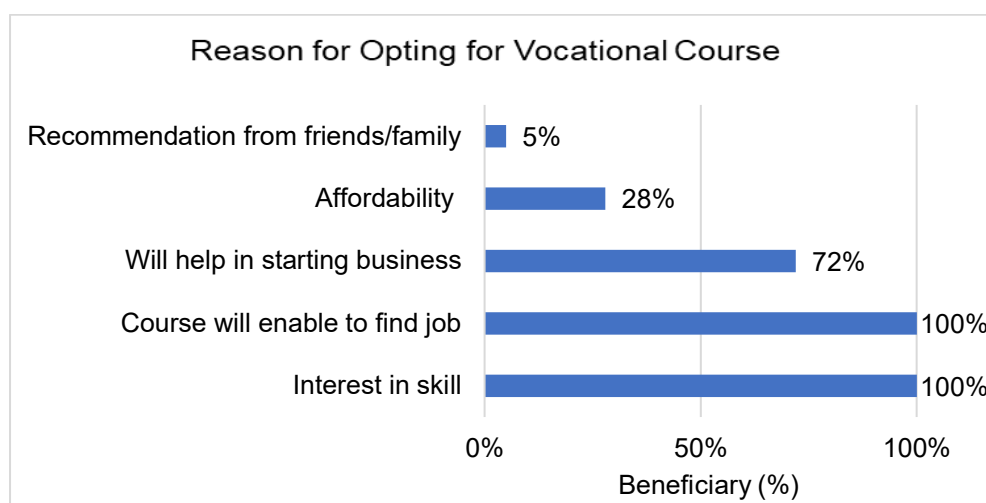
Source: Primary Data (2025)

Among the interviewed beneficiaries, the data shows that a large majority of beneficiaries, around 79% are enrolled in the Domestic Data Entry Operator course, indicating a strong preference or demand for digital and clerical skills training. In contrast, only 12% have taken up the Craft Baker course and 9% the Baking Technician course among the respondents.

### 4.4.2. Project Awareness and Training Feedback

Primary data indicates that the majority of the respondents (<90%) gained awareness about the project through word-of-mouth, through friends/acquaintances/family.

**Figure 4.15: Reasons for Opting for a Vocational Course**



Source: Primary data (2025)

The data shows that all the surveyed beneficiaries chose their course due to both interest in the skill and the belief that it would help them secure employment, indicating that personal motivation and career aspirations were equally strong drivers. A significant portion of 72% also considered the course as a step towards starting their own business, reflecting entrepreneurial intent among many participants. Affordability was a factor for 28% of respondents, showing that while cost played a role, it was not the primary motivator. Only 5% chose the course based on recommendations from friends or family, indicating that most decisions were self-driven.

Importantly, **all beneficiaries reported that the course they enrolled in aligned with their personal interests, long-term career goals, and prevailing labour market demands**, suggesting that the training provided was both relevant and purpose-driven.

**Table 4.22: Rating given by Respondents**

| Rating given to training aspects         | Average rating |
|------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Content and clarity of training material | 4.1            |
| Duration of training                     | 4.3            |
| Methodology used during training         | 4.3            |
| Effectiveness of trainer                 | 4.2            |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The feedback on training aspects indicates a consistently high level of satisfaction among participants. The methodology used and the duration of the training received the highest average ratings of 4.3, suggesting that the structure and delivery of the sessions were well-received. The effectiveness of the trainer also scored strongly at 4.2, reflecting confidence in the trainer's ability to engage and educate. Meanwhile, the content and clarity of training material received a slightly lower but still positive rating of 4.1, indicating room for minor improvements in the presentation or comprehensibility of the training materials. The ratings suggest a well-executed and impactful training programme.

Interestingly, all respondents reported that they found the training facilities satisfactory, and none had any complaints regarding the same. Furthermore, no challenges were reported. This indicates a highly positive training environment, where the infrastructure and support systems met or exceeded participant expectations. The absence of reported challenges suggests smooth implementation and effective management of the training program.

#### 4.4.3. Post-Training Outcomes

The employment profile shows a concerning trend, with **89% of beneficiaries still unemployed**, indicating minimal impact of the training on job placement. Only **4% are employed** and **7% are self-employed**, reflecting limited success in both wage and self-employment. This highlights a significant need for improved post-training support, market linkages, and follow-up mechanisms to ensure better livelihood outcomes.

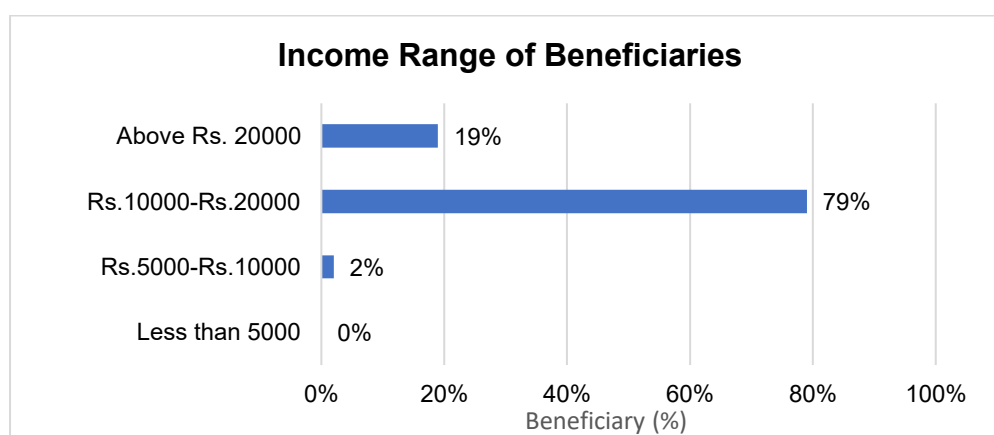
**Table 4.23: Employment Status of Respondents**

| Employment Profile | % of beneficiaries |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| Employed           | 4%                 |
| Self-employed      | 7%                 |
| Unemployed         | 89%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

However, while only 21% of the employed and self-employed respondents reported that their placement was facilitated directly by BIDS, and majority of these (employed and self-employed) surveyed beneficiaries acknowledged that the training provided by BIDS helped them secure their current job or start their business. This highlights the effectiveness and relevance of the training. It suggests that the skills and confidence gained through the programme played a crucial role in enabling beneficiaries to access livelihood opportunities independently.

**Figure 4.16: Income Range of Beneficiaries**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

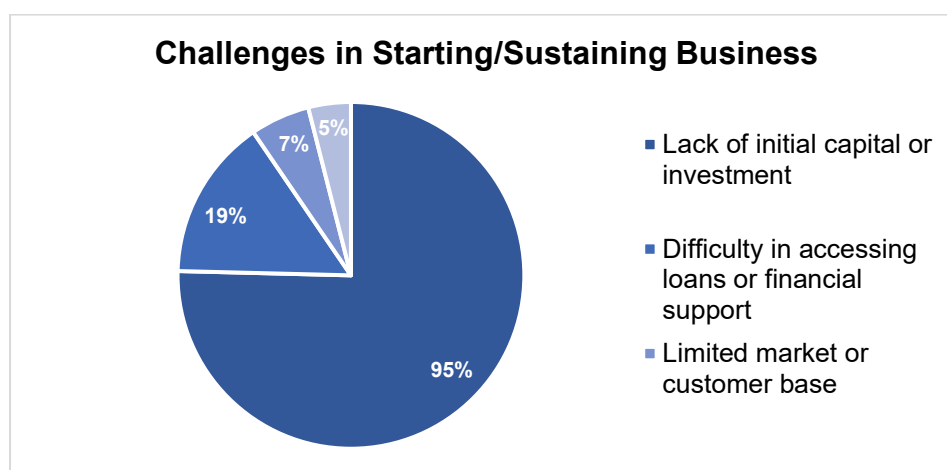
The income data reveals that a substantial **79% of the employed and self-employed respondents earn between Rs. 10,000 and Rs. 20,000**, indicating that the majority have achieved a modest but stable income level post-training. A smaller segment, **19%**, reported earning **above Rs. 20,000**, reflecting higher income potential among a few individuals, possibly due to better job roles or self-employment success. Only **2%** fall in the **Rs. 5,000–Rs. 10,000** bracket, and none earn **below Rs. 5,000**, suggesting that the training has effectively supported beneficiaries in crossing the low-income threshold.

Primary data also indicates that **none of the interviewed beneficiaries received direct financial assistance**, such as grants or loans for their business under the BIDS project. The centre's data also shows that only 2 of the total 356 trainees have received a monetary grant for starting businesses. However, all respondents reported receiving mentorship support, which suggests a strong emphasis on non-financial, capacity-building interventions by BOSCO BIDS. The universal provision of mentorship reflects the project's focus on guidance,



skill development and business preparedness, though the absence of financial assistance may pose a barrier for those looking to expand or invest in their ventures.

**Figure 4.17: Challenges in Starting/Sustaining Business**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

The primary data clearly shows that the most common challenge faced by respondents in starting or sustaining their business is **the lack of initial capital or investment, reported by 95% of the beneficiaries**. This aligns with the earlier finding that none of the respondents received any financial assistance (grants or loans) through the BIDS project. Without start-up capital, many aspiring entrepreneurs struggle to purchase equipment, raw materials or establish a physical setup, factors that are essential for launching or expanding a business.

19% reported difficulty in accessing loans or financial support, pointing to systemic barriers in formal credit access, such as lack of collateral, limited financial literacy, or procedural complexities. 7% cited a limited market or customer base, and 5% mentioned competition from other businesses, indicating that even among those who manage to start a business, sustainability and growth are constrained by external market dynamics. These findings shed light on the need for financial support mechanisms, including micro-loans, seed grants and better linkage with financial institutions to further supplement the training and mentorship provided.

The post-training support data reveals that only 2% reported receiving job placement follow-up, while the vast majority indicated that no follow-up was taken beyond mentoring. This suggests that there may be gaps in more structured post-training engagement such as field visits and placement tracking.

#### **4.4.4. Aspirations and Sustainability**

The field data reflects overwhelmingly positive outcomes from the training, both in terms of personal development and community perception. 95% of beneficiaries reported improvements in their skills and confidence, indicating that the training was effective in building individual capacities, while only 5% did not observe such changes. Impressively, 100% stated that they experienced enhanced respect or social standing within their families and communities after completing the training and securing employment, suggesting significant social empowerment. Additionally, 98% expressed willingness to recommend the training to others, showing strong satisfaction and perceived value of the programme. Furthermore, the fact that all respondents expressed aspirations to learn new skills in the future through similar vocational courses highlights both the programme's success and its potential to foster a culture of lifelong learning and self-improvement.

**Table 4.24: Aspirations of Beneficiaries**

| Indicators                                                                                  | % of beneficiaries |    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----|
|                                                                                             | Yes                | No |
| Improvements in skills and confidence                                                       | 95%                | 5% |
| Enhanced respect or social standing in the community/family post-training/ post-employment? | 100%               | -  |
| Will the beneficiary recommend the training to others in the community                      | 98%                | 2% |
| Aspiration to learn new skills in the future through similar vocational courses             | 100%               | -  |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The primary data indicates limited economic benefits, as only 7% have started earning an income, and an equal proportion contribute financially to their families. These findings highlight the need for enhanced support to translate these gains into broader economic outcomes such as income generation and financial contribution to households.

**Table 4.25: Impact of Training on Beneficiaries**

| Impact of the training on the lives of the beneficiaries | % of beneficiaries |
|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| I have started earning an income                         | 7%                 |
| I feel more confident and socially respected             | 98%                |
| I am contributing financially to my family               | 7%                 |
| I have not experienced any noticeable change             | -                  |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The findings strongly indicate a positive outlook on the **sustainability** of both individual livelihood outcomes and the training initiative itself. **The majority (98%) of the surveyed respondents (employed and self-employed only) expressed confidence in their ability to sustain their job or business in the long term**, which suggests that the training provided them not just with technical skills but also with the self-belief and practical knowledge required for long-term economic resilience.

Only one respondent provided a recommendation, stating that “[more courses should be introduced in my field of expertise, and the duration of the training should be increased.](#)” This feedback highlights the participant's interest in deeper, more specialized learning and suggests a demand for expanded course offerings and longer training periods to enhance skill mastery.



## 4.5. Don Bosco Tech, Nongstoin

### 4.5.1. Basic Beneficiary Details

The data reveals that nearly half of the respondents fall within the age group of 18–25 years, followed closely by 48% in the 26–35 years category, indicating that a large majority of the sample is comprised of young adults. Only a small proportion of 3% are aged 36 years and above, highlighting a limited representation of older individuals. In terms of educational qualifications, 33% of the respondents have completed secondary education, while 26% have attained higher secondary education, suggesting a significant portion has progressed beyond basic schooling. Graduates make up 22% of the sample, reflecting a fair level of higher education, whereas 19% have only primary education. Females constitute 88% of the respondents, compared to only 12% males, suggesting a focus on or higher participation of women in the surveyed group. This demographic profile points to a predominantly young and female population with varying levels of education, the majority of whom have at least completed secondary schooling.

**Table 4.26: Basic Beneficiary Details**

| Indicators                | % of beneficiaries |
|---------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Age (years)</b>        |                    |
| 18-25                     | 49%                |
| 26-35                     | 48%                |
| 36+                       | 3%                 |
| <b>Level of education</b> |                    |
| Primary                   | 19%                |
| Secondary                 | 33%                |
| Higher secondary          | 26%                |
| Graduate                  | 22%                |
| <b>Sex</b>                |                    |
| Female                    | 88%                |
| Male                      | 12%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 4.27: Vocations Opted by Respondents**

| Trade                                     | % of beneficiaries |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Craft baker                               | 23%                |
| Baking technician                         | 3%                 |
| Cake production                           | 3%                 |
| Electrician Domestic Solutions            | 6%                 |
| Four Wheeler Service Technician           | 29%                |
| Lead Carpenter - Wooden Furniture         | 3%                 |
| Manual Arc Welding and Shielded Metal Arc | 6%                 |
| Processed Food Entrepreneur               | 3%                 |
| sewing machine operator                   | 14%                |
| Street Food Vendor - Standalone           | 10%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

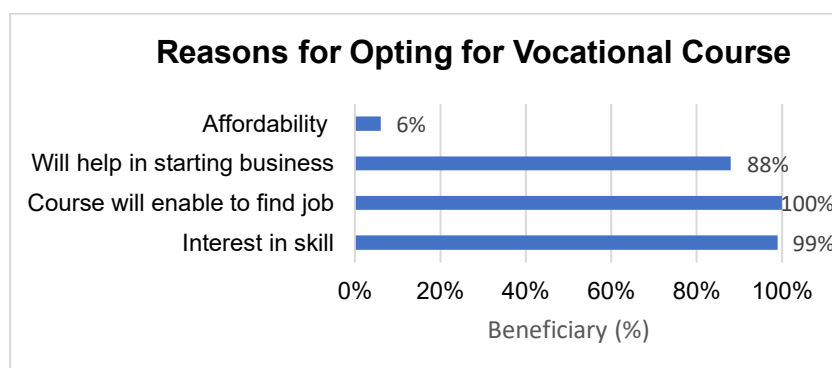
Primary data indicates that beneficiaries were trained across diverse trades, with the highest concentration in Four Wheeler Service Technician (29%) and Craft Baker (23%), suggesting high demand or interest in these sectors. Other notable trades include Sewing Machine Operator (14%) and Street Food Vendor (10%), reflecting a focus on self-employment and

livelihood enhancement. Trades like Electrician, Welding, and Cake Production had lower participation.

#### 4.5.2. Project Awareness and Training Feedback

Primary data indicates that **100% of the respondents gained awareness about the project through word-of-mouth, through friends/acquaintances/family**. To ensure wider and more consistent outreach, the training centres should consider adopting more structured outreach strategies, such as community meetings, local advertisements, social media and collaboration with local institutions or self-help groups.

**Figure 4.18: Reasons for Opting for Vocational Course**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

Primary data shows that a significant majority of respondents selected their course because they believed it would enable them to secure a job, while 88% viewed it as a pathway to starting their own business, reflecting a strong inclination towards income generation and self-reliance. Interestingly, 99% cited personal interest in the skill as a motivating factor, highlighting the importance of aligning training programs with participants' passions and aptitudes. In contrast, only 6% chose their course based on affordability, suggesting that financial considerations played a minimal role in decision-making compared to employment potential and skill relevance. Furthermore, all respondents reported that the courses were aligned with their career goals, personal interests, and the demands of the local labour market, shedding light on the relevance of the training provided.

**Table 4.28: Rating Given by Respondents**

| Rating given to training aspects         | Average rating |
|------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Content and clarity of training material | 4.3            |
| Duration of training                     | 4.2            |
| Methodology used during training         | 4.2            |
| Effectiveness of trainer                 | 4.2            |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The participants rated various aspects of the training highly, indicating overall satisfaction with the program. The **content and clarity of the training material** received the highest average rating of **4.3**, suggesting that the materials were well-structured and easy to understand. Other aspects, including the **duration of training**, **methodology used**, and the **effectiveness of the trainer**, were all rated at **4.2**, reflecting appreciation for the delivery and facilitation of the sessions.

Furthermore, 89% reported that the training facilities were satisfactory, indicating a high level of contentment with the infrastructure and resources provided during the training. However, 11% felt that while the facilities were adequate, there was scope for improvement. No challenges were reported, except 1% respondent reporting 'training method' as a challenge.

### 4.5.3. Post-Training Outcomes

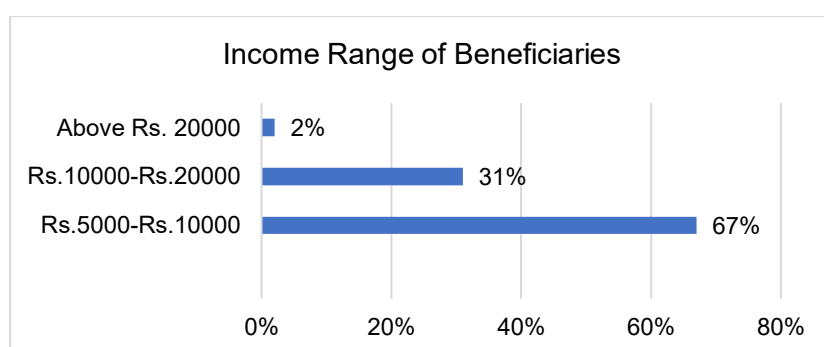
The employment profile shows that a majority of beneficiaries (53%) remain unemployed, highlighting the need for stronger post-training support and job linkages. 41% are employed full-time, indicating that some beneficiaries have successfully transitioned into stable jobs. However, only 6% are self-employed, suggesting limited entrepreneurial outcomes and a potential gap in support for starting or sustaining businesses.

**Table 4.29: Employment Status of Respondents**

| Employment Profile   | % of beneficiaries |
|----------------------|--------------------|
| Employed (full-time) | 41%                |
| Self-employed        | 6%                 |
| Unemployed           | 53%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

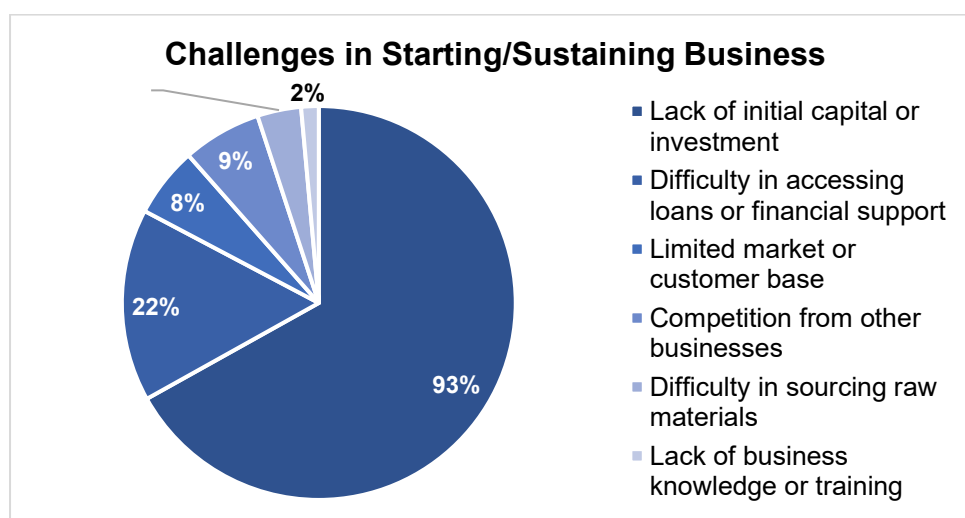
**Figure 4.19: Income Range of Beneficiaries**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

The income distribution shows that the majority of beneficiaries (**67%**) earn between **Rs. 5,000–10,000**, indicating low-income livelihoods. **31%** fall in the **Rs. 10,000–20,000** range, suggesting moderate earning capacity, while only **2%** earn **above Rs. 20,000**, reflecting limited access to higher-paying opportunities. This highlights the need to enhance skill levels and market linkages for better income outcomes. Primary data indicates that only 2% of the respondents received job placement follow-up, and no other post-training support mechanisms were reported.

**Figure 4.20: Challenges in Starting/ Sustaining Business**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

The data highlights that the most significant challenge faced by respondents in starting or sustaining their businesses is **the lack of initial capital or investment, reported by 93%**. This indicates that financial constraints are the primary barrier to entrepreneurship and business growth. 22% cited difficulty in accessing loans or financial support, further emphasizing the need for stronger financial linkages. Other challenges such as competition from other businesses, limited market or customer base and difficulty in sourcing raw materials were reported to a lesser extent. Only 2% mentioned a lack of business knowledge or training, suggesting that while skill development needs have largely been met, financial and market access remain critical areas requiring attention for the long-term sustainability of these enterprises.

#### 4.5.4. Aspirations and Sustainability

The data shows overwhelmingly positive outcomes from the training program. **Nearly all respondents, 98%, reported improvements in their skills and confidence, with only 2% indicating partial improvement.** 98% stated that they experienced enhanced respect and social standing in their family or community following the training or employment, highlighting the program's impact beyond just economic benefits. All respondents expressed a willingness to recommend the training to others in their community and showed interest in learning new skills through similar vocational courses in the future. These findings reflect the strong relevance and acceptance of the training, as well as its potential to inspire further skill development and create a ripple effect within the community.

**Table 4.30: Aspirations of Beneficiaries**

| Indicators                                                                                  | % of beneficiaries |          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------|
|                                                                                             | Yes                | Somewhat |
| Improvements in skills and confidence                                                       | 98%                | 2%       |
| Enhanced respect or social standing in the community/family post-training/ post-employment? | 98%                | 2%       |
| Will the beneficiary recommend the training to others in the community                      | 100%               | -        |
| Aspiration to learn new skills in the future through similar vocational courses             | 100%               | -        |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 4.31: Impact of Training on Beneficiaries**

| Impact of the training on the lives of the beneficiaries | % of beneficiaries |
|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| I have started earning an income                         | 46%                |
| I feel more confident and socially respected             | 87%                |
| I am contributing financially to my family               | 43%                |
| I have not experienced any noticeable change             | -                  |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The training appears to have had a positive impact on most beneficiaries, with 87% reporting increased confidence and social respect, reflecting strong personal and social gains. 46% have started earning, and 43% are now contributing financially to their families, indicating improved economic participation.

## 4.6. Don Bosco Tech, Silchar

### 4.6.1. Basic Beneficiary Details

The primary data shows that the majority of respondents, 73% are in the 18–25 age group, followed by 25% in the 26–35 group and only 2% above 36 years, indicating that the training primarily engaged youth. In terms of education, 48% have secondary education, 35% have completed higher secondary, and 17% are graduates, reflecting a fairly educated group of participants. The gender distribution is skewed towards males at 68%, with females making up 32%.

**Table 4.32: Basic Beneficiary Details**

| Indicators                | % of beneficiaries |
|---------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Age (years)</b>        |                    |
| 18-25                     | 73%                |
| 26-35                     | 25%                |
| 36+                       | 2%                 |
| <b>Level of education</b> |                    |
| Primary                   |                    |
| Secondary                 | 48%                |
| Higher secondary          | 35%                |
| Graduate                  | 17%                |
| <b>Sex</b>                |                    |
| Female                    | 32%                |
| Male                      | 68%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 4.33: Vocational courses Opted by Beneficiaries**

| Trade/Vocation                             | % of beneficiaries |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Accounts Executive                         | 8%                 |
| Domestic Data Entry Operator               | 10%                |
| Electrician Domestic Solutions             | 27%                |
| Graphic Designer                           | 10%                |
| Field Technician Computing and Peripherals | 14%                |
| Sewing Machine Operator                    | 15%                |
| Tally Acme                                 | 14%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

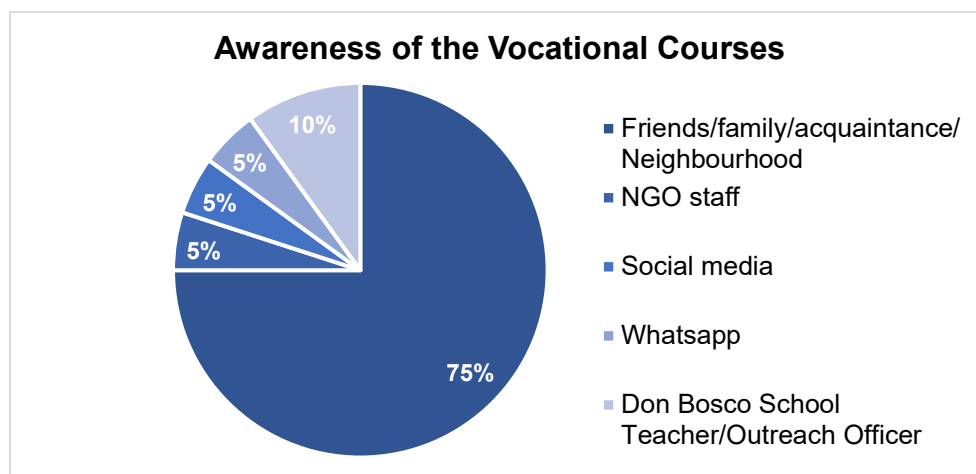
The trade-wise distribution shows that most beneficiaries were trained in Electrician Domestic Solutions (27%), followed by Sewing Machine Operator (15%), Field Technician and Tally Acme (14% each). This indicates a focus on technical and practical skills with employment potential. Trades like Data Entry Operator and Graphic Designer (10% each), and Accounts Executive (8%) also reflect demand for office-based and digital skills.

### 4.6.2. Project Awareness and Training Feedback

Primary data shows that informal social networks are the most significant source of awareness about vocational courses, with 75% of respondents learning about them through friends, family, acquaintances, or neighbours. Don Bosco School teachers and outreach officers accounted for 10%, suggesting some level of institutional involvement, though still relatively limited. Digital channels, including social media and WhatsApp, each contributed 5%, indicating emerging but still modest roles in spreading awareness. Similarly, NGO staff

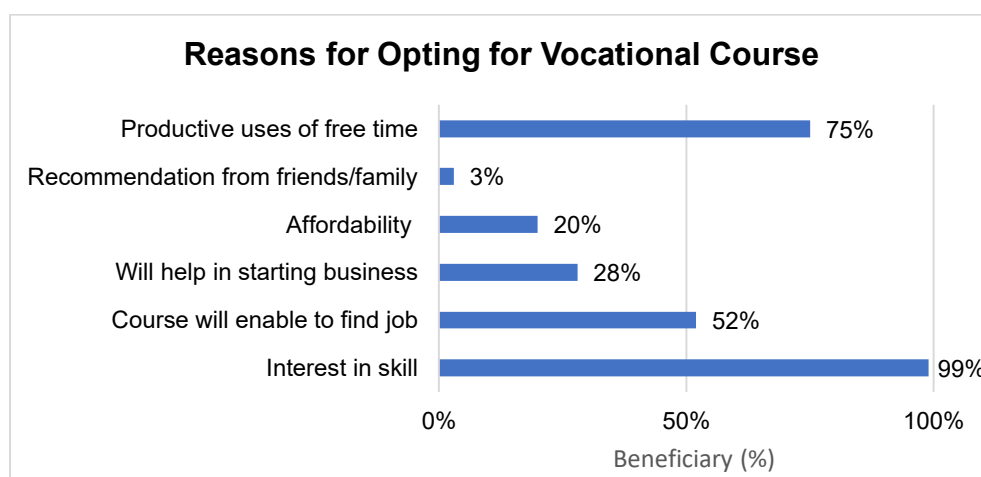
also influenced 5% of the respondents, pointing to a need for enhanced outreach strategies by civil society actors. The data highlights the dominant role of word-of-mouth communication, while also indicating an untapped potential in digital and institutional outreach efforts to broaden awareness of vocational education opportunities.

**Figure 4.21: Awareness of the Vocational Courses**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Figure 4.22: Reasons for Opting for Vocational Courses**



Source: Primary Data (2025)

Primary data also indicates that the primary motivation for choosing the vocational course was a strong interest in the skill, reported by 99% of respondents. Furthermore, 75% saw the course as a productive use of their free time, reflecting a desire to engage in meaningful learning rather than remaining idle. Around 52% of these respondents chose the course with the expectation that it would help them secure a job, highlighting employment as a key outcome. Meanwhile, 28% were motivated by the course's potential to aid in starting a business. Affordability influenced 20% of participants, suggesting that economic feasibility was an important factor for some.

**Table 4.34: Training Alignment with Interests and Market**

| Parameter                                   | Response |          |          |
|---------------------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
| Training alignment with career goals        | Yes      | Somewhat |          |
|                                             | 90%      | 10%      |          |
| Training alignment with labour market needs | Yes      | No       | Somewhat |
|                                             | 57%      | 33%      | 10%      |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The data indicates a generally positive perception of the training's relevance. 90% of respondents felt the training aligned with their career goals, while 10% felt it aligned only somewhat, suggesting that most participants saw clear value in how the training could support their future aspirations. However, when asked more broadly about training alignment with labour market needs, only 57% responded yes, while a notable 33% said no, and 10% said somewhat. The fact that 33% responded negatively to this broader alignment suggests a gap between the skills being taught and actual employment opportunities or industry demands. This disconnect could point to a need for better coordination between training providers and market trends to ensure that skills imparted are not only personally meaningful but also economically viable.

**Table 4.35: Rating Given By Respondents**

| Rating given to training aspects         | Average rating |
|------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Content and clarity of training material | 4.4            |
| Duration of training                     | 4.4            |
| Methodology used during training         | 4.4            |
| Effectiveness of trainer                 | 4.4            |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The uniform average rating of 4.4 across all key training aspects- content and clarity of materials, duration, methodology, and trainer effectiveness, indicates a consistently high level of satisfaction among participants. This suggests that the training program was well-structured, delivered effectively, and met learners' expectations in terms of both quality and delivery.

**Table 4.36: Satisfaction regarding training facilities**

| Satisfaction regarding training facilities                           | % of beneficiaries |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Training facilities were satisfactory                                | 85%                |
| Training facilities were adequate but there is scope for improvement | 13%                |
| Training facilities were not upto the mark                           | 2%                 |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The data also shows a high level of satisfaction with the training facilities, with 85% of beneficiaries finding them satisfactory, indicating that the infrastructure and resources met the general expectations of most participants. However, 13% felt that while the facilities were adequate, there was scope for improvement, pointing to specific areas that may need enhancement. A small fraction, 2%, found the facilities not up to the mark, suggesting isolated instances of dissatisfaction.



**Table 4.37: Challenges Faced During Training**

| Challenges Faced by Trainees                            | % of beneficiaries |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Training Method                                         | 8%                 |
| Trainer efficiency                                      | 18%                |
| Relevance of curriculum                                 | 2%                 |
| Reduction of cultural activities during training period | 2%                 |
| Difficulty in mobility to training centre               | 3%                 |
| Language barrier                                        | 3%                 |
| Inability to take leave                                 | 2%                 |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The challenges faced by trainees highlight some critical areas for improvement in the training program. The most significant concern was trainer efficiency, cited by 18% of beneficiaries, indicating a need for more skilled or engaging trainers. Issues with the training method were reported by 8%, suggesting that the pedagogical approach may not have been suitable or interactive enough for all learners. Other challenges were less widespread but still noteworthy: language barriers and difficulty in mobility each affected 3%, pointing to accessibility issues. Meanwhile, concerns like the reduction of cultural activities, irrelevant curriculum, and inability to take leave each affected 2% of participants. Though these percentages are relatively low, they reveal specific, actionable areas that can be addressed to enhance inclusivity, relevance and the overall training experience.

#### 4.6.3. Post-Training Outcomes

The employment data reveals that **76% of beneficiaries remain unemployed**, indicating a major gap between training and job placement. Only **15% are employed** and **9% are self-employed**, suggesting limited absorption into the workforce and low entrepreneurial outcomes. This highlights the need for stronger post-training support, job linkages, and livelihood enablement to improve employment outcomes.

**Table 4.38: Status of Employment of Respondents**

| Employment Profile | % of beneficiaries |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| Employed           | 15%                |
| Self-employed      | 9%                 |
| Unemployed         | 76%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The reasons for unemployment among beneficiaries reveal several recurring themes. A significant number reported being **still engaged in higher education**, indicating that **academic commitments are a primary barrier to employment**. Some participants mentioned **incomplete training**, which limited their ability to seek work, while one individual cited **lack of communication skills** as a personal challenge. **Financial problems** also emerged as a constraint, potentially affecting both job search efforts and mobility. One beneficiary noted **quitting a job secured through placement due to accommodation issues**, and another mentioned being **unemployed by choice**. Overall, the reasons reflect a mix of **academic priorities, skill gaps, personal constraints and logistical challenges**, which need to be addressed through flexible training schedules, post-training support and soft skills development to improve employability outcomes.

**Table 4.39: Income Range of Beneficiaries**

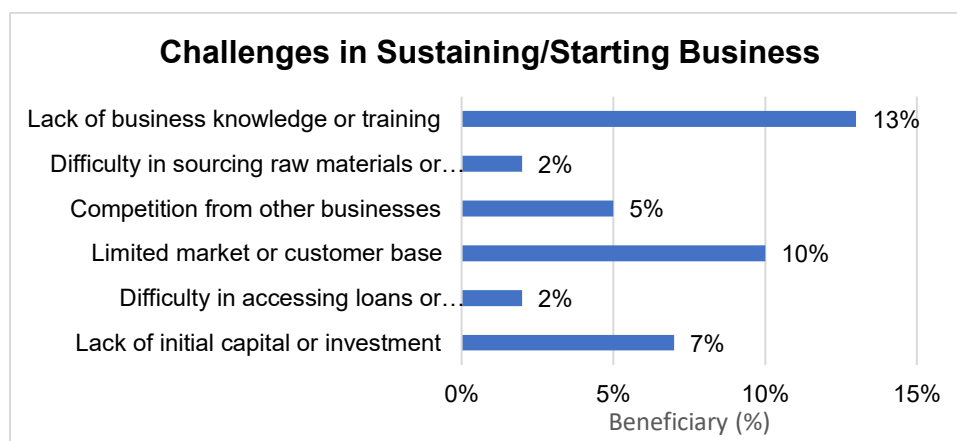
| Income range      | % of beneficiaries |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| Less than 5000    | 40%                |
| Rs.5000-Rs.10000  | 8%                 |
| Rs.10000-Rs.20000 | 35%                |
| Above Rs. 20000   | 17%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The income distribution among beneficiaries shows that a significant 40% earn less than Rs. 5000 per month, indicating a large section is still struggling with low earnings despite undergoing training. While 35% fall in the Rs. 10,000–Rs. 20,000 bracket, suggesting some level of economic improvement, only 17% have crossed the Rs. 20,000 threshold, reflecting limited high-income outcomes. 8% earn between Rs. 5000 and Rs. 10,000, showing a narrow middle band. The primary data indicates modest income gains for most beneficiaries, with a considerable proportion still earning below sustainable levels.

When asked about the usefulness of the training in securing a job or starting a business, **28%** said the training **did not help**, reflecting a significant gap between the skills imparted and real-world applicability. Another **18%** felt the training **somewhat helped**, indicating partial relevance or insufficient practical exposure. However, **54%** stated that the training **directly helped them**, showing that for half of the respondents, the program had a meaningful impact on their employment or entrepreneurial journey. This mixed outcome highlights the need to enhance the curriculum's alignment with labour market demands and offer more hands-on learning experiences.

Furthermore, none of the beneficiaries received any financial assistance, such as grants or loans for starting or supporting their businesses as part of the BIDS project. This is a critical gap, as access to finance is often a major barrier for self-employment or entrepreneurship.

**Fig 4.23: Challenges in Sustaining/Starting Business**

Source: Primary data (2025)

The challenges faced by beneficiaries in starting or sustaining their businesses highlight key barriers to entrepreneurial success. The most commonly reported issue was a limited market or customer base (10%), indicating that many struggled to generate consistent demand for their products or services. Lack of initial capital or investment, cited by 7%, emerged as another major obstacle, reflecting the critical need for seed funding at the early stages of business development. Competition from other businesses affected 5%, suggesting that market saturation or lack of differentiation may hinder sustainability. 2% faced difficulties in accessing loans or financial support, and another 2% reported problems in sourcing raw

materials or equipment, pointing to operational and financial bottlenecks. These challenges underline the need for improved market linkages, access to finance, business mentoring, and support systems to enhance the viability and growth of small enterprises.

**Table 4.40: Post-Training Support from Centre**

| Post-Training Support from Centre | % of beneficiaries |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------|
| Mentoring                         | 27%                |
| Field visits                      | 7%                 |
| Job Placement Follow-Up           | 28%                |
| No follow-up taken                | 58%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The data on post-training support reveals significant gaps in follow-up and engagement with beneficiaries. While 28% of the surveyed beneficiaries received job placement follow-up and 27% benefited from mentoring, these support services reached only about a quarter of the participants. Additionally, 7% reported having field visits, which can be crucial for practical exposure and sustained guidance. However, a concerning 58% of beneficiaries stated that no follow-up was taken after the training, indicating a major shortfall in post-training support mechanisms.

The nature of business support received from BOSCO BIDS shows a strong emphasis on mentorship, with 97% of beneficiaries reporting that they received guidance and handholding during the training period. This suggests that the program was highly effective in providing ongoing support to build confidence and improve the entrepreneurial or employment readiness of the participants. However, only 5% reported receiving market linkage support, and a mere 2% were connected to banks, SHGs, or financial institutions for loans or business assistance.

#### 4.6.4. Aspirations and Sustainability

According to primary data, 74% reported improvements in skills and confidence, with another 18% indicating somewhat, highlighting that over 90% experienced at least some growth in personal capacity. In terms of social recognition, 83% noted enhanced respect in their community or family post-training or employment, suggesting that the program not only improved employability but also boosted social standing. A strong 97% of participants would recommend the training to others, reflecting high overall satisfaction. However, when it comes to future aspirations, only 50% expressed clear interest in learning new skills through similar vocational courses, while 33% were unsure and 17% uninterested, indicating that while the current program was well-received, continued motivation for upskilling may require more engaging or better upskilling.

**Table 4.41: Aspirations of Beneficiaries**

| Indicators                                                                                 | % of beneficiaries |          |       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------|-------|
| Improvements in skills and confidence                                                      | Yes                | Somewhat | No    |
|                                                                                            | 74%                | 18%      | 8%    |
| Enhanced respect or social standing in the community/family post-training/ post-employment | Yes                | Not sure | No    |
|                                                                                            | 83%                | 10%      | 7%    |
| Will the beneficiary recommend the training to others in the community                     | Yes                | No       |       |
|                                                                                            | 97%                | 3%       |       |
| Aspiration to learn new skills in the future through similar vocational courses            | Yes                | No       | Maybe |
|                                                                                            | 50%                | 17%      | 33%   |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 4.42: Impact of Training on Beneficiaries**

| Impact of the training on the lives of the beneficiaries                            | % of beneficiaries |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| I have started earning an income                                                    | 27%                |
| I feel more confident and socially respected                                        | 73%                |
| I am contributing financially to my family                                          | 27%                |
| I have not experienced any noticeable change                                        | 13%                |
| I have started or joined an environment-friendly initiative as a part of green jobs | 7%                 |
| It has developed my life skills/technical skills                                    | 5%                 |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The primary data highlights that 27% of respondents state that they have started earning an income, and 27% now contribute financially to their families. A notable 73% reported feeling more confident and socially respected, reflecting strong psychosocial benefits of the program. However, 13% mentioned they did not experience any noticeable change, suggesting that the training outcomes were not uniform and may not have been effective for all participants.

**Table 4.43: Sustainability of the Training Centre**

| Aspect                                                 | Response | % of Beneficiaries |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------|
| <b>Training Centre's Capacity to Continue</b>          | Yes      | 70%                |
|                                                        | Not Sure | 23%                |
|                                                        | No       | 7%                 |
| <b>Confidence in Sustaining Job/Business Long-Term</b> | Yes      | 53%                |
|                                                        | Somewhat | 37%                |
|                                                        | No       | 10%                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

The findings present a **cautiously optimistic view** of sustainability. A **strong majority** believe that the training centre has the capacity to continue functioning post-project, which suggests **confidence in institutional readiness and infrastructure**. However, the **23% who are unsure** and **7% who believe it cannot continue** highlight **gaps in communication, funding stability, or strategic clarity** that need to be addressed for full confidence in long-term operations.

On the individual level, **53% of beneficiaries feel confident** in their ability to **sustain their jobs or businesses**, suggesting that the training has had a positive impact for over half the participants. However, the **37% who feel only “somewhat” confident** and the **10% who lack confidence entirely** signal that a considerable portion of trainees face **ongoing barriers** such as unstable incomes, market access issues, or lack of continued support.

Together, these insights suggest that while the foundation for sustainability exists, it is not yet fully secured. For long-term sustainability, both the training centres and beneficiaries require continued investment in institutional strengthening, clear sustainability planning, and ongoing support mechanisms such as mentorship, market integration, and financial access.

#### 4.6.5. Recommendations

The surveyed beneficiaries of Silchar centre also suggested the following recommendations to enhance the effectiveness and reach of future training interventions.

**Table 4.44: Recommendations by Respondents**

| Category                               | Recommendation by Respondents                                                       |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Curriculum Enhancement</b>          | Improve and update the curriculum for technical/repairing courses                   |
|                                        | Provide advanced training in data entry                                             |
|                                        | Introduce gents' clothing patterns in tailoring course                              |
|                                        | Increase coding/programming-related courses                                         |
|                                        | Refine and structure the course content more effectively                            |
|                                        | Focus more on curriculum rather than co-curricular activities                       |
| <b>Practical Learning</b>              | Make the course more practical and skill-oriented                                   |
|                                        | Provide advanced and hands-on training                                              |
| <b>Training Quality</b>                | Improve teaching methods to enhance understanding of technical mechanisms           |
|                                        | Replace trainers who are not effective or responsible                               |
| <b>Training Infrastructure</b>         | Improve quality of machinery and training equipment                                 |
|                                        | Extend the duration of training for better learning outcomes                        |
|                                        | Improve facilities for electrical-related courses                                   |
| <b>Placement Support</b>               | Strengthen post-training placement efforts                                          |
|                                        | Improve placement support for multimedia students                                   |
|                                        | Provide better salary packages during placement                                     |
| <b>Flexibility &amp; Accessibility</b> | Allow use of mobile phones during training for students pursuing distance education |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

***CHAPTER 5***  
**FINDINGS: BOSCO TVET  
CENTRES**

## 5.1. Outcomes of project indicators

The performance of the project was systematically assessed using key indicators (as per the data provided by the BIDS office, Shillong), with outcomes summarized below. Table 5.1 presents a clear overview of achievements in relation to the set targets.

**Table 5.1: Findings of Project Indicators**

| Indicators                                                                                    | Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>10,000 young people improve income and future opportunities through quality education</b>  | <p>The total number of youth trained in the project is <b>8180</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Agartala: 356 (4%)</li> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Bishramganj: 405 (5%)</li> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Jowai: 1209 (15%)</li> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Nongstoin: 1332 (16%)</li> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Shillong: 3811 (47%)</li> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Silchar: 1067 (13%)</li> </ul>                                                                           |
| <b>6,000 young people find employment</b>                                                     | <p>According to the placement records provided, a total of <b>1,520</b> trainees across 6 centres have successfully secured placements and are employed.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Shillong: 655 (43%)</li> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Silchar: 302 (20%)</li> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Nongstoin: 438 (28%)</li> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Bishramganj: 9 (1%)</li> <li>• Bosco Pnar, Jowai: 104 (7%)</li> <li>• Don Bosco Tech, Agartala: 12 (1%)</li> </ul> |
| <b>1,000 young people work independently/are self-employed</b>                                | <p>According to the self-employment records provided, <b>1645</b> trainees are self-employed post-training. Out of these trainees, 68% are females and 32% are males.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• DBTS, Shillong: 912 (55%)</li> <li>• Bishramganj Centre: 109 (7%)</li> <li>• Agartala Centre: 10 (1%)</li> <li>• Bosco Pnar, Jowai: 131 (8%)</li> <li>• Nongstoin Centre: 353 (21%)</li> <li>• Silchar centre: 130 (8%)</li> </ul>                                 |
| <b>At least 6,000 youth (60% incl. 30% women) in long-term employment or higher positions</b> | <p>1,520 trainees are placed, out of which 476 are female, accounting for approximately 31% of total placements. These youth are primarily employed in entry-level positions within technical roles.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>500 youth supported in micro-enterprise setup</b>                                          | <p>Between 2022 and 2024, a total of 195 youth were supported in setting up micro-enterprises across various trades through Project Entrepreneurship Hub. Of these, 72% were females and 28% were males. The financial support provided ranged from ₹6,400 to ₹25,000, with ₹25,000 being the most commonly awarded amount. The supported trades included bakery, mobile repairing, fashion designing, fast food, beauty and wellness, and cake specialization.</p>                   |



|                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>18 modular curricula aligned to NSQF</b>                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• A total of 38 job roles/modules have been aligned with NSQF, out of the 58 job roles/modules that were originally proposed in the project. Some modules were not approved due to several key reasons identified during the review process. These include repetition of job role names across sectors, course titles not aligning with official NSQF nomenclature, incorrect or inconsistent naming of modules, and certain job roles being deactivated or removed from the NSQF list. As a result, only those modules that met the required standards and alignment with the NSQF framework were retained and approved for implementation.</li> <li>• Following the 2024 review of job roles, several Qualification Pack (QP) levels were revised across key sectors to better align with the evolving demands of both beneficiaries and the job market. The QP levels were revised in the following sectors: Apparel, Automotive, Capital Goods Skill Council, Furniture &amp; Fitting Skill Sector, Water Management &amp; Plumbing Skill Sector, Skill Council for Green Jobs, IT &amp; ITeS Skill Council, and Tourism &amp; Hospitality.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Centers cover 50% of running costs</b>                       | Only Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong has been able to cover 50% of running costs.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>600 trained annually in postgraduate certificate courses</b> | The project was designed to train 600 beneficiaries annually (thus, a total of 1800) through postgraduate certificate courses. To date, a total of 1,053 youth have been trained under these particular certificate courses.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Average income of employed graduates: €96–€180</b>           | The average CTC salary of all placed trainees is ₹9271.44/month, which meets the lower band of the project's objective of €96–€180 (approximately ₹8,640–₹16,200), indicating progress toward the target while highlighting scope for further income enhancement to align with the upper range.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Tracking of all employed graduates for 1 year</b>            | Post-training tracking records from the centres are available; however, they do not cover a full one-year period.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Target income for self-employed: €72–€96/month</b>           | The average monthly income of self-employed trainees is ₹8375, which falls in the project's target range of €72–€96 per month (approximately ₹6,480–₹8,640).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>1,500 youth guided to govt. entrepreneurship schemes</b>     | A total of 24 trainees have received support in the form of loans or grants through various schemes and institutions, including KVIC, Prime Hub, SHG Loans, PMEGP, CM E-Championship (PRIME), North East Venture Jorhat Hub (NEC-funded), MUDRA, and personal/auto loans from banks and financial institutions such as SBI, MRB, UBI, Gramin Bank, and Bajaj Finserv. Of these, 14 are from Don Bosco Tech, Shillong, 8 from Don Bosco Tech, Nongstoin, and 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

|                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                        | from Don Bosco Tech, Bishramganj.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Accreditation of the 6 centres</b>                                  | Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong, Don Bosco Tech Nongstoin, and Bosco Tech Silchar centers have successfully attained certification from the National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC), demonstrating compliance with national quality standards for skill training.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>6 centers registered under the State Skill Development Missions</b> | Three training centres, Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong, Don Bosco Tech Nongstoin, and Bosco Pnar, Jowai have been empaneled under the Skill Meghalaya and have received Certificate of Empanelment as a Training Partner under Meghalaya Skill Development Society, Department of Labour.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Role distribution between BIDS and the six centres</b>              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• The project is fully managed and handled by BIDS, Shillong. The six training centres carry out the training programs with support from BIDS.</li> <li>• All staff are appointed and paid by BIDS, and expenses such as program running costs, office maintenance, stationery, and daily operations are also covered by BIDS.</li> <li>• BIDS manages the budget for all activities and programs. The main responsibility of the local centres is to conduct training classes, mobilize students, and coordinate with the central BIDS team for organizing workshops, seminars, entrepreneurship trainings, job fairs, campus recruitment drives, and similar events.</li> </ul> |

Source: Project Documents

## 5.2. Stakeholder Analysis

The stakeholders consulted for this study included Centre Directors, Trainers, and BIDS Staff (Centre Coordinators and Outreach Officers) from the six training centres, as well as employers who have hired trainees from these centres. They were engaged to provide insights on their roles in the project, the challenges they encountered, and the opportunities identified. A detailed account of these insights is provided in Annexure-1.

### 5.2.1. Key takeaways from Centre Directors

#### Administrative and Strategic Role of Centre Directors

- The Centre Directors were deeply involved in administrative planning, curriculum design, trainer recruitment, monitoring, and evaluation, ensuring operational alignment with project goals.
- They served as critical liaisons between the implementing body (BIDS) and the centres, which helped streamline communication and oversight across different implementation levels.

#### Labour Market Alignment Needs Strengthening

- Only the Shillong centre reported strong alignment with the local labour market; the others (Pnar, Agartala, Bishramganj) were only partially aligned.

- Directors emphasized the need for regular labour market assessments to ensure courses remain relevant and in sync with evolving industry demands, especially at the local and regional level.

### **Trainer Recruitment and Capacity Building Varies**

- Centres used a mix of external and internal trainer recruitment strategies, with some relying heavily on internal staff trained by BOSCO. The variance in trainer selection methods reflects differing capacities across centres. Standardizing recruitment based on qualifications and updating training content could enhance delivery quality.

### **Role of Infrastructure**

- Three centres (Shillong, Nongstoin, Silchar) were NSDC-accredited centres, aided by significant infrastructure and equipment upgrades.
- Other centres faced accreditation challenges due to infrastructural deficits or low enrolment, suggesting that physical infrastructure is directly linked to formal recognition and potentially to quality perception.
- Multiple centres saw improvements in equipment, such as computers, bakery tools, sewing machines, and even hostel expansions.

### **Gender-Inclusive Entrepreneurship Support**

- A strong majority of youth supported in micro-enterprise setups were female (72%), reflecting a notable effort towards gender inclusion. Trades covered were diverse, spanning both traditional and modern sectors, contributing to livelihood generation and self-employment.

### **Placement Challenges Are Deeply Contextual**

- Despite placement support, relocation reluctance, especially among youth and guardians from tribal communities, significantly hampered outcomes in centres like Shillong. Cultural and safety concerns about moving outside the state are a major barrier. Hence, community sensitization, local placement partnerships, and language training (e.g., Hindi) were suggested as possible solutions.

### **Sustainability is a Mixed Picture**

- The centre directors emphasized that, among all project locations, only the Shillong centre demonstrates clear potential for sustainability beyond the duration of the project. Other centres depend heavily on **temporary government funding or struggle with low enrolment**, casting doubt on their long-term viability. Directors stressed the importance of **steady financial inflow and community mobilisation** to sustain operations beyond project cycles.

### **Recommendations**

- Community awareness campaigns for trainees and parents.
- Teaching commonly spoken languages to boost employability.
- Extension of project timelines for greater reach.
- Tailoring training interventions to the **local socio-economic context**.
- Introducing courses with **high regional demand** to improve job prospects and centre sustainability.

## **Centre-Level Achievements Highlight Diverse Impact**

- Shillong emerged as the strongest performing centre, exceeding targets and producing a high number of successful entrepreneurs. Other centres, like Pnar and Agartala, highlighted improvements in infrastructure and training delivery, while Bishramganj focused on helping dropout youth re-engage with skill training and employment.

### **5.2.2. Key takeaways from Trainers**

#### **Involvement in Curriculum Alignment**

Trainers at all 6 centres confirmed their active involvement in aligning the curriculum with training goals and industry requirements.

#### **Trainer Qualifications**

Trainers across the various centres held a diverse range of certifications and qualifications, reflecting the program's emphasis on both subject expertise and effective pedagogy. These included certifications in soft skills, salon management, digital literacy, subject-specific training, training of trainers (ToT), and trade-specific qualifications. At Don Bosco Tech, Agartala, trainers possessed academic degrees such as a BE in Computer Science and an MA with a Diploma in Computer Applications (DCA), highlighting strong technical and domain knowledge. In Nongstoin, the minimum qualification for trainers in driving and welding was completion of secondary education, ensuring foundational knowledge in the trades. At Don Bosco Tech, Silchar, trainers had completed ToT programs, as well as subject-specific, pedagogy, and digital literacy trainings. Their academic and technical credentials included a B.A. in General Studies, ongoing enrollment in M.A. programs, and completion of Higher Secondary education with ITI certification in Advanced Electronics. This mix of educational backgrounds and wide-ranging certifications demonstrates a commitment to maintaining high training standards and delivering quality vocational education across all centres.

#### **Challenges in Delivering Training**

Trainers at Shillong noted that school dropout trainees tended to be slower learners and lacked consistent motivation. In Agartala, low attendance was a challenge, particularly because many trainees were simultaneously pursuing college education. At Bishramganj, trainers faced language barriers while delivering sessions.

#### **Assessment of Trainee Performance and Post-Training Behaviour Change**

Across all centres, a combination of written tests, practical demonstrations, and continuous assessments was used to evaluate trainees' progress and performance. Trainers observed notable improvements in confidence, grooming, behaviour, and employment-readiness among the trainees. In Shillong, many students became more determined and goal-oriented as a result of the training.

#### **Employability of Students**

Trainers across the centres expressed varying assessments of trainee employability. In some centres, students were regarded as highly employable, having developed both technical and soft skills through the training programs. In others, employability was assessed as moderate, with trainees showing potential but requiring further support to meet industry standards. However, in a few instances, particularly where skill gaps or lower levels of preparedness were observed, trainers reported that only a limited number of students were job-ready. These variations highlight the need for consistent quality in skill delivery and targeted interventions to bridge existing gaps.

## Relevance and Practicality of Training

Most trainers affirmed that the training programs were practical and aligned with industry needs, particularly in trades where hands-on application is essential. However, some noted that course content could benefit from more frequent updates to stay current with evolving labour market demands. In certain cases, alignment with the local labour market was only partial, suggesting the need for improved labour market analysis and course planning.

## Recommendations for Course Improvement

- Introducing structured on-the-job training during weekends or integrating internships within the course duration was recommended to provide trainees with real-world experience and enhance workplace readiness.
- Trainers suggested the inclusion of advanced and emerging topics, such as Artificial Intelligence (AI) and digital productivity tools (e.g., AI-based MS Office), to ensure the curriculum remains future-ready and industry-relevant.
- Enhancing classroom infrastructure with modern teaching tools, such as projectors and digital devices, was identified as a priority to facilitate better learning outcomes and engagement.
- A recurring observation was that many trainees were hesitant to pursue job opportunities outside their home regions, especially in the Northeastern states. Trainers emphasized the importance of motivating and preparing trainees for mobility—through counselling, exposure visits, and confidence-building, so they can access a broader range of employment options.

### 5.2.3. Key takeaways from BIDS Project Staff

## Roles and Responsibilities

Across all six centres, BOSCO IDS project staff played a crucial role in the planning, implementation, monitoring, and evaluation of the TVET project. At Bishramganj, the staff primarily acted as coordinators between the BIDS Office and the centre, while at Agartala and Silchar, they were additionally involved in mobilisation efforts, especially targeting youth from underprivileged backgrounds.

## Beneficiary Identification and Mobilisation

A variety of methods were employed to identify and mobilise beneficiaries:

- Community mobilisation drives were widely used, often in collaboration with local leaders, panchayats, and NGOs.
- Staff also utilised social media platforms (Facebook, Instagram, YouTube), leaflets, brochures, and newsletters to raise awareness.
- In some centres, home visits and surveys were conducted by trainers or mobilisers, with a specific focus on school drop-outs and female youth from rural, low-income families.

## Key Achievements and Innovations

The BOSCO IDS teams reported notable achievements across centres.

- Shillong recorded the highest placement rate and saw several trainees transition into entrepreneurship.
- In Pnar, a unique outcome was that some students re-enrolled in school post-training, while others, especially from the motor mechanic trade, secured placements with reputed companies like Tata and Rani Motors.
- Bishramganj trained 432 trainees under the project.

- Silchar supported 130 self-employed youth and was commended for offering supplementary courses in soft skills and spoken English, contributing to the holistic development of trainees.

### **Sustainability of Project Components**

Most centres assessed their operations as fully sustainable, particularly Shillong, Nongstoin, Agartala, and Silchar. However, Pnar and Bishramganj reported partial sustainability, often linked to financial constraints and the need for continued external support.

### **Lessons Learned and Recommendations**

- The importance of enhanced community mobilisation and counselling for trainees, especially in regions where awareness about skilling opportunities remains low.
- A need to strengthen relationships with community stakeholders, which would improve mobilisation and long-term engagement.
- Staff in some centres noted challenges around affordability, as many students were inclined to join free or subsidised training programmes, making it difficult for fee-based models to sustain.

#### **5.2.4. Key takeaways from Employer**

### **Association with BOSCO**

Employers became connected with BOSCO through different means. While some, like 7 Brothers and 4 Sisters Bakery in Shillong, reached out on their own during vacancies, others were approached directly by BIDS staff or became associated through networking efforts. This indicates BOSCO's proactive approach to employer engagement and the growing reputation of its trainees.

### **Roles and Performance of Hired Youth**

Trainees were primarily hired for technical roles across all three employers. Most employers reported that the youth were well-prepared for the roles they were hired into. At Pride Honda and Nongbri Traditional Dress Making, trainees were seen as highly skilled, both in technical tasks and in soft skills such as attitude and communication. While some trainees at the bakery had limited hands-on experience or theoretical gaps, their enthusiasm to learn and improve was highlighted as a strong positive.

### **Skill Gaps and Preparedness**

Overall, the employers did not observe significant skill deficiencies. However, the bakery noted that some trainees lacked theoretical understanding, for instance, not knowing correct ingredient proportions, suggesting the need for better integration of theoretical knowledge with practical training. Another employer suggested that teaching widely spoken languages like Hindi could help trainees navigate workplaces outside their home region more effectively.

### **On-the-Job Support and Retention**

All employers confirmed that they provided on-the-job training or mentorship to help trainees settle into their roles. They also reported a 100% retention rate for BOSCO-trained employees, which reflects the strong alignment between the training received and workplace expectations.

### **Future Hiring Plans and Suggestions**

All employers expressed willingness to hire from BOSCO again, citing satisfaction with the quality of trainees. They recommended enhancing theoretical instruction in certain trades and offering language training to improve employability, especially in contexts where communication barriers exist.



### **5.3. Focus Group Discussion Analysis**

Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) were conducted with youths currently undergoing training at the centres to delve into their experiences related to classroom environment, training quality, teaching-learning methods, and to gauge whether their aspirations and needs are being met through the program. A total of five FGDs were held across the various centres, each comprising approximately 6 to 13 participants. Due to the unavailability of trainees at the Don Bosco Tech Silchar centre on the day of the visit, an FGD could not be conducted at that location.

#### **Motivation and Course Selection**

Participants across centres were motivated by a mix of personal interest, peer influence, and practical considerations such as job prospects and financial independence. Many were inspired by seniors already working in relevant trades, particularly those placed in other states like Kerala. The reputation of the centre and the perceived usefulness of the course also played an important role, especially in Shillong and Jowai. For most participants, the choice of course was voluntary, reflecting a desire to gain employable skills, although in Nongstoin, some trainees had enrolled simply to learn a new skill without a specific career goal in mind.

#### **Learning Experience and Training Delivery**

Trainees largely appreciated the dedication and skill of their trainers. In Shillong, trainers were praised not just for their technical expertise but also for fostering an encouraging and interactive learning environment. Trainers were described as approachable, supportive, and capable of explaining content clearly, making the sessions both enjoyable and educational. Similarly, in Jowai and Agartala, trainers were reported to be skilled and attentive. However, some feedback highlighted that short course durations limited in-depth skill development, and in certain centres, the curriculum lacked a strong entrepreneurial component that could help students set up their own ventures.

#### **Infrastructure and Training Facilities**

Infrastructure remained a mixed experience. Centres like Nongstoin reported adequate facilities, while others, particularly Shillong and Agartala pointed out issues such as lack of functional fans, absence of air-conditioning, and inadequate classroom setups. For example, Shillong trainees in theory classes had no desks to write on, affecting their learning comfort. In courses like Beauty and Wellness, although quality products were provided, the overall training cost (including fees and kits) was burdensome for many trainees, especially those from economically disadvantaged backgrounds. Equipment gaps were also noted in trades like electrical work, with specific tools either missing or of poor quality.

#### **Post-Training Outcomes and Centre Support**

Post-training pathways for beneficiaries encompassed a diverse range of outcomes, including self-employment, freelancing, employment in local shops or salons, and, in some cases, placements outside the state. Participants from Jowai and Nongstoin reported a few successful placements in Kerala, while several others had initiated small businesses or contributed to family-run enterprises. However, placement support at the centre level was generally minimal or absent across most locations. Consequently, trainees frequently had to secure employment independently or depend on informal networks for job opportunities. Where formal placement drives were organized, such as at the Ginger Hotel in Agartala, the results were largely unproductive.



## Challenges Faced by Trainees

A recurring issue across FGDs was the short duration of the training programs, which limited the depth of learning and practical exposure. High training fees, combined with additional costs for course kits, were also highlighted, especially in Beauty and Wellness. Infrastructural shortcomings further affected the learning experience in some centres. In rural and semi-urban areas, students noted limited local demand for certain skills, such as women's tailoring or electrical repairs, due to the rise of readymade products and online sales. Family responsibilities and commuting challenges also impacted consistent attendance, particularly for female trainees.

## Suggestions and Aspirations

Participants expressed a strong desire for extended training durations, ideally spanning up to a year, to deepen their expertise. Several suggested introducing modern and in-demand courses, such as coding, Artificial Intelligence, and video editing, to better align with market needs. Others called for improved infrastructure, air-conditioned classrooms, better equipment, and greater financial support to help launch micro-enterprises. Many trainees aspired to either upscale their current businesses or seek employment before transitioning to self-employment. In all cases, peer and family support emerged as a critical enabler of success.

## Socio-Economic Context and Observations

Many trainees came from modest socio-economic backgrounds, with several reporting the loss of a parent or being primary earners in large families. Media and institutional outreach were identified as primary sources of awareness about the courses, especially in centres like Jowai and Agartala. Instructors' salaries were also noted by trainees, with some questioning the disparity between what instructors earn and the salary expectations placed on them, pointing to deeper concerns around sustainability and value.

The detailed insights of the FGDs are presented in Table 5.2 and Table 5.3.

**Table 5.2: FGD Insights (Agartala, Bishramganj, Jowai)**

| Category                       | Agartala                                                                                                     | Bishramganj                                                                                          | Jowai                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Participants</b>            | 4 (3 from Domestic Data Entry Operator course, 1 from Baking Technician course)                              | 7 (All from Sewing Machine Operator course)                                                          | 6 [All women (Age 18–28) from Beauty & Wellness]                                                               |
| <b>Pre-training Motivation</b> | Peer/senior influence; chose out of interest; expectation of job; felt 3-month course is too short           | Self-interest in tailoring; seniors working in Kerala inspired them; market competition acknowledged | Job opportunity, financial independence, peer/NGO influence, local awareness; most chose the courses willingly |
| <b>Learning Experience</b>     | Skilled trainers; good equipment; punctual classes; individual attention; need for 1-year duration for value | Skilled, kind trainers; good machines; schedule reduced but fees increased; non-                     | Trainers helpful; methods interactive; curriculum useful but lacks entrepreneurial depth                       |

|                                  |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                  |                                                                                                                    | working fans, no AC                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Infrastructure</b>            | AC classrooms (for computer); tools working; safe; CCTV suggested for security                                     | Clean; non-functional fans; no AC; classes shortened despite fee hike                                   | Safe and friendly; equipment lacking in some courses; Beauty course cost burdensome (Fees ₹14K, Kit ₹5K+)                         |
| <b>Challenges Faced</b>          | Short course duration, high fee, no financial/startup aid, skills risk being forgotten, no peer employed in 1 year | High competition, ready-made & online sales; only women's tailoring offered; limited demand for repairs | Inadequate tools, short training, limited exposure to outside world, high accessory/training cost                                 |
| <b>Suggestions for Courses</b>   | Introduce AI, coding, video editing; longer duration; certified/diploma-level programs                             | Include men's tailoring; AC classrooms; better placement drives                                         | More hands-on training, financial help for entrepreneurs, longer training                                                         |
| <b>Future Plans</b>              | 1 doing BA; 2 plan computer shop; 1 wants hotel; 1 fast food business                                              | Work in Kerala or expand tailoring business                                                             | Upscale businesses, take further training, or secure better jobs                                                                  |
| <b>Special Observations</b>      | Students expect salary upwards of Rs. 25000                                                                        | Classes cut short but fees increased; commute & family obligations impact learning                      | All from modest families (avg. family size = 6); 50% had lost fathers by age 55; media & institute are main sources of exposure   |
| <b>Popular/Available Courses</b> | Computer, Baking Technician                                                                                        | Tailoring                                                                                               | 5: Motor Mechanic, Electrician, IT-ITES, Beauty & Wellness, Welding & Furniture; Electrician & Mechanic popular due to job demand |
| <b>Centre-Specific Issues</b>    | Short duration and no placement, which leads to low impact                                                         | Gents tailoring needed; subsidised tools delayed                                                        | Beauty course costly; Electrician & Mechanic lack tools;                                                                          |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 5.3: FGD Insights (Shillong, Nongstoin)**

| Category                         | Shillong                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Nongstoin                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Participants</b>              | 13 participants, 3 boys and 10 girls (Courses- fashion designing, fast food, electrical)                                                                                                                                                                                               | 6 participants, 2 boys and 4 girls (Courses- craft bakery, electrical)                       |
| <b>Pre-training Motivation</b>   | Reputation of the centre, interest in the skill                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Just wanted to join to learn new skill                                                       |
| <b>Learning Experience</b>       | Trainers are highly knowledgeable, experiences, supportive, friendly and create a safe space to learn. Clear way of imparting training, classes are interactive and enjoyable. Students are encouraged to show creativity. Environment conducive for learning.                         | Trainers are good at imparting the training and training curriculum is also well-structured. |
| <b>Infrastructure</b>            | Equipment in electrical (such as holders) not upto the mark, whereas in make-up, kits provided are of good brands and of premium quality. However, conditions of theory classrooms are not adequate. For instance, there are no tables for the trainees to take notes on, just chairs. | Infrastructure is upto the mark.                                                             |
| <b>Popular/Available Courses</b> | Bakery, Make-up, Fashion Designing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Electrical, craft bakery                                                                     |
| <b>Centre-Specific Issues</b>    | Infrastructural issues specifically with equipment and classrooms. As mentioned before, trainees reported that classroom condition (rooms used for theory classes) are not adequate, lack tables for taking notes.                                                                     | None.                                                                                        |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

***CHAPTER 6***  
**CRAFTING CHANGE: STORIES OF  
YOUTH EMPOWERMENT**

## Case Study: 1

### From Tailoring to Fashion Design – Sosila Japang's Entrepreneurial Journey

This case study captures the inspiring journey of Sosila Japang, a young woman from Mawryngkneng, East Khasi Hills, Meghalaya, who turned her passion for tailoring into a thriving fashion design business. Through skill training, determination, and resilience, she established her own enterprise, ***I.N.S Japang***, on 20th October 2023. Her story reflects the transformative power of vocational education and the entrepreneurial spirit.

#### Background and Training

Sosila began her journey with a tailoring course, which sparked her interest in fashion design. She wanted to upskill and applied, albeit at the last minute, for a fashion design course at Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong. Her acceptance into the program marked a turning point in her career. The training provided her with a strong foundation in both theoretical concepts and practical techniques, which helped her gain confidence and refine her craft.



#### Venturing into Entrepreneurship

Soon after completing her training, Sosila launched her fashion design shop, ***I.N.S Japang***. She started small, working from a modest space with basic equipment. Her first order, designing outfits for flower girls and bridesmaids, arrived soon after opening, giving her business an encouraging start. As word spread and demand increased, especially during the peak winter season when festivals and marriages drive orders, she expanded her operations and hired two assistants to manage the workload.

#### Challenges and Learnings

Sosila's entrepreneurial journey was not without challenges. She credits her training for not only developing her tailoring skills but also shaping her professional attitude. Over time, she learned the importance of staying grounded, taking feedback positively, and continuously improving her work.

#### Conclusion

Sosila Japang's journey from a tailoring student to a successful fashion entrepreneur stands as a powerful example of how vocational training can empower youth—especially young women in rural and tribal areas. Her story is a reminder that persistence, adaptability, and self-belief are key ingredients in building a successful enterprise.

## Case Study: 2

### **Darikupar Thangkhiew – A Young Chef’s Journey to Entrepreneurship**

Darikupar Thangkhiew is a dynamic young entrepreneur from Patharkhmah village in Ri Bhoi district, Meghalaya, who has charted an inspiring journey of self-reliance and community development. Located 65 km from Nongpoh town, Patharkhmah is home to this enterprising youth who, as the youngest among four siblings, has shown remarkable ambition and drive from an early age.

#### **Background**

After completing his Higher Secondary education, Darikupar pursued a culinary course at the Institute of Hotel Management (IHM), Shillong. Determined to further refine his skills, he enrolled at Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong, upon the recommendation of his friends. His time at Don Bosco proved instrumental in strengthening his practical knowledge and preparing him for real-world challenges in the food and hospitality industry.

#### **Venturing into Entrepreneurship**

At just 20 years old, with the support of his family and friends, Darikupar took a bold step and launched his own restaurant in his hometown, named **Joshua’s Kitchen**. His vision was not only to pursue his passion for cooking but also to contribute to the local economy. The restaurant quickly became a space for quality food and community engagement. Through his venture, Darikupar realized his potential not just as a chef, but also as a leader capable of creating employment for other young people in the region. His efforts have contributed to raising the standard of living in his community by offering both job opportunities and inspiration to other aspiring youth. He has expressed his gratitude towards the Don Bosco Technical school as well as the BMZ TVET Project for helping him discover his true potential and for empowering not only him, but youth across the state.

#### **Conclusion**

His journey is a testament to how skill training, family support, and courage can empower youth to not only build successful careers but also uplift their communities. His story serves as an inspiration for other young individuals to pursue their dreams with dedication and purpose.



### Case Study: 3

#### **Manda Kharir – Weaving Dreams Through Fashion and Determination**

"Work with passion and purpose, keeping my goals, ambitions, and aim in life at the forefront." – This powerful statement defines the journey of Manda Kharir, a talented young woman from Mawlai Mawtawar in East Khasi Hills District, Meghalaya. As the second of five siblings, Manda comes from a humble background. Her mother works as a housekeeper at North Eastern Hill University (NEHU), Shillong, and her father earns a living through daily wage labour.

#### **Background**

Manda completed her Class 12 from Sacred Heart Boys, Mawlai, Shillong. Driven by her deep interest in fashion, she enrolled in a five-month Fashion Designing Course at Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong, which commenced on 8th September 2023 and concluded in February 2024. Manda is known for her dedication, multitasking ability, and strong work ethic. Despite financial hardships, she managed to juggle responsibilities at home while regularly attending training sessions. Her commitment was rooted in a desire to serve society through fashion, by using her creativity and talent to make a difference.



#### **Achievements**

Overcoming numerous obstacles, Manda represented Meghalaya at the **National Level Skill Competition** under the **Creative Arts & Fashion** category, held from 15th to 16th May 2024 in Delhi. Her exceptional skills earned her the **“Medallion of Excellence” in Fashion Technology** at the prestigious **India Skills Competition 2024**, organised by the **National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC)** under the aegis of the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship**, Government of India.

As a self-employed fashion entrepreneur, Manda reflects on her journey with immense gratitude to the trainer, the management, and all the mentors at Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong.

#### **Conclusion**

Manda Kharir's story is a shining example of how perseverance, skill, and the right support system can help one overcome life's challenges. Her journey from a small town in Meghalaya to national recognition reflects the strength of young women who dare to dream and work relentlessly toward their goals. Her success is an inspiration to many aspiring youth across the state.



***CHAPTER 7***  
**PROJECT IMPACT AND  
TAKEAWAYS**

## 7.1. Centre-Level Impact of the Project

The overall centre-level impact of the Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) project across the studied centres is summarized in the tables below, highlighting key findings across various dimensions of project performance, beneficiary outcomes, and sustainability.

**Table 7.1: Centre-level Impact: Don Bosco Tech, Shillong**

| Category                                          | Findings                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Reasons for Enrolling</b>                      | Personal interest and employment motivation dominant; entrepreneurial interest also strong.                |
| <b>Training Alignment</b>                         | 94% said courses aligned with personal interests                                                           |
| <b>Training Quality Ratings</b>                   | Avg. rating: Methodology (4.6), Content/Trainer/Duration (4.5 each).                                       |
| <b>Facilities</b>                                 | 83% found infrastructure satisfactory; 14% found it adequate; only 3% unsatisfactory.                      |
| <b>Placement Status</b>                           | Employed (27%), Self-employed (26%), Unemployed (46%)                                                      |
| <b>Livelihood Impact</b>                          | 91% of surveyed employed beneficiaries said training helped with job/business.                             |
| <b>Income Distribution</b>                        | 54% earn ₹5K–₹10K; 39% earn ₹10K–₹20K; 4% earn above ₹20K; 3% earn under ₹5K.                              |
| <b>Post-Training Support</b>                      | 19% had job follow-up; <2% field visits.                                                                   |
| <b>Business Challenges</b>                        | 73% cited lack of capital; 30% faced loan access and raw material issues; competition was another barrier. |
| <b>Impact</b>                                     | 55% started earning; 96% feel confident/respected; 47% contribute financially.                             |
| <b>Sustainability</b>                             | 98% say the centre can continue post-project.                                                              |
| <b>Total Number of trainees trained in centre</b> | 3811                                                                                                       |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 7.2: Centre-level Impact: Don Bosco Tech, Pnar, Jowai**

| Category                                          | Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Relevance and Satisfaction</b>                 | - All respondents found training aligned with their personal interest and career goals.                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Training Quality Ratings</b>                   | - Avg. ratings: Methodology & Duration (4.4), Content & Trainer (4.3).<br>- 96% found facilities satisfactory; 4% saw minor room for improvement. No dissatisfaction reported.                          |
| <b>Employment Outcomes</b>                        | - 34% employed; 9% self-employed; 57% unemployed.                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Training Impact on Employment</b>              | - 96% of the employed and self-employed respondents felt training directly helped them secure a job or start a business.                                                                                |
| <b>Income Distribution</b>                        | - 40% earn ₹10K–₹20K/month; 49% in ₹5K–₹10K, only 11% earn <₹5K; likely recent hires or early-stage businesses.                                                                                         |
| <b>Business Challenges</b>                        | - 87% cited lack of initial capital, 43% faced loan access issues.<br>- Other issues: market limitations (21%), competition (11%).<br>- Very few had problems with raw materials or business knowledge. |
| <b>Aspirations</b>                                | - 96% reported skill/confidence improvement.<br>- Majority felt enhanced social standing and would recommend the training.<br>- All respondents want to continue learning new skills.                   |
| <b>Training Impact</b>                            | - 43% started earning income post-training.<br>- 94% felt confident and respected.<br>- 40% now contribute financially to their families.                                                               |
| <b>Sustainability</b>                             | - All respondents believe the centre can continue offering training after project closure.                                                                                                              |
| <b>Total Number of trainees trained in centre</b> | 1209                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 7.3: Centre-level Impact: St. Xavier's Vocational Training Centre, Bishramganj**

| Category                                          |                | Finding                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Training Alignment</b>                         |                | - 95% said training matched their personal interests and career goals. - 72% found training aligned with market demands; 30% felt it was only partially aligned.                                           |
| <b>Training Ratings</b>                           | <b>Quality</b> | - Effectiveness of Trainer (4.8), Methodology (4.7), Duration (4.5), Content (4.4).<br><br>- High satisfaction levels across all dimensions.                                                               |
| <b>Facilities</b>                                 |                | - 89% said infrastructure and tools were satisfactory; 11% saw room for improvement.                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Employment Outcomes</b>                        |                | - Employed (6%), Self-employed (44%), Unemployed (50%)                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Effectiveness of Training</b>                  |                | - 44% respondents said training helped secure job/start business, and 17% were unsure, indicating mixed perceptions of impact.                                                                             |
| <b>Financial Assistance</b>                       |                | - Only 6% received any financial support                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Income Levels</b>                              |                | - 11% earn < ₹5,000/month; 44% earn ₹5,000–₹10,000; 33% earn ₹10,000–₹20,000.<br><br>- Indicates <b>limited income potential</b> despite training.                                                         |
| <b>Business Challenges</b>                        |                | - 56% cited <b>lack of initial capital</b> ; 33% reported loan access issues.<br><br>- 50% noted poor market/customer base<br><br>- Other barriers: competition, lack of raw materials, business know-how. |
| <b>Post-Training Support</b>                      |                | - 67% reported <b>no follow-up support</b> .<br><br>- Only 22% received mentoring.<br><br>- 11% each got field visits or job follow-up.<br><br>- Indicates <b>weak post-training ecosystem</b> .           |
| <b>Training Impact</b>                            |                | - 50% started earning income.<br><br>- 89% feel more confident/respected.<br><br>- 50% contribute financially to their families.<br><br>- 6% reported no change.                                           |
| <b>Sustainability</b>                             |                | - 89% believe the centre can continue training youth post-project.                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Total Number of trainees trained in centre</b> |                | 405                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 7.4: Centre-level Impact: Don Bosco Peace Centre, Agartala**

| Category                                          | Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Motivation &amp; Course Relevance</b>          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- All beneficiaries enrolled due to both interest in the skill and belief in employability.</li> <li>- <b>72%</b> saw the course as a pathway to starting a business.</li> <li>- Only 28% were influenced by affordability, and 5% by recommendations.</li> <li>- All beneficiaries confirmed training aligned with <b>personal goals</b> and <b>local labour market demand</b>.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Training Quality Ratings</b>                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Methodology &amp; Duration (4.3 each); Trainer effectiveness (4.2); Content/Clarity (4.1)</li> <li>- No complaints reported; all respondents said facilities were satisfactory.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Employment Outcomes</b>                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Employed (4%), Self-employed (7%), Unemployed (89%)</li> <li>- Only 21% of the employed respondents received direct placement support from BIDS, but <b>all credited BIDS training for enabling their employment or business</b>.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Income Distribution</b>                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <b>79% earn ₹10K–₹20K/month</b>, showing strong mid-level income outcomes.</li> <li>- 19% earn above ₹20K</li> <li>- Only 2% earn between ₹5K–₹10K</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Financial Support</b>                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <b>None of the respondents received grants or loans</b> from BIDS.</li> <li>- <b>All respondents received mentorship support</b>, showing a focus on non-financial guidance.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Business Challenges</b>                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <b>95% cited lack of initial capital</b> as the top challenge.</li> <li>- 19% had difficulty accessing loans; 7% limited customer base; 5% cited business competition.</li> <li>- Clear gap in <b>financial linkages</b> despite strong business interest.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Post-Training Support</b>                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Only 2% reported job placement follow-up.</li> <li>- <b>No other follow-up mechanisms</b> (e.g., field visits) were reported.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Impact of Training</b>                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- 7% respondents reported they started earning income.</li> <li>- 98% felt confident and socially empowered.</li> <li>- 7% now contribute financially to their families.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Sustainability</b>                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Majority believe the centre can continue operating post-project, indicating <b>strong institutional credibility and infrastructure</b>.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Total Number of trainees trained in centre</b> | 356                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 7.5: Centre-level Impact: Don Bosco Tech, Nongstoin**

| Category                                          | Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Motivation &amp; Course Selection</b>          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <b>99%</b> chose the course due to <b>personal interest</b>; all believed it would help secure employment.</li> <li>- <b>88%</b> were motivated by business start-up potential.</li> <li>- Only <b>6%</b> considered affordability, and <b>5%</b> enrolled based on external recommendations.</li> <li>- All respondents confirmed alignment between training, personal goals, and local labour demand.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Training Quality Ratings</b>                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Content &amp; clarity (<b>4.3</b>)</li> <li>- Duration, Methodology, Trainer Effectiveness (<b>4.2</b> each)</li> <li>- 89% found facilities satisfactory; 11% saw scope for improvement.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Employment Outcomes</b>                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Employed (41%), Self-employed (6%), Unemployed (53%)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Income Distribution</b>                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <b>67%</b> earn ₹5K–₹10K/month; 31% earn ₹10K–₹20K/month; 2% earn above ₹20K</li> <li>- <b>No beneficiaries earn below ₹5K.</b></li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Financial/Market Linkages</b>                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>-None of the respondents received financial support (grants/loans) or market linkage.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Business Challenges</b>                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <b>93%</b> cited <b>lack of start-up capital</b> as their biggest challenge.</li> <li>- <b>22%</b> faced difficulty in getting loans or financial support.</li> <li>- Other barriers: competition (minor), limited customer base, raw material access.</li> <li>- Only 2% cited knowledge/training gaps, indicating skill delivery was largely effective.</li> </ul>                                               |
| <b>Post-Training Support</b>                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Only <b>2%</b> received job placement follow-up.</li> <li>- No other structured support mechanisms (field visits, market linkage) reported.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Training Impact</b>                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- 46% reported earning income post-training.</li> <li>- 87% feel confident and respected.</li> <li>-43% now contribute financially to their families</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Sustainability</b>                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- 100% believe the centre can continue operating post-project — strong institutional trust.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Total Number of trainees trained in centre</b> | 1332                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

Source: Primary Data (2025)

**Table 7.6: Centre-level Impact: Don Bosco Tech, Silchar**

| Category                                          | Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Motivation &amp; Relevance</b>                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <b>99%</b> enrolled due to interest in the skill.</li> <li>- <b>75%</b> wanted to productively use free time; 52% expected job outcomes; 28% sought business opportunities.</li> <li>- <b>90%</b> felt training aligned with personal goals; but only <b>57%</b> found it aligned with labour market needs</li> </ul> |
| <b>Training Ratings</b>                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- All key aspects (content, duration, methodology, trainer): <b>4.4/5</b>.</li> <li>- 85% satisfied with training facilities; 13% saw room for improvement, 2% reported that facilities were not upto the mark</li> </ul>                                                                                               |
| <b>Training Challenges</b>                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <b>18% reported trainer inefficiency, 8% reported issues with methodology.</b></li> <li>- Minor issues: language barriers (3%), mobility (3%), reduced cultural activities (2%), inability to take leave (2%).</li> </ul>                                                                                             |
| <b>Employment Outcomes</b>                        | - Employed (15%), Self-employed (9%), Unemployed (76%)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Income Levels</b>                              | - <b>40% earn &lt; ₹5,000, 35% earn ₹10K–₹20K, 17% earn &gt; ₹20K, and 8% in ₹5K–₹10K.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Entrepreneurial Challenges</b>                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Lack of business knowledge (13%) and <b>Limited market/customer base (10%)</b> were top business challenges.</li> <li>- <b>Lack of capital (7%), competition (5%), loan access and raw material sourcing (2%)</b> also noted.</li> </ul>                                                                              |
| <b>Post-Training Support</b>                      | - 58% reported no follow-up at all. - Only 28% had job follow-up; 27% received mentoring; 7% had field visits.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Training Impact</b>                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- 27% started earning income; 73% felt more confident/respected. - 30% contribute financially to their families.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Sustainability</b>                             | -70% believe the centre can continue operations post-project; 23% unsure, 7% pessimistic. - Indicates <b>moderate optimism but weak sustainability assurance.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Total Number of trainees trained in centre</b> | 1067                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

Source: Primary Data (2025)



## 7.2. Project Relevance

The table below sheds light on the relevance of the TVET project across various dimensions across the 6 training centres.

**Table 7.8: Project Relevance across the Training Centres**

| Aspect                           | Evidence                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Relevance Rating |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Alignment with Youth Aspirations | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Majority of respondents (&gt;90%) across the 6 training centres selected courses based on personal interest and career goals.</li><li>- &gt;97% across centres want further skill training.</li></ul>       | Very High        |
| Labour Market Compatibility      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- In each centre, more than 70% respondents reported training alignment with market needs.</li><li>- High uptake of trades like Beauty, Data Entry, Tailoring, Electrician, showing demand linkage.</li></ul> | High             |
| Gender Relevance                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- 78–88% female participation shows project success in reaching young women</li></ul>                                                                                                                         | High             |
| Socioeconomic Fit                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Majority aged 18–25, educated but unemployed, seeking low-cost, short-term training.</li><li>- Many faced financial constraints, but affordability was not the top motivator.</li></ul>                     | High             |
| Psychosocial Needs Addressed     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- 94–98% felt increased confidence, respect, and dignity after training.</li><li>- High satisfaction with methodology and mentorship</li></ul>                                                                | Very High        |

Source: Primary data (2025)

## 7.3. Key Achievements

### Access to Quality Skill Training

The project successfully trained 8,180 disadvantaged youth across six centres in the Northeast, including high outreach in Shillong (3811 trainees) and Nongstoin (1332 trainees). This extensive coverage, though below the initial target of 10,000, marks a significant reach among marginalized communities with youth-centric and gender-inclusive participation.

### Strong Employment and Self-Employment Outcomes

A total of 1,520 trainees were placed in employment, with Don Bosco Tech Shillong (691 placements) and Nongstoin (437 placements) leading the figures. In parallel, 1,688 youth became self-employed, exceeding the original target of 1,000 and 68% of these were women, underlining the project's impact on women-led livelihoods.

## **Enterprise Development and Entrepreneurship Promotion**

The project supported 195 youth in setting up micro-enterprises through the *Project Entrepreneurship Hub*, spanning trades like bakery, mobile repair, and fashion design. Most supported beneficiaries, 72% were female, and grants ranged up to ₹25,000, contributing to local economic activity.

## **Curriculum and Quality Alignment with NSQF**

The initiative ensured 38 vocational modules were aligned with the National Skills Qualification Framework (NSQF), including key revisions in sectors like Automotive, Apparel, and Hospitality. This compliance with national standards enhances the portability and recognition of training outcomes.

## **Income Enhancement and Economic Inclusion**

The average salary of placed trainees was ₹9271.44/month, aligning with the lower benchmark of the project's target (€96–€180/month). Though the average income for self-employed youth stood slightly below the target (₹8375/month vs €72–€96), the earnings demonstrate substantial progress, especially for first-generation earners.

## **Gender and Inclusion Mainstreaming**

The project demonstrated clear commitment to inclusion, with female participation comprising a significant portion of both self-employed and enterprise-supported beneficiaries. In placements too, 515 women (33%) were placed, meeting the project's gender equity goal.

## **7.4. Effectiveness of Stakeholder Collaboration**

The TVET project has established a myriad of collaborations with stakeholders across the government, financial, academic and incubation sectors to improve entrepreneurial training, financial literacy, mentorship and access to support services for youth.

### **Government Schemes and Institutions**

While the project has not yet received support under national programs like PMKVY or DDU-GKY, three training centres, Don Bosco Technical School, Shillong, Don Bosco Tech Nongstoin, and Bosco Pnar, Jowai have been empanelled under the Skill Meghalaya initiative thus indicating formal recognition and future potential for government-linked support for skilling and vocational education.

The project has also established key partnerships with government bodies like KVIC, DCIC (Jowai), MSMEs, and DIC (Agartala), which have provided awareness sessions on government schemes, entrepreneurial taxation, regulatory compliance, and enterprise registration (Udyam). NABARD also played a key role in the project by promoting Awareness on government scheme and programmes of NABARD.

### **Private Sector Employers**

The project has also established partnerships through MoUs and Letters of Intent with various private sector employers to facilitate placements and ongoing support for trained youth. The key partners include All Furniture Association and Barbeque Nation Ltd.

### **Financial Institutions**

Financial institutions such as SIDBI, SBI, Federal Bank, HDFC Bank, and Meghalaya Rural Bank have offered in-depth guidance on financial literacy, loan schemes, and bank procedures. Institutions like NESFAS have contributed through hands-on guidance in market survey tools and fieldwork techniques.

Entrepreneurial skill-building and ideation were supported through incubation and academic collaborations with Prime Meghalaya, RSETIs (Shillong and Agartala), IIE Guwahati, DOERS, Assam University, Jorhat Incubation Hub, and Downtown Incubation Hub, focusing on mindset development, skill training, and brainstorming activities. These partnerships in various capacities are important in building an ecosystem that supports youth through training, financing, mentorship and post-training entrepreneurship.

**Table 7.9: Type of Collaboration with Stakeholders**

| Name of Institutions                                          | Type/Capacity of Collaboration                                                                                                                                                       | Number of entrepreneurs/youth/trainees impacted |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| KVIC (Khadi Village Industries Commission)                    | Awareness on Government Schemes and Loan for young people                                                                                                                            | 100                                             |
| DCIC (District Commerce & Industries Centres), Jowai          | Entrepreneurship Schemes of State Govt : DIC<br>Entrepreneurial Accounting & Entrepreneurial Taxation<br>Regulatory Compliances and Registration for Enterprises, Udyam Registration | 500                                             |
| Prime Meghalaya                                               | Entrepreneurial skills & Brain storming Activity                                                                                                                                     | 1200                                            |
| RSETI (rural self employment training Institute)              | Entrepreneur, Entrepreneurship and Enterprise & Characteristics of an Entrepreneur                                                                                                   | 875                                             |
| SIDBI (Small Industries Development Bank of India)            | Financial Literacy & Loans and schemes                                                                                                                                               | 375                                             |
| SBI ( State Bank of India)                                    | Financial Literacy                                                                                                                                                                   | 150                                             |
| Meghalaya Rural Bank, Nongstoin                               | Financial Literacy                                                                                                                                                                   | 300                                             |
| NABARD (National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development ) | Awareness on government scheme and programmes of NABARD                                                                                                                              | 200                                             |
| Meghalaya Rural Bank, Nongstoin                               | Financial Literacy & Loans and schemes                                                                                                                                               | 200                                             |
| Federal Bank, Shillong                                        | Financial Literacy & Loans and schemes Procedure and Formalities for Bank Finance<br>Type of Enterprises/ Interaction with Bank Officials                                            | 875                                             |
| HDFC Bank, Shillong                                           | Procedure and Formalities for Bank Finance<br>Type of Enterprises/ Interaction with Bank Officials                                                                                   | 375                                             |

|                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                              |     |
|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| MSMS -Micro small and medium enterprise              | Procedure and Formality for Online Application for Financial Linkage under different schemes & Govt Programmes of MSMEs                                                      | 120 |
| NESFAS -North East Society for Agroecology Support   | Market Survey Tools & Techniques & Guidance for Field Work                                                                                                                   | 300 |
| Eastern Panorama Foundation                          |                                                                                                                                                                              |     |
| Assam university Incubation Hub                      | Entrepreneurial skills & Brain storming Activity                                                                                                                             | 250 |
| Jorhat Incubation Hub, Assam                         | Entrepreneurial skills & Brain storming Activity                                                                                                                             | 60  |
| DIC, Agartala                                        | Entrepreneurship Schemes of State Govt: DIC Entrepreneurial Accounting& Entrepreneurial Taxation Regulatory Compliances and Registration for Enterprises, Udyam Registration | 200 |
| DOWN TOWN INCUBATION HUB                             | Entrepreneurial skills & Brain storming Activity                                                                                                                             | 200 |
| DOERS                                                | Development of entrepreneurial skills/mindset                                                                                                                                | 600 |
| RSETI(AGARTALA)                                      | Development of entrepreneurial skills/mindset                                                                                                                                | 50  |
| IIE, Guwahati (Indian Institute of Entrepreneurship) | Awareness on entrepreneurship development and entrepreneurial skill training                                                                                                 | 500 |

Source: Project Documents

## 7.5. Challenges Faced and Gaps Identified

| Thematic Area                                | Gaps and Challenges                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>High Unemployment Rates Post-Training</b> | Despite training interventions, several centres reported high unemployment rates among beneficiaries (e.g., 76% in Jowai and 89% in Agartala), indicating limited success in translating skills into immediate employment.                       |
| <b>Weak post-training support</b>            | Structured post-training engagement, including job placement follow-up and field visits, was lacking. In many centres, over 60–70% of beneficiaries reported no follow-up after training, limiting job retention and long-term outcome tracking. |
| <b>Duration &amp; Depth of Training</b>      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Beneficiaries and trainers both reported 3-month courses are too short for industry-level competency.</li> </ul>                                                                                          |

|                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Students suggested 6–12 months for real impact, especially in trades like electrician, computer, beauty.</li> <li>In at least one centre (Bishramganj), trainees reported that the daily class schedule was shortened, while fees increased</li> </ul>                                                                                                   |
| <b>Equipment &amp; Infrastructure Gaps</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Non-functional or inadequate tools were reported in Silchar, Bishramganj, and Nongstoin.</li> <li>Beauty kits were expensive (₹5K+) and often had to be purchased by trainees.</li> <li>Fans, ACs, and power backup missing in some centres.</li> </ul>                                                                                                  |
| <b>Affordability of Training</b>             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Although subsidized, some courses were still financially burdensome: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>Agartala:</b> Food Processing students reported ₹14,000 fees + ₹5,000 kit cost.</li> </ul> </li> <li>Students preferred free or low-cost courses.</li> <li>Scholarships or fee waivers were not widely offered or transparent.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Soft Skill and Entrepreneurial Gaps</b>   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>While some confidence-building was achieved, many beneficiaries reported lack of business planning skills</li> <li>FGD data showed minimal awareness of market analysis, branding, or digital selling.</li> <li>Stakeholders noted curriculum lacked structured entrepreneurship modules.</li> </ul>                                                     |
| <b>Digital &amp; Green Skill Integration</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Limited or no integration of green skills (3–6% participation only).</li> <li>Digital skills (AI, coding, editing) desired by beneficiaries were not available.</li> <li>Demand for courses like video editing, AI, mobile repair was expressed in Shillong and Agartala FGDs.</li> </ul>                                                                |
| <b>Market Linkage and Exposure</b>           | Minimal exposure to external employers, real-time market visits, internships                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Certification and Recognition</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>While certificates were provided, beneficiaries expressed concern that short-term certificates lacked industry recognition.</li> <li>No clear pathway to government-recognized diploma or long-term certification.</li> <li>Some of the training modules were introductory in nature and may not meet deeper industry expectations.</li> </ul>           |
| <b>Centre Sustainability Concerns</b>        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Some stakeholders raised concern about future viability of centres post-project if external funding ceases.</li> <li>Only 2–3 centres had active partnerships with government schemes.</li> <li>Limited visibility of exit or sustainability plan.</li> </ul>                                                                                            |
| <b>Mobility Constraints</b>                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Many trainees were reluctant to migrate outside their home districts or states</li> <li>Concerns included language barriers, fear of urban safety, lack of family support, and cultural unfamiliarity</li> <li>This reduced their participation in national-level job placements.</li> </ul>                                                             |

Source: Primary data (2025)

## 7.6. Project Sustainability

The sustainability of the TVET project implemented by Bosco Integrated Development Society (BIDS) is marked by promising indicators at both the institutional and beneficiary levels. Several training centres, such as the Don Bosco Technical School in Shillong, have made strides toward financial sustainability by covering up to 50% of operational costs, while others are gradually building capacity. Importantly, over 90% of surveyed beneficiaries across multiple centres expressed confidence that the vocational training institutions could continue operating effectively beyond the project's lifespan. This is attributed to the availability of infrastructure, trained staff, and established training systems.

On the individual level, 78–92% of employed and self-employed youth reported confidence in sustaining their livelihoods over the long term, indicating that the skills imparted were practical and relevant. The project also instilled a spirit of continued learning and self-reliance, with nearly all beneficiaries expressing a desire to pursue additional skill development in the future. However, sustainability is somewhat limited by persistent challenges, particularly in access to finance and market linkages. Most beneficiaries did not receive monetary support for entrepreneurship, and centres reported low outreach in terms of government or private financial schemes.

Despite these gaps, the strong mentoring support, alignment of training with labour market demands, and high levels of satisfaction among trainees suggest that the project has created a resilient foundation. Strengthening financial access, institutional linkages, and placement mechanisms will be crucial for ensuring long-term sustainability and scalability of the TVET ecosystem established through this initiative.

**CHAPTER 8**  
***RECOMMENDATIONS AND***  
***CONCLUSION***



## 8.1. Recommendations

| Thematic Area                       | Recommendations                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Course Duration and Depth           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Extend training duration for technical and service trades to 6–12 months, especially in trades like electrician, computer, and beauty therapy.</li> <li>- Introduce modular structures with levels (basic to advanced).</li> </ul>                                              |
| Financial Support for Entrepreneurs | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Establish seed funding or micro-grant mechanisms for self-employed youth.</li> <li>- Facilitate linkages with credit institutions, SHGs, or state livelihood missions.</li> <li>- Provide toolkits/equipment starter packs to top-performing graduates.</li> </ul>              |
| Placement and Industry Linkages     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Integrate internships/apprenticeships within training where feasible.</li> <li>- Organize exposure visits to local businesses.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                       |
| Certification and Accreditation     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Ensure universal affiliation with NSDC/SSC or state-recognized bodies.</li> <li>- Map trades to official National Skills Qualification Framework (NSQF) levels.</li> <li>- Enable credit transfers toward diplomas or long-term certification for further education.</li> </ul> |
| Curriculum and Skill Relevance      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Update curricula regularly with employer input.</li> <li>- Add entrepreneurship modules: pricing, marketing, digital promotion, GST/compliance.</li> <li>- Incorporate soft skills, workplace readiness, and digital literacy (e.g., email, MS Office).</li> </ul>              |
| Course Expansion (New Trades)       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Introduce demand-driven modern courses: AI, video editing, mobile repair, digital marketing.</li> <li>- Promote non-traditional trades for women (electrical, welding).</li> <li>- Offer men's tailoring and other trades relevant to male youth.</li> </ul>                    |
| Equipment and Infrastructure        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Upgrade centre infrastructure: ACs, fans, tools, power backup.</li> <li>- Ensure full functional labs/kits for beauty, electrician, and computer courses.</li> </ul> <p>Allocate repair/maintenance budgets annually.</p>                                                       |
| Green and Digital Skill Integration | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Integrate green job components into existing trades (e.g., energy-efficient practices, sustainable beauty, solar installation).</li> <li>- Make digital upskilling cross-cutting: all trades should include basic ICT skills.</li> </ul>                                        |

|                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Post-Training Support & Alumni Linkage | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Establish alumni tracking systems, including employment status and earnings.</li> <li>- Conduct monthly follow-ups for 6–12 months post-training.</li> <li>- Create WhatsApp groups or peer learning forums for ongoing support.</li> </ul>              |
| Gender Inclusion & Support             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Ensure gender-neutral trade access.</li> <li>- Provide transport, childcare, or safety support (e.g., hostels, CCTVs).</li> <li>- Conduct family counselling sessions to support women's mobility for work.</li> </ul>                                   |
| Outreach and Targeting                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Run structured IEC campaigns (social media, radio, community mobilizers) to reach underserved youth in tribal/rural belts.</li> <li>- Collaborate with panchayats, SHGs, and local influencers for mobilization.</li> </ul>                              |
| Migration & Mobility Support           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Offer pre-placement counselling on migration, language readiness, and city orientation.</li> <li>- Partner with industry to create safe work migration pathways with boarding assistance.-</li> <li>Encourage local placement where feasible.</li> </ul> |
| Centre Sustainability Planning         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Develop revenue-generating models (short paid courses, CSR tie-ups, product sales).</li> <li>- Forge partnerships with state skill missions, MSMEs, and government schemes</li> </ul>                                                                    |

## 8.2. Summary of Key Findings

### Strong Youth and Female Participation

The project effectively reached its target group, with the majority of beneficiaries aged 18–25 and a high proportion of female participants (up to 83% in some centres). This highlights the project's inclusivity and relevance for rural, disadvantaged youth, especially young women.

### Alignment with Aspirations and Market Needs

Over 95% of beneficiaries reported that their chosen courses aligned with their personal interests and long-term career goals. Around 92–100% found the training relevant to local labour market demands, indicating high programme relevance.

### Quality and Satisfaction with Training

Training was rated highly across all centres, with average scores above 4.2 out of 5 on content, methodology, and trainer effectiveness. Beneficiaries also reported satisfaction with infrastructure and learning facilities.

## **Entrepreneurial Aspirations but Limited Financial Support**

A significant number of youth expressed intent to start businesses, particularly in Bishramganj and Nongstoin. However, access to financial assistance remained limited, with less than 2% of trainees in some centres receiving startup support. The lack of capital, access to loans, and market linkages were commonly reported barriers.

## **Income Generation and Social Impact**

Most employed and self-employed beneficiaries earn between Rs. 5,000–20,000 per month, with income gradually improving over time. In addition, 94–100% reported increased self-confidence and social respect, with many contributing financially to their households.

## **Mentorship vs. Financial Linkages**

While 90–96% of beneficiaries received mentorship and handholding support, only a small fraction received job placement follow-up, field visits, or financial support. Centres need to strengthen structured post-training engagement and credit/market linkages.

## **Centre Performance and Sustainability**

Centres like Shillong have started covering a portion of their operating costs (50%), while others are still dependent on project support. More efforts are needed to strengthen financial and institutional sustainability across all locations.

## **High Aspirations and Willingness to Learn**

Over 97% of beneficiaries expressed interest in pursuing further skill training, and nearly all recommended the training to others. This reflects high satisfaction and scope for long-term capacity-building initiatives.

## **Challenges Identified**

- Inadequate placement and tracking mechanisms
- Limited access to financial support for self-employment
- Poor market linkage and post-training follow-up
- Gender disparity in labour force participation in the broader context (especially in Meghalaya and Tripura)

## **8.3. Conclusion**

The evaluation of the Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) project implemented by Bosco Integrated Development Society (BIDS) reveals that the initiative has made meaningful strides in enhancing the employability and livelihood prospects of disadvantaged youth across Northeast India. Operating across six centres, Shillong, Jowai, Nongstoin, Silchar, Bishramganj, and Agartala—the project reached over 8,000 youth and maintained a strong focus on inclusion, with a significant proportion of participants being women and individuals from rural and low-income backgrounds.

The training courses were well-aligned with both the aspirations of the youth and the demands of the local labour market. Over 90% of beneficiaries across centres reported that the training matched their interests and was relevant to employment opportunities in their region. Training quality was consistently rated highly, with average scores above 4.2 out of 5 in terms of trainer effectiveness, content clarity, and delivery methodology. Additionally, more

than 95% of beneficiaries reported increased confidence and social respect after training, reflecting significant psychosocial benefits.

In terms of economic impact, the project facilitated both employment and entrepreneurship, with 1,520 trainees securing jobs and 1,645 becoming self-employed—surpassing the original target. However, unemployment rates remain high in some centres, and income levels for most employed beneficiaries still fall in the Rs. 5,000–10,000 range, suggesting that many are in early-stage or low-paying jobs. Entrepreneurial intent was strong, particularly in locations like Bishramganj and Nongstoin, but access to capital, loans, and market linkages was limited. Less than 2% of respondents received direct financial support, and post-training placement or business support remains an area of concern.

The project demonstrated potential for long-term impact, with the majority of beneficiaries expressing interest in further training and belief in the sustainability of their livelihood activities. However, for the project's gains to be sustained and scaled, future interventions must strengthen financial linkages, market access, and post-training follow-up.

In conclusion, the TVET project has laid a strong foundation for skill development and youth empowerment in the region. With focused improvements in placement systems and entrepreneurship support, it holds the potential to evolve into a scalable and sustainable model for livelihood generation in underserved communities.

## ANNEXURE- I

### 1. Details of Insights from Centre Director

|                                                  | <b>Don Bosco Tech,<br/>Shillong</b>                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Don Bosco Tech,<br/>Pnar</b>                                                     | <b>Don Bosco Peace<br/>Centre, Agartala</b>                                                                               | <b>St. Xavier<br/>Vocational Training<br/>Centre,<br/>Bishramganj</b>                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Centre Director</b>                           |                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                     |                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                       |
| Role and responsibilities in the TVET project    | Administrative, Curriculum Planning, Monitoring and Evaluation, Trainer Recruitment & Management, Acts as a link between the BIDS office and the Centre.                                  | Administrative, Curriculum Planning                                                 | Administrative                                                                                                            | Administrative, Curriculum Planning, Monitoring and Evaluation, Trainer recruitment/management                                                        |
| Alignment with local labour market               | Well-aligned                                                                                                                                                                              | Partially aligned                                                                   | Partially aligned                                                                                                         | Partially aligned                                                                                                                                     |
| Trainer selection and training method            | External recruitment based on qualification<br>Internal staff training                                                                                                                    | Internal staff training facilitated by BOSCO                                        | Training facilitated by BOSCO                                                                                             | Internal staff training                                                                                                                               |
| Strengths of the centre                          | Experienced trainers, Industry linkages with employers, strategic location of centre, brand name of centre, easier mobilisation since the centre is well-known and strategically located. | Infrastructure, experienced trainers                                                | Infrastructure, easily accessible location                                                                                | Experienced trainers                                                                                                                                  |
| Is the centre NSDC-accredited? Challenges if not | Yes, accredited.                                                                                                                                                                          | Not accredited due to infrastructural shortfall.                                    | Not accredited due to lack of candidates.                                                                                 | Not accredited due to infrastructural shortfall                                                                                                       |
| Any infrastructural upgrades done?               | Equipment and tools in the trades of– electronics and mobile repair, motor mechanic vehicle, bakery and cake specialist, fashion designing and tailoring.                                 | A new building was constructed under this project. New equipments also accompanied. | Infrastructure in terms of equipment- computers, bakery equipment. There has also been an extension of hostel facilities. | Yes. Sewing machines for Sewing Machine Operator (SMO) course.                                                                                        |
| Support received from BOSCO/government/partners  | Financial Technical Monitoring & Evaluation, Providing sessions and programs on entrepreneurship, guest lectures, tools and equipment                                                     | Financial                                                                           | Financial, technical, monitoring and evaluation                                                                           | Financial, technical, monitoring and evaluation, mobilisation support, aid in organising entrepreneurship development programme, conference for self- |

|                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                   |                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                   | employment with stakeholders                                                               |
| Challenges in achieving project objectives | Most of the soft skills and entrepreneurship training programs were conducted as per the project targets. However, the performance of the centre in terms of placements was not satisfactory. While the centre's placement cell did facilitate job opportunities for all trainees, many of these opportunities are located outside Meghalaya, since it is not feasible to place all candidates within the state. Both the trainees and their guardians often express hesitation and apprehension about accepting placements outside Meghalaya, which significantly affects the overall placement outcomes. | Retention issues of the trainees.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Low enrolment of trainees, low awareness about the centre.        | Lack of infrastructure                                                                     |
| Ability to sustain post-project            | Yes.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Partially.</b> Government-supported initiatives like Skill Meghalaya currently provide financial support to trainees, which helps sustain the training centres. However, this funding may not be consistent in the long term, and there is a risk that the funds could eventually be exhausted. | Partially.                                                        | Partially. Due to low enrolment rates of trainees, the centre is unable to sustain itself. |
| Suggestions for project improvement        | Community awareness programs should be conducted for both trainees and their parents to sensitise them about the importance and opportunities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | An extended duration of project will enable the centres to reach out to larger population & serve the society.                                                                                                                                                                                     | The interventions need to be specific to local context and needs. | To offer courses that have a demand in the regional labour market                          |

|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                | <p>associated with placements. In tribal communities, which are often close-knit and deeply rooted in their home environment, there is a natural reluctance to move outside the state, primarily due to safety concerns. This makes it challenging for the centre to facilitate placements beyond Meghalaya.</p> <p>Regular labour market assessments should be carried out to understand evolving industry demands and align training programs accordingly. This would ensure that the skills being imparted remain relevant and increase the employability of trainees. Teaching commonly spoken languages like Hindi can also enhance trainees' ability to communicate effectively in work environments outside the state, making relocation and integration smoother.</p> |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Linkages with employers        | Yes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Yes                                                                                                          | Yes                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Key Achievements of the Centre | <p>The centre successfully exceeded its project objectives by training a significant number of disadvantaged rural youth, primarily school dropouts. Many of these trainees secured suitable placements after completing their training. A majority of the well-established entrepreneurs under the project also emerged from this centre.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <p>More than 700 students have been trained, most of the students trained are earning a good livelihood.</p> | <p>The centre has become better equipped to conduct skill training, the centre has gained experience in conducting more training programs, and has successfully help youth to acquire income- generating skills.</p> | <p>Centre has been able to reach target number of trainees, many of which have been placed in various companies and others are self-employed. The centre has also enabled many drop-out students who joined as trainees to gain employment.</p> |



## 2. Details of Insights from Trainers

| Trainers                                   | Don Bosco Tech, Shillong                                                                                    | Don Bosco Tech, Pnar                                                 | Don Bosco Peace Centre, Agartala                                                             | St. Xavier Vocational Training Centre, Bishramganj                                           | Don Bosco Tech, Nongstoin                                                                                         | Don Bosco Tech, Silchar                                     |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Involvement in curriculum alignment        | Yes                                                                                                         | Yes                                                                  | Yes.                                                                                         | Yes.                                                                                         | Yes.                                                                                                              | Yes.                                                        |
| Type of capacity building received         | Training in cosmetology course, basic and advanced hair training                                            | Training of Trainers (ToT)                                           | Training of Trainers (ToT)                                                                   | Training of Trainers (ToT), trade-specific certifications                                    | Training of Trainers (ToT)                                                                                        | Training of Trainers (ToT), trade-specific certifications   |
| Qualifications                             | Certifications on soft skills, certification to open salon, etc. ToT,                                       | Graduate (BA)                                                        | Trainer (ITES)-BE (Computer Science)<br><br>Trainer (Domestic Data Entry Operator)- MA (DCA) | Trainers for driving and welding, qualifications were the completion of secondary education. | Trainers for electrical and welding & possessed qualifications like the completion of higher secondary education. | B.A in General, Higher Secondary, ITI (Advance electronics) |
| Challenges in delivering training          | Some students who are school dropouts are slower learners than the others, with lower levels of motivation. | No challenge                                                         | Low attendance since most trainees were college students.                                    | Language barrier                                                                             | No challenge                                                                                                      | Enthusiasm of trainees is lacking                           |
| How trainee performance was assessed       | Tests and exams, practical demonstration, and continuous assessment,                                        | Tests and exams, practical demonstration, and continuous assessment, | Tests and exams, practical demonstration, and continuous assessment,                         | Tests and exams, practical demonstration, and continuous assessment,                         | exams, practical demonstration, and continuous assessment                                                         | Exams, practical demonstration, and continuous assessment   |
| Changes observed in students post-training | Increase in confidence, groomed behaviour, many become determined and strive                                | Confidence, skills, behaviour,                                       | Confidence, skills, behaviour, employment-readiness                                          | Confidence, skills, behaviour, employment-readiness                                          | Confidence, skills, behaviour, employment-readiness                                                               | Confidence, skills, behaviour, employment-readiness         |
| Were gender-sensitive practices adopted?   | No                                                                                                          | No                                                                   | No                                                                                           | No                                                                                           | No                                                                                                                | No                                                          |

|                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                    |                                    |                                                                                                  |                                  |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Employability of students                 | Highly employable                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Highly employable                                       | Moderately-to- Highly Employable                                                                                                                                   | Very less students are employable. | Moderately-to- Highly Employable                                                                 | Moderately-to- Highly Employable |
| Training was practical/industry-relevant? | Yes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Yes                                                     | Yes                                                                                                                                                                | Yes, partially.                    | Yes, partially.                                                                                  | Yes, partially.                  |
| Recommendations for course improvement    | After 5 days of training, weekends should be used for on-the-job training so that trainees get exposure and practical experience. Furthermore, trainees are hesitant to venture outside the Northeastern region for job/training opportunities, and this hinders opportunities of growth and experience. Trainees should be motivated to go to different places and employers to attain | More equipments are need, such as engine, gearbox, etc. | Courses need to be up-to-date, for example, can include courses on Artificial Intelligence (AI). Advanced courses should be introduced such as AI-based MS Office. | Classrooms should have projectors. | More technical courses related to modern tech (eg. A.I) and 6+ months courses are more efficient | Long duration courses            |

### 3. Details of Insights from BOSCO IDS Project Staff

|                                |                                 |                             |                                  |                                               |                                         |                                |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>BOSCO IDS Project Staff</b> | <b>Don Bosco Tech, Shillong</b> | <b>Don Bosco Tech, Pnar</b> | <b>Don Bosco Tech, Nongstoin</b> | <b>St. Xavier Vocational Training Centre,</b> | <b>Don Bosco Peace Centre, Agartala</b> | <b>Don Bosco Tech, Silchar</b> |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------|

|                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                     |                                                     |                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                     | <b>Bishramganj</b>                                  |                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                 |
| Role in BIDS TVET project                      | Planning, Implementation, Monitoring and Evaluation                                                                                                                                                                      | Planning, Implementation, Monitoring and Evaluation                                                                                                                | Planning, Implementation, Monitoring and Evaluation | Co-ordination between BIDS Office and centre        | Planning, Implementation, Monitoring and Evaluation, Mobilisation | Planning, Implementation, Monitoring and Evaluation, Mobilisation                                                                               |
| Beneficiary identification/mobilisation method | Community mobilisation drives, NGO referrals Social media outreach, approaching village headmen to mobilise youth from rural, low-income families, Leaflet, brochure, newsletter, YouTube channel, Facebook, , Instagram | Home visits                                                                                                                                                        | Community mobilisation drives                       | Community mobilisation, local leaders, networks     | Community mobilisation drives, panchayat/local leader networks    | Mobilisers, mobilising done by trainers through surveys, visits, and drives. Special attention given to females. School drop-outs.              |
| Key achievements and innovations               | Highest placement among centres, many trainees have their own enterprises.                                                                                                                                               | Some students rejoined school after this course, some employed at various organizations, mostly motor mechanic trained students are placed with Tata & Rani Motors | 30-40 jobs in Kerala.                               | Centre has trained 432 employees under TVET Project | -                                                                 | 140 students self-employed, the centre provides many additional courses on soft skills, and spoken English for holistic development of trainees |
| Any unintended outcomes                        | Late disbursement of NSDC certificates                                                                                                                                                                                   | -                                                                                                                                                                  | -                                                   | -                                                   | -                                                                 | -                                                                                                                                               |
| Sustainability of project components           | Fully Sustainable                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Partially sustainable                                                                                                                                              | Fully Sustainable                                   | Partially sustainable                               | Fully Sustainable                                                 | Fully Sustainable                                                                                                                               |

|                                            |     |                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                  |                                                   |                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lessons learned and recommendations        | -   | The staff member joined five months ago and assumed their current role only two months back, so they have limited exposure and experience in this position. | Many students find it difficult to afford the course fees and tend to prefer free or lower-cost training options. | Community mobilisation should be enhanced, counselling should be given to trainees, awareness programs regarding skill, and better documentation | Foster better relationship with community members | There should be community awareness programmes since there is a large proportion of unemployed youth that is hesitant to join such courses. |
| Was the project on time and within budget? | Yes | Yes                                                                                                                                                         | Yes                                                                                                               | Yes                                                                                                                                              | Yes                                               | Yes                                                                                                                                         |

#### 4. Details of Insights from Employers

| Employers                                   | 7 Brothers and 4 Sisters Bakery, Shillong                                                                                                                                            | Nongbri Traditional Dress Making, Shillong | Pride Honda, Kerala                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| How association with BOSCO began            | Employer reaches out during vacancy                                                                                                                                                  | Direct Outreach by BIDS                    | Networking                                                                   |
| Roles filled by trained youth               | Technical roles                                                                                                                                                                      | Technical roles                            | Technical roles                                                              |
| Skill/preparedness level of trainees        | Some of them are well-trained while some have the training experience but not much hands-on experience.                                                                              | Highly skilled.                            | Highly skilled- both with soft skills (attitude, etc) as well as hard skills |
| Skills youth lacked (if any)                | They did not lack any skill but whatever skill they were weak in, they were eager to learn, and better themselves at that skill. Enthusiasm to learn was shown by these individuals. | None                                       | None                                                                         |
| On-the-job training or mentorship provided? | Yes                                                                                                                                                                                  | Yes                                        | Yes                                                                          |
| Retention rate of BOSCO-trained employees   | 100%                                                                                                                                                                                 | 100%                                       | 100%                                                                         |

|                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |      |                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Would you hire from BOSCO again?     | Yes                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Yes  | Yes                                                                                         |
| Suggestions to improve employability | Some possessed less knowledge on theory. For example, not knowing the correct proportion of ingredients to make dough. Thus, proper theoretical knowledge should supplement practical knowledge for better employability. | None | If languages such as hindi can be taught, then the barrier of communication can be removed. |

## ANNEXURE- II

### **BIDS Beneficiary Questionnaire**

#### **▪ *Basic Details***

**Name**

**Age**

**Educational Qualifications**

- Primary
- Secondary
- Higher secondary
- Graduate
- Post-graduate

**Gender**

- M
- F

**Centre location**

- Shillong
- Silchar
- Agartala
- Nongstoin
- Bosco Pnar
- Bishramganj

#### **▪ *Training Participation and Satisfaction***

**Which course were you enrolled in? Why did you choose this course?**

**Was the training aligned with your interest and career goals?**

**Was the vocational course aligned with the labour market demands of your region?**

**Rate the quality of training on a scale of 0-5 scale:**

- CONTENT AND CLARITY OF TRAINING MATERIAL
- DURATION OF TRAINING\*
- METHODOLOGY USED DURING TRAINING
- EFFECTIVENESS OF TRAINER

**Were the training facilities (infrastructure, labs, tools, equipment) adequate and well-functioning?**

**Was it a residential training?**

**Did you face any challenges during the training?**

**Employment Outcomes**

**What is your current employment status?**

**Was the placement part of the BIDS project?**

**Monthly income range?**

**Did your training help you get this job/start your business?**

- *Entrepreneurship and Support Services*

**Have you received financial assistance (grant/loan) for your business as a part of the BIDS project?**

**What kind of business support did you receive from BOSCO?**

**What was the biggest challenge in starting/continuing your business?**

**Have you received any follow-up or post-training support from the centre?**

- *Perception and Impact*

**Has the training improved your self-confidence and communication skills?**

**Has your social standing or respect within your family and community improved after participating in the training and gaining employment?**

**Would you recommend this training to others in your community?**

**In what ways has the training impacted your life after completion?**

**What are your suggestions to improve this project?**

- *Future Aspirations*

**Do you feel confident to sustain your job/business in the long term?**

**Do you wish to take more training or learn new skills in the future?**

**Do you think the training centre you attended has the capacity to continue training youth even after the project ends?**





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